

TOP SECRET

Over 1,200 marketing ideas that attract
new clients and put cash in your pocket!

2014

Cash Flow Calendar
(7th Edition)

The Ultimate Marketing & Promotional
Campaign That Helps You THINK Like a
Marketer...

Marketing campaigns that are **GUARANTEED**
to make you money and grow your business.

by Troy D White, Responsive Direct Marketing
www.cashflowcalendars.com

Welcome to your 2014 Marketing & Promotional Calendar!

When planning your marketing campaigns and promotions, make sure you choose ones that fit your industry, target market and goals but don't be afraid to go out-of-the-box.

This marketing and promotional calendar has **thousands of unique ideas** that you can change to grow your company. Use this calendar to maintain all your planned and actual promotional events.

Make sure you try to schedule events 3-6 months in advance to create an effective promotion.

To use this calendar efficiently, always **READ AHEAD!**

Look at the time it will take to write your promo, organize printing, envelope stuffing and mailing etc.

*For example, if you want to do a Valentines day promotion – make sure you have prepared your mailing materials and **have it printed AT LEAST 30 days before** the day you want it to hit everyone's mailbox. Mail it 7 – 10 business days before your offer begins. If you are mailing across the Canada/US border – leave at least 14 business days.*

*It may take less time and get there early, but that is better than the package showing up **AFTER THE DEADLINE!***

Not that it has ever happened to me – ah hem.

Ok maybe once.

Some extra hints:

- Don't forget to include local community events in your planning. For example, since I live in Calgary – I focused my attention on the Calgary Stampede and have since built a successful plan with my Wild West Wealth Summit. It tied into something and has since exploded into something else. Tie yourself into municipal events – national events – and ANYTHING media worthy that you can tie into your business or offering.
- If you can't seem to find a great promotion, consider declaring your own holiday event. You will find tons of different unusual celebrations throughout this calendar but don't forget to include your company's anniversary etc. The main thing to remember is to not let a marketing opportunity pass you by!
- Make sure you also track your marketing costs for each event and the results from it. By doing this – you will give yourself an easy glance at which events and promotion were productive. This will help you with your future marketing planning.
- **Outside of the envelope is key.** Live stamps (use multiples if possible, special edition stamps, crooked or upside down), blue ink, blind approach (with no company name, just your return address). Send by Fedex if you can. Phony Fedex envelopes. UPS style envelope. Placemats, brown paper bags. Get through the clutter! It must appear so important they have no choice but to open it. One of the nicest

things with Lumpy mail (which refers to the grabbers you insert with the mailer – many examples are in this calendar) is that it is next to IMPOSSIBLE to throw it out without opening it... the curiosity factor is immense.

- Once you open it – the inside must be congruent with the outside. Do not give them a “I’ve been conned” feeling. If it says Confidential and Personal – there had better be the same on the inside! Same with photo enclosed. Fragile.
- **Keep em reading!** Grabbers at top of letters. Personalization. Opening sentence after the headline - - not the place to talk about yourself. Talk about what it is going to do to help the reader. Use the If you..... then..... as an intro. Cosmetics of the letter and contents are key. Personalize it as much as you can. Gimmicky things. Grabbers, devices. You are trying to buy a few moments of permission from them.
- **Create urgency.** Big issue – most will attempt to set it aside. They typically will never buy if they do. Make it easy. Make it fast. Make it clear and very prominent that there is urgency. Choices of incentive and penalty. Multiple incentives. Choice of incentives. Discounts. Payment terms. Penalties. Take away bonuses. Take away portions of the product or service. Analogy – “be back” customers never do what they say. < 3% do. **Good reason for why an urgency must be created – because it takes work off your plate if it sells out quickly – and costs you less.**
- **Don’t be cheap... but control your costs!** Especially in small run mailers. Format – page size – heavier paper. Have a much tighter targeted mailer. Get rid of the names of people who don’t fit the perfect client profile.
- **Some exceptional places to get marketing ideas:** www.OrientalTrading.com (a great source of inexpensive “grabbers” for your mailings. Or www.PlumParty.com for a little higher end grabber (or bonus product). **Last, www.promoprofits.com GETS direct mail and has an exceptional program in place**

If you need help with getting started I recommend taking, The Sales Letter Success Workshop and Home Study Course! For a very minimal investment, you can learn exactly how to create sales letters that sell.

Visit: <http://saleslettersuccess.com/homestudy.html> to get more information about this program! My other clients have had great success with this course:

"A great handout package and resources kit - lots of unique and inspiring marketing techniques. You always deliver more than you promise! Thanks Troy." - Kim Palmer

"Huge volume of useful material. Great value Troy!" - Ann Stewart

I can craft you a sales letter to tie into your campaign. Warning though: I require 6 weeks in advance to complete a project like this - or a rush charge does apply. My minimum project fee for writing a campaign is now \$6,000. (I do not do one-off letters anymore; better results are attained by a consistent marketing system that keeps in touch with your customers on a regular basis). Consider it the wisest investment you can make in creating a sales system that will continue to make you money for many years to come. If that is out of your budget, let me know and I will refer some other writers to you.

Please put this into ACTION! It is the easiest way possible to grow your business by 130% OR MORE in the next 90 days or less.

Take everything that you now know about your business and industry... and find a way to recreate the way your clients buy from you and hear from you.

It will make a major difference in the types of clients that buy from you... and from the amount of money you make from the same amount of time being put into your business.

Last, remember the McGraw Hill study. I know you would much prefer growing your business by 256% over 19%... **and more effective marketing is the key.**

No matter what the economy is doing, more marketing will always improve your bottom line results... when it is done right.

Take the lessons in this and FIND WAYS to make them fit your own business.

They can easily add some serious dollars to your bank account... IF YOU USE THEM. They don't magically add millions to your pockets... YOU have to do something with them.

Once you do, and you start seeing results, reinvest the additional revenues right away into more marketing, bigger marketing, better marketing. You will easily come out of this recession an entirely new company with a serious surge of cash.

To your success,
Troy White
403-259-4566

24 Ways You Can Use The Cash Flow Calendar and Sales Letters or Emails Combined... To Attract More Clients and Improve Your Cash Flow

1. Eliminate the need for cold calls – the letters do the work for you
2. Get referrals from your existing clients and contacts
3. Covert your letter to a 2 or 3 column display ad – leverage existing marketing dollars
4. Create retail traffic with simple mailings
5. Create website traffic
6. Sell direct to consumers without any middlemen
7. Reduce refunds
8. Build anticipation for upcoming product launches
9. Find joint venture partners
10. Endorsed mailouts
11. Email campaigns that sell and educate
12. Web page sales copy
13. Product launches
14. Autoresponder sales campaigns
15. Phone script
16. Collect on outstanding bills
17. Get warm leads from “cold lists”
18. Fill seminars
19. Find distributors
20. Build an online database
21. Improve sales with eBay
22. Customer Appreciation events
23. Upsell your present customers on upgraded versions
24. Social Media updates extraordinaire! You’ve got enough ideas in here to keep your Facebook and Twitter feed busy for the next 365 days! Each of your posts can be sending traffic to your paid products or services – and they WILL make you sales when you are consistent!

*"Your last piece created over \$47,857 in revenues for us,
within the first 48 hours." - Joel Christopher*

WELCOME!

Let's get to 11 of the most important rules you need to stick to if you want to succeed in your marketing:

- . 1) **The purpose of your marketing is NOT to showcase your brand, your logo**, (it does not need to be for them to buy something, as it can be for them to take some kind of action like visiting a web page to get something for free)
- . 2) You **MUST** learn how to **create compelling offers that get them to take those actions**.
- . 3) **Each of the marketing campaigns you launch will consist of a minimum of 3 steps**. In other words, when communicating with your clients and prospects, you must send at least 3 different pieces to them in order to call it a properly designed campaign (and one that will actually work and help you achieve goal #1 from above)
- . 4) **No more cutesy sayings and vague one-liners** that say and do nothing that take you closer to goal #1. Again, a cute radio ad is useless if it doesn't generate you leads or make you money.
- . 5) You will **learn how to become a more natural writer**, and use those skills to further build on goal #1
- . 6) **Your personality in your marketing is your greatest asset**. Don't hide the fact that you are a real live person, like most business owners do. They try and mask the size of their company... pretending to be a big company. Putting your face and personality front and center in all your marketing will do more for your sales than anything else you do.
- . 7) Effective advertising **rarely looks like advertising**.
- . 8) **Effective advertising stops your ideal customer in their tracks** and literally forces them to start reading your ad.
- . 9) Effective advertising always has some form of **tracking mechanism in place** so you know exactly if it is working, or not. *My first few years into copywriting, I had logged 2,000 hours of writing and studying from the masters (I tracked my hours). Since discovering this thing called copywriting, I have a whole new world in front of me. I see why most businesses struggle. I see why people think marketing doesn't*

work. I see why most people think advertising is a waste of money. And I see why some companies go on and accomplish amazing things in record time. I have had the privilege to work with some incredible people, from all over the world. Movie stars. Bestselling authors. Public speakers. Inventors. Real estate investors and developers. Information publishers. All said and done, there are probably 35+ industries I have helped now. And have made them millions and millions of dollars in short periods of time.

Why do I share this with you? Because just 11 years ago I had no idea what marketing was or how it worked.

Today, I am an internationally-known entrepreneur who has helped thousands of people turn their businesses around.

Every week, my articles and blog posts go out to thousands of people spanning the globe. And I absolutely love seeing the look in a client's eye when they hit their first grand slam in marketing.

If I can do it, so can you. I failed English in high school and university. But I quickly discovered that real marketing doesn't care about proper grammar. As you will see in this chapter, real marketing breaks many of the rules of proper English.

Yet it works... and the results speak for themselves.

Looking forward to working with you. And I LOVE your comments... good and bad. Let me know what I can do to help you grow your business faster and more profitably.

Troy White "Turning Your Words Into Wealth" 403-259-4566

The Dale Carnegie Rules of Marketing Your Business Everyone knows Dale Carnegie...

A man whose legacy will live forever. A man who has changed millions of lives worldwide. And a man who has more of a grasp on the true art of marketing than many would ever recognize!

Having spent many hours there as a student and as a graduate assistant, I felt compelled to look back over his material and what I found astonished me.

If you want to market yourself or write effective copy - take heed in the following advice from Dale Carnegie himself. His book "How To Win Friends And Influence People" shares the following advice (*written in 1936 but as applicable today as back then*)...

*** **"First, arouse in the other person an eager want.** He who can do this has the whole world with him. He who cannot walks a lonely way" If they don't want what you sell - they won't buy it. You need to master the ability to showcase your product or service in a way that builds excitement and gets them passionate about buying what you offer.

*** **"Become genuinely interested in other people"** This actually should be first and foremost. If you don't understand who exactly your ideal buyers are... the rest of it is a waste of time.

But, when you dig deep into the profile of a buyer of your products, and you understand who they are, what average age they are, if they are married, single or divorced, if they have kids and what age, what books they read, movies they watch, and competitors they buy from... you won't be able to sell to them nearly as effectively as you could be.

FACE IT: the current economy has changed a lot of peoples buying preferences. They are holding off on purchases. They are making their decisions based on a new criteria, and they are definitely not buying like they used to. Do you know what the difference is with YOUR customers? You need to!

. *** **"Remember that a person's name is to that person the sweetest and most important sound in any language."** Always use YOU in the writing you do, and in the presentations you do for your clients.

One tip I give people in my classes is to take a sheet of paper and draw a line from top to bottom down the middle.

On the left side of the paper, count all the times you say "I", "me", "my", "us" or "our". On the right side of the paper, count all the times you say "you", "yours", "you'll", etc.

The references to "you" should outnumber the others by 8 to one MINIMUM. If you are talking about yourself that much, instead of talking about them, their needs, their problems they want solved, etc., you won't be getting nearly the response that you could! .

*** **"Become a good listener"** - potential clients don't want to hear about you and your company, they want you to listen to them, their problems, their dreams, their aspirations. Show them you understand this in your copy and they will listen then. .

*** **"Make the other person feel important"** - and do it sincerely- share with them how important they are now to you, to their friends, their family and the world

*** **"Get the other person saying yes, yes, yes immediately"**. What you don't want to do is get them started on a negative note answering things in their mind with the word NO. Show them how much you understand them, their problems, their deepest darkest desires for solving that problem.

Get them shaking their head yes, and leave them wondering how it is that you seem to know so much about them.

*** **"Make the other person happy to do what you suggest"**. If you can leave them with such an incredible feeling of self-satisfaction after they order... you have done your job right.

Better?

Give them an awesome story they could tell their friends, family, and loved ones that would leave them just as excited about the product they just ordered.

Get that across in your campaigns and you have done some amazing things that will show in your sales numbers!

Think about it – this advice is 75 YEARS OLD... and still is not being listened to by 90% of the small business owners out there.

Sad, but true.

If you could accomplish that in all your dealings with your clients - would you not be the leader in your field?

How many companies that you know of (and have bought from) actually apply even half of the above? 10%?

Make those your new mission in dealing with clients and see your profits soar this year - and your clients thank you beyond all belief for finally understanding their side of the equation!

To your success, Troy White

NOVEMBER 2013

Birthstone: Topaz or Aquamarine

Birth Flower: Chrysanthemum

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Drum Month

I Am So Thankful Month

National Inspirational Role Models Month

Family Story Month

National Roasting Month

Christmas Seal's Month

National Peanut Butter Lovers Month

Hospice Month

National Novel Writing Month

Alzheimer's Disease Awareness Month

National Homeless Youth Month

Pancreatic Cancer Awareness Month

Aviation History Month

Aviation History Month

Adoption Awareness Month

Child Safety Protection Month

National Model Railroad Month

Native American Heritage Month

Real Jewelry Month

Peanut Butter Lovers Month

National Sleep Comfort Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: World Communication Week*/Dear Santa Letter Week / National Care Week / Medical Staff Services Week / Chemistry Week

Second Week: American Education Week / National Children's Book Week / National Hunger & Homeless Awareness Week / World Kindness Week

Third Week: National Game and Puzzle Week / National Bible Week / Lung Cancer Awareness Week

Fourth Week: National Geography Awareness Week / National Leftover Awareness Week / Better Conversation Week / Adoption Week / Family Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

Black Friday (Busiest Shopping Day)
Christmas Sales Cycle
NBA Opening Night
November Sweeps for Television

November 2013

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
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This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Oct 29, 2013 - Nov 4, 2013

Tue, Oct 29	Bring your Jack-O-Lantern to Work Day / Great Stock Market Crash (1929) / National Hermit Day / National Frankenstein Day
Wed, Oct 30	Mischief/Devil Night / International Orthopedic Nurse's Day / National Candy Corn Day / 1 st daily newspaper comic strip (1904) / War of the World Broadcast (1938)
Thu, Oct 31	Halloween / National Knock-Knock Joke's Day / National Magic Day / Books for Treats Day / Nevada Day / Harry Houdini, famous magician & escape artist dies / Carve a Pumpkin Day / National Increase Your Psychic Powers Day / Increase Your Psychic Powers Day
Fri, Nov 1	World Vegan Day / All Saint's Day / National Author's Day / Teach a Friend How to Homebrew Day / Mexico Day of the Dead Celebrations / 1 st Meteorological Forecast (1870) / National Plan Your Epitaph Day
Sat, Nov 2	National Deviled Egg Day / Digital Scrapbooking Day / 1 st radio broadcast (USA – 1920) / All Soul's Day / Look for Circles Day
Sun, Nov 3	National Sandwich Day* / Housewife's Day / Bean Day / Cliché Day / 1 st dog orbited earth (1957) / Daylight Savings Time Ends (US/Canada)
Mon, Nov 4	Use Your Common Sense Day / Waiting for the Barbarians Day / Machine gun patented (1862) / King Tut Day / National Candy Day

Nov 5, 2013 - Nov 11, 2013

Tue, Nov 5	1 st US patent for a car (1895) / American Football Day / Guy Fawkes Day / National Gunpowder Day
Wed, Nov 6	Guinness World Record Day / National Men Make Dinner Day / Motor car bumpers patented (1905) / Regan re-elected by a landslide (1984) / Election Day / Marooned Without A Compass Day / National Saxophone Day
Thu, Nov 7	Symbol for the Republican party (elephant) 1 st appeared (1874) / Canadian Pacific Railway completed (1885) / Hug A Bear Day / International Tongue Twister Day / Bittersweet Chocolate with Almonds Day
Fri, Nov 8	Dunce Day / Bram Stoker's (Dracula Creator) B-day / Cook Something Bold Day
Sat, Nov 9	National Young Reader's Day / Lost Sock Memorial Day / Chaos Never Dies Day / 1 st Jewish Knight (England – 1837) / Berlin Wall opened (1989)
Sun, Nov 10	Forget-Me-Not-Day / Gingerbread Day / 1 st long distance phone call w/o operator assistance (1951) / USMC Day
Mon, Nov 11	Bonza Bottler Day* / Remembrance Day / Veterans Day / "God Bless America" written by Irving Berlin, 1 st performed in 1938 by Kate Smith / Origami Day

Nov 12, 2013 - Nov 18, 2013

Tue, Nov 12	National Pizza w/the Works Except Anchovies Day / 1 st known photo of Loch Ness Monster taken (1933) / Grace Kelly's B-day / Chicken Soup for the Soul Day Young Readers Day
Wed, Nov 13	National Indian Pudding Day / Bra Patented (USA – 1914) / World Wide Web 1 st began (1990) / World Kindness Day / Sadie Hawkins Day
Thu, Nov 14	World Diabetes Day / Loose Up & Lighten Up Day / Operation Room Nurse Day / American Teddy Bear Day / Prince Charles's B-day / National Guacamole Day / National Pickle Day
Fri, Nov 15	American Recycles Day / I Love to Write Day / Teddy Bear Day / National Clean Out Your Fridge Day / 1 st rubberized raincoat (1747) / National Philanthropy Day
Sat, Nov 16	International Day of Tolerance / Love a Tree Day / Animal Day / Button Day / 1 st edition of New York Evening Post (1801) / Have a Party With Your Bear Day
Sun, Nov 17	World Peace Day / International Student's Day / Use Less Stuff Day / Take A Hike Day / Homemade Bread Day / Electronic Greeting Card Dar
Mon, Nov 18	Married to a Scorpio Support Day / Scooter invented (1897) / Mickey Mouse's B-Day (1928) / Use Less Stuff Day / Occult Day

Nov 19, 2013 - Nov 25, 2013

Tue, Nov 19	The Great American Smoke Out / Equal Opportunity Day / Have A Bad Day Day / World Toilet Day / National Fearless Day / Pop Tarts Created (1965) / National Blow Bagpipes Day
Wed, Nov 20	Name Your PC Day / Universal Children's Day / Absurdity Day / McDonald's made it's 50 billionth hamburger* / TV Pitchman Mr. Whipple dies – "Charmin Toilet Paper" (2007) / Beautiful Day
Thu, Nov 21	World Hello Day / World Television Day / National Adoption Day / National Stop the Violence Day / 1 st Hot-Air Balloon Flight (1763) / 1 st color newspaper supplement (1883) / False Confession Day / Great American Smokeout
Fri, Nov 22	National Family Volunteer Day / Start Your Own Country Day / John F. Kennedy assassinated (1963) / Antarctic Day / Go For a Ride Day
Sat, Nov 23	Your Welcome Giving Day / National Cashew Day / Eat a Cranberry Day
Sun, Nov 24	Celebrate Your Unique Talent Day / What Do You Love About America Day / Use Even if the Seal is Broken Day / Origin of the Species Published (1859) / Tie One On Day
Mon, Nov 25	Buy Nothing Day (environmentalists/concerned consumers buy nothing due to consumption) / Parfait Day / Wind-Up Car Patented / Andrew Carnegie's B-day

DECEMBER 2013

Birthstone: Turquoise or Topaz

Birth Flower: Narcissus or Holly

MONTHLY EVENTS:

National Write A Business Plan Month

Safe Toys & Gifts Month

National Tie Month

Bingos' Birthday Month

National Sign Up for A Summer Camp

Learn A Foreign Language Month

National Stress – Free Family Holidays Month

Spiritual Literacy Month

Hi Neighbor Month

Read A New Book Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: Recipe Greetings For the Holidays / Cookie Cutter Week / Tolerance Week

Second Week: National Hand Washing Awareness Week / Operation Santa Paws Week / Coats for Kids

Third Week: Human Rights Week / International Language Week

Fourth Week: It's About Time Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

Winter Activities* (Skiing/Snowboarding/Skating)

New Years Resolutions

Hanukkah

Good Samaritan Stories

December 2013

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Nov 26, 2013 - Dec 2, 2013

Tue, Nov 26	National Hockey League formed (1917) / Price of Right premiers (1956) / National Shopping Reminder Day
Wed, Nov 27	Pins & Needles Day / 1st Macy's Thanksgiving Day Parade is held (1924 – New York) / National Bavarian Cream Pie Day
Thu, Nov 28	Flossing Day / 1 st automobile race took place b/w Chicago & Waukegan, Ill. (1925) / 26 Shopping Days until Christmas / Thanksgiving Day US / Make Your Own Head Day / Red Planet Day
Fri, Nov 29	Black Friday / Square Dance Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / Electronic Greeting Card Day / You're Welcome Day
Sat, Nov 30	Computer Security Day / Stay at Home b/c You're Well Day / Winston Churchill's & Mark Twain's B-Day / Small Business Saturday
Sun, Dec 1	National Pie Day / Eat a Red Apple Day / Rosa Parks Day / World AIDS Day / Cyber Monday
Mon, Dec 2	National Day of United Arab Emirates / Special Education Day / Razor Blade patented (1901) / Neon Lighting introduced (1910) / National Fritters Day / Safety Razor Day

Dec 3, 2013 - Dec 9, 2013

Tue, Dec 3	International Day of Disabled Persons / National Roof Over Your Head Day / 1 st heart transplant (1967)
Wed, Dec 4	Extraordinary Work Team Recognition Day / Wear Brown Shoes Day / National Dice Day / 1 st CFL Grey Cup (1909) / National Cookie Day / Santa's List Day
Thu, Dec 5	International Volunteer Day / Bathtub Party Day / Prohibition repealed (USA – 1933) / Day of the Ninja
Fri, Dec 6	Miner's Day / Edison invents phonograph (1877) / 1 st taxicabs (London – 1897)* / National Gazpacho Day / National Microwave Oven Day / Put On Your Own Shoes Day / St. Nicholas Day
Sat, Dec 7	Cotton Candy Day / Encyclopedia Britannica Launched (1768) / Pearl Harbor Remembrance Day / International Civil Aviation Day / Letter Writing Day
Sun, Dec 8	National Brownie Day / Take it in the Ear Day / Henry Laurens is the 1 st cremation (USA – 1792) / International Children's Day
Mon, Dec 9	International Children's Day of Broadcasting / National Pastry Day / 1 st Christmas Card Sent */ Computer Mouse invented (1968) / Christmas Card Day

Dec 10, 2013 - Dec 16, 2013

Tue, Dec 10	Human Rights Day / Nobel Peace Prizes Awarded / Grateful Dead plays 1 st concert (1965)
Wed, Dec 11	International Mountain Day / National Noodle-Ring Day / 1 st yacht race across Atlantic Ocean (1866)
Thu, Dec 12	Poinsettia Day / National Ding-A-Ling Day / Bonza Bottler Day* / Golf Tee patented / Tide detergent introduced (1946) / Festival of Unmentionable Thoughts / National Ambrosia Day
Fri, Dec 13	International Shareware Day / Ice Cream Day / World's 1 st motor show (1984) / National Cocoa Day / National Violins Day
Sat, Dec 14	Tell Someone They Are Doing A Good Job Day / South Pole discovered (1911) / Nascar founded (1947) / Monkey Day / National Bouillabaisse Day
Sun, Dec 15	Bill of Rights Day / Cat Herder's Day / National Lemon Cupcake Day / Sitting Bull died (1890) / Basketball invented (1891)
Mon, Dec 16	National Chocolate Covered Anything Day / Beethoven's B-day (1770) / Boston Tea Party (1773) / Hanukkah / National Re-Gifting Day

Dec 17, 2013 - Dec 23, 2013

Tue, Dec 17	Clean Air Day / Underdog Day / National Maple Syrup Day / Wright Brother's fly (1903)
Wed, Dec 18	International Migrant's Day / Bake Cookies Day / Mohamed Ali's B-day / National Roast Suckling Pig Day / National Wear a Plunger on Your Head Day
Thu, Dec 19	Oatmeal Muffin Day / Christmas Crackers invented (1861) / Look for an Evergreen Day
Fri, Dec 20	Games Day / Jelly Beans 1 st made (1874) / Go Caroling Day / Mudd Day
Sat, Dec 21	Humbug Day / Look at the Brightside Day / National Flashlight Day / 1 st feature length color & sound cartoon premiers (Snow White – 1937) / Winter Solstice / Forefather's Day
Sun, Dec 22	Maritime Day / 1 st string of Christmas tree lights created by Edison (1882) / 1 st cloned pet born (2001) / National Date Nut Bread Day
Mon, Dec 23	National Roots Day / 1 st non-stop flight around the world (1986) Festivus / National Pfeffernusse Day

Dec 24, 2013 - Dec 30, 2013

Tue, Dec 24	Christmas Eve / Remember to Read the Instructions the 1 st Night Day (the night to assemble toys) / National Eggnog Day / Anniversary of Silent Night (1818) / National Chocolate Day
Wed, Dec 25	Christmas Day / National Pumpkin Pie Day
Thu, Dec 26	Boxing Day Canada / National Whiner's Day / FM radio patented (1933) / Federal Employees extra day off for Christmas / Kwanzaa (12/26-1/1 annually) / National Candy Cane Day
Fri, Dec 27	Visit the Zoo Day / National Fruitcake Day / Peter Pan on stage (1904) / Make Cut Out Snowflakes Day
Sat, Dec 28	Card Playing Day / Chewing gum patented (1869) / 1 st American test tube baby born (1981) / National Chocolate Candy Day
Sun, Dec 29	Tick Tock Day / National Chocolate Day Again / Barbara Streisand's 1 st recording at age 13 (1955) / National Pepper Pot Day
Mon, Dec 30	Festival of Enormous Changes at the Last Minute Day / Fountain pen invented (1656) / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / National Bicarbonate Of Soda Day

Dec 31, 2013 - Jan 6, 2014

Tue, Dec 31	New Year's Eve / Make Up Your Mind Day / General Motors Corp. becomes 1 st US corporation to make over \$1 Billion USD in a year (1955) / National Champagne Day

2014

January

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September

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October

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November

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December

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JANUARY 2014

Birthstone: Garnet

Birth Flower: Carnation or Snowdrop

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Creativity Month
International New Year's Resolutions Businesses Month
International Coffee Gourmet Month
National Hobby Month
National Soup Month
National Thank You Month*
National Get Organized Month
National Staying Healthy Month
National Egg Month
National Clean Up Your Computer Month
Hot Tea Month
Walk Your Pet Month
Adopt a Rescued Bird Month

National Book Blitz Month
March of Dimes Birth Defects Prevention Month
Cervical Health Awareness Month
Celebration of Life Month
Radio Month
Bath Safety Month
Eye Care Month
Oatmeal Month
Financial Wellness Month
Blood Donor Month
National Braille Literacy Month
Train Your Dog Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: Silent Record Week / Braille Literacy Week / Universal Week of Prayer / Women's Self Empowerment Week / Someday We Will Laugh About This Week

Second Week: National Bowling Week / National Pizza Week / National Book Week / National Thank Your Customers Week / Law Enforcement Training Week / Letter Writing Week

Third Week: International Printing Week / Jaycee Week / Worldwide Kiwanis Week / National Thrift Week / Activity Professionals Week / Special Education Week

Fourth Week: Mozart Week / National Meat Week / Catholic Schools Week / Celebrate Reading A Book Week / Health Awareness Week / International Kiwanis Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

New Years Resolutions (Weight Loss, Smoking Cessation)

Back To School (2nd Semester)

Vacation Planning (One of the busiest months for travel agents and cruise lines)

Football Playoffs (SuperBowl Upcoming, National Championships)

January 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
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5	6	7	8	9	10	11	
12	13	14	15	16	17	18	
19	20	21	22	23	24	25	
26	27	28	29	30	31		

Jan 1, 2014 - Jan 7, 2014

Wed, Jan 1	New Year's Day / Given birth date to refugees who are unable to document date of birth / United States Navy Seals established (1962) / Internet's Domain System created (1985) / Bonza Bottler Day / National Bloody Mary Day / National First Foot Day / Apple Gifting Day / Global Family Day / Polar Bear Plunge or Swim Day / Mummer's Parade
Thu, Jan 2	Happy Mew Year for Cats Day / Science Fiction Day / Run Up the Flagpole and See if Anybody Salutes it Day / National Buffet Day / National Cream Puff Day
Fri, Jan 3	Rock and Roll Hall of Fame inducts 1st female artist Aretha Franklin (1987) / Festival of Sleep Day / Fruitcake Toss Day / Humiliation Day / National Drinking Straw Day / National Chocolate Covered Cherry Day / Memento Mori Remember You Die Day
Sat, Jan 4	Free Flower Basket Day / Trivia Day / World Hypnotism Day / National Spaghetti Day / World Braille Day
Sun, Jan 5	1st National Hockey Association game (Victoria) (1912) / National Whipped Cream Day / National Bird Day
Mon, Jan 6	Joan of Arc's B-day (1412) Roman Catholic Saint & Heroine of France / Apple Tree Day / National Bean Day / National Shortbread Day / Cuddle Up Day / Epiphany
Tue, Jan 7	1 st US Presidential Election (1789) / Distress signal "COD" established only to be replaced 2 years later by SOS (1904) / International Programmers Day / National Old Rock Day / National Tempura Day / Harlem Globetrotters Day

Jan 8, 2014 - Jan 14, 2014

Wed, Jan 8	Elvis Presley's B-day / Rock 'n' Roll Day / First Computer Patented / National Joy Germ Day / Show & Tell at Work Day* / National English Toffee Day / Man Watcher's Day / Bubble Bath Day / World Literacy Day
Thu, Jan 9	StepFather's Day / Richard Nixon's B-Day (1913) / Dear Abby 1 st published (1956) / Play God Day / National Static Electricity Day / National Apricot Day / Panama's Martyr Day
Fri, Jan 10	Oil 1 st discovered in Texas (1901) / Peculiar People Day / Volunteer Fireman's Day / National Cut Your Energy Costs Day / Where's the Beef? Day* / National Bittersweet Chocolate Day / Houseplant Appreciation Day / Save the Eagles Day
Sat, Jan 11	International Thank You Day / National Step in a Puddle and Splash Your Friend Day / Milk Day / National Hot Toddy Day / Amelia Earhart Day / Learn Your Name in Morse Code Day / National Human Trafficking Awareness Day / Secret Pal Day
Sun, Jan 12	"All in the Family" premiered on CBS (1971) / Mystery writer Agatha Christie dies (1976) / National Pharmacist Day / Stick to Your New Years Resolutions Day / Feast of Fabulous Wild Men Day / National Marzipan Day / National Curried Chicken Day / National Glazed Doughnut Day / Golden Globe Awards
Mon, Jan 13	Rubber Duckie's Birthday / Frisbee Invented / Make Your Dream Come True Day / Blame Someone Else Day / National Peach Melba Day
Tue, Jan 14	National Dress-Up Your Pet Day / Henry Ford introduces the assembly line, for T-Fords / NBC's "Today" show premiered (1952)* / National Clean Off Your Desk Day / National Hot Pastrami Sandwich Day

Jan 15, 2014 - Jan 21, 2014

Wed, Jan 15	Champion of the Month Day / Hat Day / 1 st Superbowl Game (1967) / National Strawberry Ice Cream Day / Tu B'Shevat
Thu, Jan 16	Appreciate A Dragon Day / International Hot and Spicy Food Day / Religious Freedom Day / National Nothing Day / Comic strip "Superman" debuts (1939) / National Fig Newton Day
Fri, Jan 17	Benjamin Franklin's B-day / Pig Day / Customer Service Day / Judgment Day / Ditch New Years Resolutions Day / Kid Inventors' Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / National Hot Butted Rum Day
Sat, Jan 18	Winne The Pooh Day (A.A. Milne's B-Day) / Bill Clinton & Monica Lewinsky affair reported (1998) / Thesaurus Day / National Gourmet Coffee Day / Peking Duck Day
Sun, Jan 19	National Popcorn Day / Confederate Hero's Day / World's 1st women stockbrokers start in New York (1870) / 1 st Men's Briefs Sold (1935)
Mon, Jan 20	National Disc Jockey Day / National Buttercrunch Day / National Cheese Lover's Day / George Burns' B-day (1896) / Penguin Awareness Day / Martin Luther King Day / National Pot Luck Day
Tue, Jan 21	National Hugging Day* / The first Kiwanis Club was founded, in Detroit (1915) / New England Clam Chowder Day / Squirrel Appreciation Day / National Granola Bar Day

Jan 22, 2014 - Jan 28, 2014

Wed, Jan 22	Celebration of Life Day / National Answer Your Cat's Question Day / National Speak Up & Succeed Day / National Blonde Brownie Day
Thu, Jan 23	Food and Allergy Awareness Day / National Rhubarb Pie Day / National Handwriting Day / Rock & Roll Hall of Fame inducts 1 st Members (1985) / Measure Your Foot Day / National Pie Day
Fri, Jan 24	Belly Laugh Day / National Mentor Day / TV Game Show Day / National School Nurse Day / National Compliment Day / National Healthy Weight Day / Beer 1 st sold in cans (1935) / Beer Can Appreciation Day / National Eskimo Pie Patent Day / National Peanut Butter Day / National Change a Pet's Life Day
Sat, Jan 25	National Opposite Day / Observe the Weather Day / Burns Night / American gangster "Scarface" Al Capone dies (1947) / National Irish Coffee Day
Sun, Jan 26	Australia Day / National Peanut Brittle Day / World Social Forum Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday / Western Union discontinues use of Telegram service (2006) / Bald Eagle Appreciation Day / Spouses Day / Grammy Awards
Mon, Jan 27	Holocaust Memorial Day / Crapper Day (Thomas Crapper invents flush toilet)* / National Chocolate Cake Day / Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart B-day / World Leprosy Day / Bubble Wrap Appreciation Day
Tue, Jan 28	Better Business Communication Day / Elvis Presley's 1st appearance on TV (1956) / National Blueberry Pancake Day / National Kazoo Day / Have Fun at Work Day / Rattlesnake Roundup Day

FEBRUARY 2014

Birthstone: Amethyst

Birth Flower: Violet

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Boost Self Esteem Month

International Friendship Month

International Expect Success Month

National Weddings Month

National Time Management Month

National Snack Food Month

National Parent Leadership Month

National Wild Bird Feeding Month

National Cherry Month

American Heart Month

Great American Pie Month

National Grapefruit Month

Spay/Neuter Awareness Month

National Pet Dental Month

Unchain a Dog month

Responsible Animal Guardian Month

American History Month

Black History Month

Children's Dental Health Month

Responsible Pet Owners Month

Bake for Family Fun Month

Candy Month

Creative Romance Month

Library Lovers Month

Bird/Wild Bird Feeding Month

An Affair to Remember Month

Canned Food Month

Dog Training Education Month

National Prevent a Litter Month

National Cat Health Month

Adopt a Rescued Rabbit Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: Agricultural Week / Publicity for Profit Week / Burn Awareness Week / Women's Heart Week / School Counselor's Week / Consumer Protection Week

Second Week: Hero Week / National Crime Prevention Week / Celebration of Love Week / Flirting Week / Freelance Writer's Appreciation Week / Make Chatter Matter / National Marriage Week / Have a Heart for Chained Dogs Week (Feb 7-14)

Third Week: National Engineers Week / National Pancake Week / Random Acts of Kindness Week / Love Your Pet Week / National Nest Box Week / National Chip Week / International Flirting Week / National Justice for Animals Week

Fourth Week: National Eating Disorder Awareness Week / Pancake Week // National Pub Week / National Student Volunteering

Tax Preparation

Jan 29, 2014 - Feb 4, 2014

Wed, Jan 29	International Puzzle Day / Freethinker's Day / Carnation Day / National Corn Chip Day / Seeing Eye Guide Dog Day Birthday (1929)
Thu, Jan 30	Lone Ranger Debuted* / Escape Day / Insane Answering Message Day / Mahatma Gandhi Assassinated (1948) / National Croissant Day
Fri, Jan 31	National Backwards Day / 3M markets Scotch Tape (1930) / 1st TV soap opera, "These Are My Children," broadcast (1949) / US launched 1 st artificial satellite Explorer 1 (1958) / Inspire Your Heart With Art Day / Chinese New Year / Brandy Alexander Day
Sat, Feb 1	Bubble Gum Day / National Freedom Day / Give Kid's A Smile Day / Spunky Old Broads Day / Women's Heart Health Day / National Serpent Day / National Baked Alaska Day
Sun, Feb 2	Groundhog Day / Self Renewal Day / Bonza Bottler Day* / Heavenly Hash Day & Super Bowl / Candlemas / The Feast of Purification Day / Sled Dog Day
Mon, Feb 3	UNICEF Day for Change / National Carrot Cake Day / Four Chaplain's Memorial Day / Buddy Holly dies in plane crash (1959) / National Cordova Ice Worm Day / The Day The Music Died Day
Tue, Feb 4	World Cancer Day / Across the Universe Day / Thank a Mailman Day / National Stuffed Mushroom Day / Snicker's Candy Bar 1 st sold / Rosa Park's B-Day (1913) / National Create A Vacuum Day / Homemade Soup Day

Feb 5, 2014 - Feb 11, 2014

Wed, Feb 5	National Weatherperson's Day / Pancake Day / Disaster Day* / World Nutella Day / National Chocolate Fondue Day
Thu, Feb 6	National Girls & Women in Sports Day / Pay a Compliment Day / Bob Marley Day / Lame Duck Day / Waitangi Day / National Frozen Yogurt Day
Fri, Feb 7	Wave all your fingers at your Neighbor Day / Beatles arrive in NY for 1 st USA tour – starting of “The British Invasion” / Charles Dicken's B-day (1812) / Fettuccine Alfredo Day / Send a Card to a Friend Day / Olympic Games Opening Ceremony / National Wear Red Day
Sat, Feb 8	World Marriage Day / Laugh & Get Rich Day / Leadership Success Day / Kite Flying Day / Boy Scouts Day / National Molasses Bar Day
Sun, Feb 9	Toothache Day / Shoelaces Invented* / Joanne Woodward receives 1 st star on Hollywood Walk of Fame / National Bagels and Lox Day / Read in the Bathtub Day / Pizza Pie Day
Mon, Feb 10	Umbrella Day / 24 hour Tea or Coffee break / 1 st singing telegram debuted (1913) / WWII peace treaty signed (1947) / National Cream Cheese Brownie Day / Family Day (British Columbia)
Tue, Feb 11	National Inventor's Day / White T-Shirt Day / Don't Cry Over Spilled Milk Day / Satisfied Staying Single Day / Pro-Sports Wives Day / Clean Out Your Computer Day / National Make a Friend Day / Peppermint Patty Day

Feb 12, 2014 - Feb 18, 2014

Wed, Feb 12	Abraham Lincoln's Birthday / Lost Penny Day / National Freedom to Marry Day / International Darwin Day / National Plum Pudding Day
Thu, Feb 13	Dream Your Sweet Dream Day / Final Peanut's comic strip ran – Charles Schulz dies next day at age 77 / Get a Different Name Day / National Tortellini Day / National Crab Ragoon Day
Fri, Feb 14	Valentine's Day* / Gold Heart Day / Read to your Child Day / Stop the Violence Day / Ferris Wheel Day / National Call in Single Day / Organ Donor Day / Pet Theft Awareness Day
Sat, Feb 15	International Childhood Cancer Day / National Flag of Canada Day / Jewellery Day / National Gum Drop Day / YouTube launched (2005) / Singles Awareness Day / National Hippo Day
Sun, Feb 16	Do A Grouch A Favour Day / Mule Day / "Ladies Home Journal" published (1833) / Nylon Stocking patented (1937) / National Almond Day
Mon, Feb 17	World Human Spirit Day / Random Acts of Kindness Day / My Way Day / "Newsweek Magazine" published (1933) / National Champion Crab Races Day / President's Day / Louis Riel Day (Manitoba) / Islander Day (Pr.Edward I) / Family Day (AB, ON, SK) / Washington's Birthday
Tue, Feb 18	National Battery Day / Pluto Discovered / 1 st Academy Awards Announced (1929) / Drink Wine Day / National Cow Milked While Flying in an Airplane Day / World Whale Day

Feb 19, 2014 - Feb 25, 2014

Wed, Feb 19	National Sister & Girlfriend's Day / Chocolate Mint Day / 1 st prize inserted in Cracker Jack Box (1913) / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day
Thu, Feb 20	Toothpick Patented / Family Day / Love Your Pet Day / National Cherry Pie Day / National Hoodie Hoo Day
Fri, Feb 21	International Mother Language Day / National Sticky Bun Day / 1 st Telephone Book issued* / Malcolm X assassinated at age 39 (1965) / Card Reading Day
Sat, Feb 22	World Thinking Day / Be Humble Day / Woolworths 1 st opens (1879) / 1 st Color Photo Taken (1890)* / Pop Artist Andy Warhol dies at 58 (1987) / National Margarita Day / Walking the Dog Day / George Washington's Birthday
Sun, Feb 23	Curling is Cool Day / National Banana Bread Day* / Tootsie Roll introduced (1896) / International Dog Biscuit Appreciation Day / Daytona 500 / Play Tennis Day
Mon, Feb 24	Open That Bottle Day / National Artist Day (Thailand) / National Mexico Flag Day / National Tortilla Chip Day
Tue, Feb 25	Quiet Day / People Power Day (Philippines) / Samuel Colt patents the revolver (1836) / National Chocolate Covered Nuts Day / National Pistol Patent Day / World Spay Day

MARCH 2014

Birthstone: Aquamarine

Birth Flower: Daffodil

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Idea's Month	Woman's History Month
National Social Worker's Month	Youth Art Month
National Craft Month	Optimism Month
National Frozen Food Month	Spiritual Awareness Month
National Caffeine Awareness Month	Irish-American Month
National Noodle Month	Youth Science Month
National Nutritional Month	Humorists Are Artists Month
American Red Cross Month	Peanut Month
Music in our Schools Month	National Bed Month
Adopt a Rescued Guinea Pig Month	National Dolphin Awareness Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: Read an E-Book Week / American Camping Week / Canada Pharmacy Awareness Week / Lutheran Schools Week / Sherlock Holmes Week / Pet Sitters Week (Mar 3-9) / National Invasive Species Awareness Week

Second Week: Bubble Gum Week / Chocolate Week / Girl Scout Week / Crochet Week / Procrastination Week / Endometriosis Awareness Week / Fair Trade Week / National Science Week / National Aardvark Week

Third Week: National Wildlife Week / National Sports Trivia Week / National Spring Fever Week / Poison Prevention Week / Lavendar Week / National Obesity Awareness Week / Tree Love Care Week

Fourth Week: Art Week / Clean Your Closet Week / Egg Salad Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

First Day of Spring (Hardware, Gardening & Renovations)

Academy Awards (Oscars)

March Madness (NCAA Basketball)

March 2014

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Feb 26, 2014 - Mar 4, 2014

Wed, Feb 26	For Pete's Sake Day / Grand Canyon declared National Park / Johnny Cash (1932) & Jackie Gleason (1916) B-day's / National Pistachio Day / Tell a Fairy Tale Day / Carnival Day / World Pet Spay Day / Pet Spay Day USA
Thu, Feb 27	Inconvenience Yourself Day / International Polar Bear Day / Women's Right to Vote Day / US Black Churches Day / National Read Your Warranty Day* / National Kahlua Day / No Brainer Day / National Strawberry Day / National Chili Day
Fri, Feb 28	Floral Design Day / National Tooth Fairy Day / Salem Witch hunts begins (1692) / National Public Sleeping Day / National Chocolate Souffle Day / National Pancake Day
Sat, Mar 1	Be Positive – Do Something Day / Self-Injury Awareness Day / Peanut Butter Lover's Day / National Pig Day / Beer Day (Iceland – in 1989 beer was allowed again) / Employee Appreciation Day / National Sales Person Day / National Horse Protection Day
Sun, Mar 2	National Reading Day / Old Stuff Day / World Book Day / Dr. Seuss's B-day (1904) / "Time" magazine debuted (1923) / Silly Putty invented (1950) / National Banana Cream Pie Day / Academy Awards / Namesake Day
Mon, Mar 3	Bonza Bottler Day* / I Want You to be Happy Day* / Doll Festival (Japan) / National Doodle Day/ Alexander Graham Bell's B-day (1847) / If Pets Had Opposable Thumbs Day / National Anthem Day / Peach Blossom Day / National Cold Cuts Day
Tue, Mar 4	World Math's Day / Unique Names Day / International Scrapbooking Day / Courageous Follower Day / Holy Experiment Day / National Pound Cake Day / Hug a GI Day /Mardi Gras / Learn What Your Name Means Day / National Grammar Day / International Pancake Day

Mar 5, 2014 - Mar 11, 2014

Wed, Mar 5	Mother-in-law's Day / Multiple Personalities Day / National Salesperson Day / Parachute Invented* / Patsy Cline dies in plane crash at age 30 (1963) / National Cheese Doodle Day / National Absinthe Day / Ash Wednesday
Thu, Mar 6	Dentist's Day / 1 st time Oreo Cookies for sale (1912) / Walter Cronkite signs off CBS evening news for last time (1981) / National Frozen Food Day / National White Chocolate Cheesecake Day
Fri, Mar 7	World Day of Prayer / Middle Name Pride Day / Lassie's B-day / Monopoly Invented (1933) / Alexander Graham Bell Day / National Cereal Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / National Crown Roast of Pork Day
Sat, Mar 8	Fat Tuesday / International Woman's Day / Genealogy Day / No Smoking Day / World's 1 st game of snooker (1875 – India) / National Be Nasty Day / National Peanut Cluster Day
Sun, Mar 9	Cabin Fever Day / Panic Day / Get Over It Day / Barbie 1 st introduced (1959) / National Crabmeat Day / Joe Franklin Day
Mon, Mar 10	Salvation Army Day / Organize Your Home Office Day / 1 st Paper Money Issued (1862)* / Daylight Saving Time Begins (US/Canada) / National Blueberry Popover Day / Middle Name Pride Day / Commonwealth Day / International Day of Awesomeness
Tue, Mar 11	Check Your Batteries Day / Johnny Appleseed Day / World's 1 st Theatrical Striptease (Paris) / Middle Name Pride Day / National Worship of Tools Day / Plumbing Day / Oatmeal Nut Waffles Day

Mar 12, 2014 - Mar 18, 2014

Wed, Mar 12	Plant a Flower Day / National Baked Scallops Day / NHL Gordie Howie retires after 26 seasons (1972) / Girl Scouts Day / National Alfred Hitchcock Day / Registered Dietician Day
Thu, Mar 13	Good Samaritan Day / Uncle Sam debuts as a cartoon (1852) / Ear Muffs Day / National Jewel Day / Coconut Torte Day
Fri, Mar 14	Save A Spider Day / International Ask a Question Day* / National Potato Chip Day / Albert Einstein's B-Day / Learn About Butterflies Day / Pi Day & Bake a Pie Day / Popcorn Lovers Day / International Fanny Pack Day
Sat, Mar 15	Everything You Think is Wrong Day / Act Happy Day / True Confession's Day / Ides of March / Escalator Patented (1892) / Chatrooms debut on Internet (1974)* / National Pears Helene Day / Dumbstruck Day / Purim
Sun, Mar 16	Everything You Do is Right Day / Absolutely Incredible Kid Day / Freedom of Information Day / National Hiccup Day / Jerry Lewis's B-day / National Quilting Day / National Artichoke Hearts Day / Purim
Mon, Mar 17	St. Patrick's Day* / National Common Courtesy Day / National Boxers & Muay Thai Day / Rubber Band Invented (1845) / Absolutely Incredible Kid Day / Submarine Day / Holi / Buzzard Day
Tue, Mar 18	World Storytelling Day* / Awkward Moment's Day / Pillsbury Doughboy's & Sparky the Fire Dog's B-day's / Goddess of Fertility Day / Supreme Sacrifice Day / Oatmeal Cookie Day

Mar 19, 2014 - Mar 25, 2014

Wed, Mar 19	Act Happy Day / St. Joseph's Day / Swallow's Return Day/ National Chocolate Carmel Day / Marshal Wyatt Earp's B-day / National Poultry Day
Thu, Mar 20	Festival of Extraterrestrial Abductions Day / Companies that Care Day / Big Bird's B-day / Spring Equinox / National Ravioli Day / International Earth Day / Proposal Day / Snowman Burning Day / National Quilting Day / World Frog Day
Fri, Mar 21	National Astrology Day / Single Parent's Day / National Teenager's Day / Fragrance Day / World Poetry Day / "Who shot JR" aired – Dallas series (1980) / National French Bread Day
Sat, Mar 22	World Water Day / Act As Young As You Feel Day / International Goof-Off Day / Toast Day / International Day of the Seal
Sun, Mar 23	Administrative Professional's Day / National Organize Your Home Office Day / Near Miss Day / World Metrological Day / National Chip and Dip Day / National Puppy Day
Mon, Mar 24	World Tuberculosis Day / Chocolate-Covered Raisin Day / Elvis Presley's 1 st day in US army (1958)
Tue, Mar 25	Waffle Day / Maryland Day / Greek Independence Day / Pecan Day / Meteorite explodes in Wisconsin (1965) / Old New Year's Day

APRIL 2014

Birthstone: Diamond or Sapphire

Birth Flower: Daisy or Sweet Pea

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Customer Loyalty Month*	Pets Are Wonderful Month
National Garden Month	Couple Appreciation Month
National Humor Month	Financial Literacy Month
National Poetry Month	Soy Foods Month
Mathematics Education Month	Frog Month
Month Of The Young Child	Guitar Month
Jazz Appreciation Month	Welding Month
Alcohol Awareness Month	Car Care Month
Keep America Beautiful Month	Lawn and Garden Month
Records and Information Management Month	Pecan Month
Sexual Assault Awareness Month	Stress Awareness Month
Prevention of Animal Cruelty Month	National & International Pet First Aid Awareness Month
National Pet Month	Prevent Lyme Disease in Dogs Month
National Heartworm Awareness Month	

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: National Reading a Road Map Week / National Straw Hat Week /Egg Salad Week / Publicity Stunt Week

Second Week: Be Kind To Animals Week / National Garden Week / National Guitar Week / National Library Week / National Animal Control Officer Appreciation Week

Third Week: National Astronomy Week / Bike Safety Week / National Coin Week / National Police Week / National Volunteer Week / Consumer Awareness Week / Organize Your Files Week / Medical Labs Week / National Pet ID Month (April 21-27) / World Week for Animals in Laboratories / Animal Cruelty Awareness Week / World Laboratory Animal Liberation Week

Fourth Week: Forest Week / National Television-Free Week / National Karaoke Week / National Scoop The Poop Week / Volunteer Week / Parkinson's Awareness Week / National Bike to School Week / Administrative Assistants Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

Spring Projects (Hardware, Gardening & Renovations)

Master's Golf

Graduation/Prom

Baseball Opening Day

Tax Day, Passover

April 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
		1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30			

Mar 26, 2014 - Apr 1, 2014

Wed, Mar 26	Earth Hour / World Theater Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / Prince Kuhio Day (Hawaii) / Robert Frost's B-Day / National Nougat Day / Spinach Festival Day
Thu, Mar 27	Kite Flying Day / Quirky Country Music Song Titles Day / National Joe Day* / National Spanish Paelia Day / Manatee Appreciation Day
Fri, Mar 28	Something On a Stick Day / Respect Your Cat Day / National Black Forest Cake Day / 1 st Washing Machine Patented (1930) / Eggsibit Day
Sat, Mar 29	Festival of Smoke & Mirror's Day / National Mom & Pop Business Owner's Day / Oscar Mayer's B-day / Coca Cola invented (1886) / National Lemon Chiffon Cake Day / Smoke and Mirrors Day
Sun, Mar 30	Doctor's Day / I Am In Control Day / Pencil Day / Vincent Van Gogh's B-day / Take a Walk in the Park Day
Mon, Mar 31	Tater Day / Bunsen Burner Day / 1 st US Map published / Zip fastener patented (1896) / Eiffel Tower Day
Tue, Apr 1	April Fool's Day / National Sleep Day / One Cent Day / National Sourdough Bread Day / Palm Sunday / International Tatting Day / Dyngus Day / International Fun at Work Day

Apr 2, 2014 - Apr 8, 2014

Wed, Apr 2	World Autism Awareness Day / National Peanut Butter & Jelly Day / International Children's Book Day / Reconciliation Day / Every Day is Tag Day / National Ferret Day
Thu, Apr 3	National Find-A-Rainbow Day / Don't Go To Work Unless It's Fun Day / American Circus Day / National Tweed Day / World Pillow Fight Day / World Party Day National Chocolate Mousse Day
Fri, Apr 4	Tell-A-Lie Day / National Cordon Bleu Day / Dream Catcher Day / Bonza Bottler Day* / Hug a Newsperson Day / Walk Around Things Day
Sat, Apr 5	Go For Broke Day* / Bette Davis's B-day / Pocahontas marries John Rolfe (1614) / Read a Road Map Day / School Librarian Day / Walk to Work Day / National Caramel Day
Sun, Apr 6	Student Athlete Day / Twinkie's 1 st introduced (1930) / TV Dinner's introduced (1954) / National Caramel Popcorn Day / National Sorry Charlie Day / Plan Your Epitaph Day / National Tartan Day
Mon, Apr 7	World Health Day / Empowered Women Entrepreneur's Day* / No Housework Day* / Museum Day / Hug Day / Coffee Cake Day / National Beer Day / Everyday is Tag Day
Tue, Apr 8	All Is Ours Day / National Empanada Day / International Bird's Day / Buddha's B-day / Draw a Picture of a Bird Day / Zoo Lovers Day

Apr 9, 2014 - Apr 15, 2014

Wed, Apr 9	Name Yourself Day / 1 st Public Library Opens / Roller-skates 1 st worn (1760) / Cherish an Antique Day / National Winston Churchill Day / Vimy Ridge Day / National Bookmobile Day
Thu, Apr 10	National Siblings Day / Golfer's Day / Safety Pin patented (1849) / National Cinnamon Croissant Day / National Farm Animals Day / ASPCA Day
Fri, Apr 11	Eight Track Tape Day / Dandelion Day / National Cheese Fondue Day / Barbershop Quartet Day / National Submarine Day / National Pet Day
Sat, Apr 12	Thank Your School Librarian Day / International Yuri's Night (1 st human in space) / 1 st LP's produced (1904) / Big Wind Day / Look Up In The Sky Day / Russian Cosmonaut Day / National Grilled Cheese Sandwich Day / National Licorice Day
Sun, Apr 13	Blame Someone Else Day* / Peach Cobbler Day / 1 st flight over Mt. Everest (1933) / Scrabble Day / Thomas Jefferson's Birthday (1743) / Palm Sunday
Mon, Apr 14	National Pecan Day / Noah Webster copywrite's 1 st dictionary (1828)* / Abraham Lincoln assassinated (1865) / Ex-Spouse Day / Reach as High As You Can Day / International Moment of Laughter Day / Look up in the Sky Day / Passover / National Dolphin Day
Tue, Apr 15	Tax Day (US) / Rubber Eraser Day / Titanic strikes iceberg & sinks (1912) / 1 st McDonald's opens (1955) / Patriots Day / National Glazed Spiral Ham Day

Apr 16, 2014 - Apr 22, 2014

Wed, Apr 16	National Stress Awareness Day / National Eggs Benedict Day / Charlie Chaplin's B-day / Patriot's Day / National Wear Your Pajamas To Work Day
Thu, Apr 17	National Zoo Awareness Day / Daffy Duck debuts (1937) / John Bell, 115, receives new pacemaker (1997) / Blah, blah, Blah Day / National Cheeseball Day / Pet Owners Independence Day / National High Five Day / Lag B'Omer
Fri, Apr 18	Good Friday / National Animal Crackers Day / 1 st Crossword Puzzle Book published (1924) / 1 st Laundromat opens (1934) / National Wear Your Pajamas To Work Day / International Jugglers Day / National High Five Day / Pet Owner's Independence Day
Sat, Apr 19	Get To Know Your Customer's Day / Garlic Day / 1 st Boston Marathon (1897) / National Amaretto Day / Record Store Day
Sun, Apr 20	Easter Sunday / Pineapple Upside-Down Cake Day / 1 st Baseball Broadcast in Chicago (1946) / Lima Bean Respect Day / National Look Alike Day
Mon, Apr 21	Easter Monday / Kindergarten Day / School Librarian Day / National Chocolate Covered Cashews Day / World Creativity and Innovation Day / Boston Marathon
Tue, Apr 22	Earth Day (observed) / Jack Nicholson's (1937) & Steve Fossett's (1948-2007) B-day's / Girl Scout Leader Day / National Jelly Bean Day

Apr 23, 2014 - Apr 29, 2014

Wed, Apr 23	International Day of the Book / National Picnic Day / Take Your Daughter's & Son's To Work Day / Shakespeare's B-day & Death (1564-1616) / Lovers Day / Take a Chance Day / World Laboratory Day / Administrative Professionals Day / National Cherry Cheesecake Day
Thu, Apr 24	Teach A Child to Save Day / American Genocide Remembrance Day / National Pigs-In-A-Blanket Day / Executive Admin's Day
Fri, Apr 25	Day of Silence / Cuckoo Day / The name "America" 1 st used (1507) / Hug a Plumber Day / World Penguin Day / East Meets West Day / National DNA Day / National Zucchini Bread Day / Arbor Day / Hairball Awareness Day
Sat, Apr 26	Read Me Day / Hug An Australian Day / Pretzel Day / World Intellectual Property Day / National Richter Scale Day / National Kids and Pets Day / National Arbor Day
Sun, Apr 27	Tell A Story Day / South American Millipede found w/784 legs (1669) / Morse Code Day / Babe Ruth Day / National Prime Rib Day / Pet Parent's Day / Free Feral Cat Spay Day / World Veterinary Day / Save The Frogs Day
Mon, Apr 28	Costume Day / Kiss Your Mate Day / Dennis Tito 1 st space tourist by paying \$20 million (2001) / Cubicle Day / International Astronomy Day / National Blueberry Pie Day / International Guide Dog Day
Tue, Apr 29	International Dance Day / International Make-A-Wish Day / 1 st edition of Roget's Thesaurus published (1852) / Zipper Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / National Shrimp Scampi Day

MAY 2014

Birthstone: Emerald
Birth Flower: Lily of the Valley

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Victorious Woman Month	Heal the Children Month
International Business Image Improvement Month	Teen Self-Esteem Month
National Mental Health Month	Asian Pacific American Heritage Month
National Older Americans Month	Better Sleep Month
National Revise Your Work Schedule Month	Tennis Month
Clean Air Month	Better Hearing & Speech Month
Family Wellness Month	Physical Fitness & Sports Month
National Barbeque Month	Date Your Mate Month
National Bike Month	Foster Care Month
Blood Pressure Month	National Hamburger Month
National Salad Month	National Photograph Month
Go Fetch! Food Drive for Homeless Animals Month	National Recommitment Month
Be Kind to Animals Month	Chip Your Pet Month
National Pet Month	National Service Dog Eye Examination Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: National Fairy Godmother Week / Eat Dessert First Week / Teacher's Appreciation Week / National Safe Drinking Water Week / Deaf Awareness Week / National Pet Week (May 5-11)

Second Week: National Wildflower Week / National Family Week / National Nurses Week / Gamblers Week / National Pet Week (May 5-11) / Puppy mill Action Week (May 6-12)

Third Week: National Nursing Home Week / National Police Week / Work At Home Moms Week / National Running and Fitness Week / Bike to Work Week / National Dog Prevention Week (May 19-25)

Fourth Week: National Safe Boating Week / National New Friends, Old Friends Week / National Etiquette Week / Teacher Appreciation Week / Emergency Medical Services Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

May Sweeps & Season Finales for Networks (most important time for TV Stations)

Moving Month

Indy 500

Kentucky Derby

May 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
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4	5	6	7	8	9	10	
11	12	13	14	15	16	17	
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Apr 30, 2014 - May 6, 2014

Wed, Apr 30	National Honesty Day / Mr. Potato Head is 1 st toy advertised on TV (1952) / Hairstyle Appreciation Day / International Jazz Day / National Raisin Day / National Adopt a Shelter Pet Day
Thu, May 1	May Day / Frequent Flyer Day / Loyalty Day / Mother Goose Day / Save A Rhino Day / Global Love Day / MayDay for Mutts
Fri, May 2	National Public Radio Day / National Scrapbooking Day / "Good Housekeeping" is published (1885) / National Truffle Day / Scurvy Awareness Day / Baby Day / Brothers and Sisters Day
Sat, May 3	World Laughter Day / National Day of Reason / Paranormal Day / Join Hands Day / National Lumpy Rug Day / World Press Freedom Day / International Tuba Day / Space Day / Kentucky Derby / National Two Different Coloured Shoes Day / National Homebrew Day / National Specially-abled Pets Day
Sun, May 4	National PTA Day / Garage Sale Day / International Firefighters Day / Star Wars Day / National Candied Orange Peel Day / Bird Day / Renewal Day / International Respect for Chickens Day
Mon, May 5	Bonza Bottler Day* / Cinco de Mayo / Pilates Day / International Midwives Day / 1 st US Train Robbery (1865) / Channel No. 5 released (1941) / Oyster Day / National Hoagie Day / Oyster Day
Tue, May 6	World Asthma Day / No Diet Day / No Homework Day / Nurses Day / National Beverage Day / National Tourist Appreciation Day / National Crepes Suzette Day / National Teacher Day

May 7, 2014 - May 13, 2014

Wed, May 7	Child Care Provider Day / International Dawn Chorus Day / Kodak Camera 1 st for sale (1888) / National Tourism Day / National Roast Leg of Lamb Day
Thu, May 8	World Red Cross Day / No Socks Day / Have A Coke Day / Student Nurses Day / National Coconut Cream Pie Day / Iris Day / National Receptionist Day / National Animal Disaster Preparedness Day
Fri, May 9	World Fair Trade Day / National Night Shift Worker's Day / Provider Appreciation Day / 1 st outboard motor produced (1896) / National Butterscotch Brownie Day / National Lost Sock Memorial Day / National Public Gardens Day / Military Spouse Appreciation Day
Sat, May 10	Donate A Day's Wages to Charity Day / Clean Up Your Room Day / National Shrimp Day / Fred Astaire's B-day / National Astronomy Day / National Train Day / National Babysitter's Day / National Miniature Golf Day
Sun, May 11	Eat What You Want Day / Twilight Zone Day / Birth Mothers Day / International Migratory Birds Day / Mother's Day / Animal Disaster Preparedness Day
Mon, May 12	National Babysitter's Day / Limerick Day / International Nurses Day / International Awareness for Chronic Immunological & Neurological Diseases / Fatigue Syndrome Day / National Nutty Fudge Day / World Migratory Bird Day (12/13)
Tue, May 13	Race for the Cure Day / Frog Jumping Day / Star Trek's Final Show (2005) / National Leprechaun Day / National Apple Pie Day / National Fruit Cocktail Day / World Migratory Bird Day (12/13)

May 14, 2014 - May 20, 2014

Wed, May 14	Receptionist's Day / World's 1 st Picture Postcard (1872) / Anniversary of Lewis & Clarke Exhibition / National Buttermilk Biscuit Day / National Dance Like a Chicken Day
Thu, May 15	International Day of Families / Straw Hat Day / Peace Officer's Memorial Day / National Chocolate Chip Day / Dinosaur Day
Fri, May 16	Wear Purple for Peace Day / Biographer's Day / National Sea Monkey Day / True Beauty Inside Out Day / Liberace's B-Day / Love a Tree Day / National Bike to Work Day
Sat, May 17	World Telecommunication's Day / Pack Rat Day / 1 st Poodle Parlor Opens (London 1896) / National Cherry Cobbler Day / Endangered Species Day
Sun, May 18	Visit Your Relatives Day / Send An E-Card Day / I Am An American Day / Armed Forces Day / No Dirty Dishes Day / Fascination of Plants Day / National Cheese Soufflé Day
Mon, May 19	Victoria Day (Most Regions) / Stagecoach Day / Cultural Diversity Day / Friendship Day / Malcolm X's B-day / Lawrence of Arabia dies (1935) / Stepmothers Day / Boys and Girls Club Day / National Devil's Food Cake Day / Frog Jumping Jubilee Day
Tue, May 20	Neighbor Day / 1 st Modern Atlas issued (1570) / Be a Millionaire Day / Pick Strawberries Day / National Quiche Lorraine Day

May 21, 2014 - May 27, 2014

Wed, May 21	National Wait Staff Day / National Memo Day / Employee Health & Fitness Day / National Strawberries and Cream Day
Thu, May 22	Buy a Musical Instrument Day / National Moth Day / Johnny Carson's final appearance on Tonight Show (1992) / National Vanilla Pudding Day / Chardonnay Day
Fri, May 23	World Turtle Day / Lucky Penny Day / Bank Robbers Bonnie & Clyde ambushed & killed (1934) / National Taffy Day / National Wig Out Day
Sat, May 24	Tiara Day / Low Tide Day / "Mary Had A Little Lamb" published (1830) / 1 st Auto Repair Shop Opens (1899) / National Escargot Day
Sun, May 25	National Missing Children's Day / National Tap Dance Day / Fork Utensil debuted (1630) / International Geek Pride Day / National Wine Day / Indianapolis 500 / National Brown-Bag-It Day
Mon, May 26	National Sorry Day (Australia) / 1 st Motion Picture Projected Publically (Greece 1928)/ National Blueberry Cheesecake Day / Sally Ride Day / Memorial Day
Tue, May 27	World Day For Water / National Grape Popsicle Day / Billiards invented (1591) / Batman debuts in DC Comics (1939) / Sun Screen Day

JUNE 2014

Birthstone: Pearl
Birth Flower: Rose or Honeysuckle

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Men's Month	Professional Wellness Month
National Rose Month	Rebuild Your Life Month
Entrepreneurs Do It Yourself Marketing Month	Sports America Kids Month
Children's Awareness Month	World Infertility Month
Effective Communications Month	Caribbean – American Heritage Month
Gay and Lesbian Pride Month	Zoo & Aquarium Month
Audio Book's Month	People Skill's Week
Dairy Month	Candy Month
National Accordion Awareness Month	Fight The Filthy Fly Month
National Fresh Fruit and Vegetables Month	National Adopt a Cat Month
Adopt a Shelter Cat Month	Turkey Lovers Month
National Micro-chipping Month	Social Petworking Month
National Pet Preparedness Month	

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: National Business Etiquette Week / Telemarketing Awareness Week / Superman Week / Fishing Week / Pet Appreciation Week

Second Week: Families in Business Week / National History Days / Bathroom Reading Week / Hug Week / Men's Health Week / Email Week / Animal Rights Awareness Week

Third Week: Nursing Assistants Week / Meet A Mate Week / National Take Your Dog To Work Day

Fourth Week: Carpenter Awareness Week / Fish Are Friends, Not Food! Week / National Prevention of Eye Injuries Awareness

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

School is Out (Activities for Kids)

Graduation

First Day of Summer

US Open (Golf)

Wimbledon (Tennis)

NBA/NHL Finals

Weddings (known for the largest #'s of marriages that occur this month)

Gay Pride Celebrations (take place in honor of the Stonewall Riots)

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June 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
8	9	10	11	12	13	14	
15	16	17	18	19	20	21	
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29	30						

May 28, 2014 - June 3, 2014

Wed, May 28	National Hamburger Day / Golden Gate Bridge officially opens (1937) / Amnesty International Day / Slugs Return to Capistrano Day / Whooping Crane Day
Thu, May 29	End of The Middle Ages Day / International Jazz Music Day / Escalator Patented / Learn About Composting Day / International Coq Au Vin Day / Pink Flamingo Day
Fri, May 30	Senior Health & Fitness Day / Ice Cream Freezer Patented / Australian Dr. Lear yanks out 1 st teeth (1818)* / My Bucket's Got a Hole in it Day / Water a Flower Day / National Mint Julep Day / International Hug Your Cat Day
Sat, May 31	World No Tobacco Day / Brassiere invented (1914) / Poet Walt Whitman's B-day (1819) / Save Your Hearing Day / National Macaroon Day
Sun, Jun 1	Leave the Office Early Day / Dare Day / Pen Pal Day / Marilyn Monroe's B-day / Flip a Coin Day / National Go Barefoot Day / World Milk Day
Mon, Jun 2	Derby Horse Race 1 st held (1780) / Barnum ran 1 st major 3-ring circus (1835) / Radio Patented (1896) / I Love my Dentist Day / National Bubba Day / National Rocky Road Day / Leave the Office Early Day & Shavuot
Tue, Jun 3	Repeat Day / Donut Day / 1 st US Space Walk (1965) / Egg Day / Chimborazo Day

June 4, 2014 - June 10, 2014

Wed, Jun 4	Old Maid's Day / National Cheese Day / 1 st Personal Computer on Sale (Apple II – 1977) / Hug Your Cat Day / National Cognac Day / Applesauce Cake Day / National Running Day
Thu, Jun 5	World Environment Day / National Family Day / Robert Kennedy assassinated (1968) / National Gingerbread Day
Fri, Jun 6	Cancer's Survivor's Day / Teacher Day / Hunger Awareness Day / 1 st Roller Coaster opened / Bonza Bottler Day* / National Gardening Exercise Day / National Yo-Yo Day / D-Day / National Doughnut Day
Sat, Jun 7	Trial Technology Day / Canadian Rivers Day / VCR Introduced (1975) / Graceland opens to public (Bathroom where Elvis died is off limits – 1982) / Daniel Boone Day / National Chocolate Ice Cream Day
Sun, Jun 8	World Ocean Day / Name Your Poison Day / Banana Split Day* / 1 st Indoor Swimming Pool Opened / High heeled shoes introduced (1688) / Best Friends Day / National Children's Day / International Day of Action for Elephants in Zoo Day
Mon, Jun 9	Raggedy Anne & Andy Day / Donald Duck's Birthday / National Strawberry Rhubarb Pie Day / World Pet Memorial Day
Tue, Jun 10	Ball-Point Pen Patented (1943) / Saab produces 1 st car (1947) / Herb and Spice Day / National Iced Tea Day / National Black Cow Day

June 11, 2014 - June 17, 2014

Wed, Jun 11	National Hug Holiday / Kamehamecha Day (Hawaii) / Jacques Cousteau's B-Day / E.T. Premiers (1982) / Corn on The Cob Day / National King Kamehameha Day
Thu, Jun 12	Machine Day / Loving Day (Celebration of Interracial Marriage) / Magic Day / Anne Frank receives a diary for her 13 th B-day (1942) / Red Rose Day / National Peanut Butter Cookie Day
Fri, Jun 13	Kitchen Klutzes of America Day / National Lobster Day* / Alexander the great dies from over-eating (323BC)* / National Peanut Butter Cookie Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / Sewing Machine Day
Sat, Jun 14	Flag Day / World Blood Donor Day / Family History Day / World Juggling Day / Pop Goes The Weasel Day / Superman debuts in Action Comics (1938) / National Strawberry Shortcake Day / Belmont Stakes / World Sea Turtle Day
Sun, Jun 15	Nature Photography Day / Smile Power Day / Bug Busting Day / Benjamin Franklin discovers electricity (1752) / National Lobster Day / National Hollerin' Contest Day / World Juggler's Day / Father's Day
Mon, Jun 16	Mortician's Day / Fudge Day / Fresh Veggies Day
Tue, Jun 17	Eat Your Vegetables Day / Violin Day / National Badger Day / Iceland Independence Day / 1 st magazine to publish a photograph (1846) / National Apple Strudel Day / Bunker Hill Day

June 18, 2014 - June 24, 2014

Wed, Jun 18	International Panic Day / National Splurge Day / Autistic Pride Day / Checker Taxi puts 1 st taxi on streets (1923) / International Picnic Day / Go Fishing Day / National Cherry Tart Day
Thu, Jun 19	Garfield the Cat Day / 1 st official game of baseball (1846) / Book matches invented (1892) / Juneteenth / National Martini Day / World Sauntering Day
Fri, Jun 20	World Refugee Day / International Surfing Day / Ice Cream Soda Day / National Vanilla Milkshake Day / National Flip Flop Day / Take Your Dog To Work Day
Sat, Jun 21	National Aboriginal Day / International Go Skateboarding Day / Baby Boomer's Recognition day / World Vegan Day / Watermelon Seed Spitting Day / First Day of Summer / Cuckoo Warning Day / Summer Solstice / International Lambrusco Day / Take Your Dog to Work Day / National Dog Party Day
Sun, Jun 22	Stupid Guy Thing Day / Lady & The Tramp opened in theaters (1955) / National Chocolate Éclair Day / National Onion Rings Day / Great American Backyard Campout
Mon, Jun 23	United Nations Public Service Day / Wrong Trousers Day / Let it Go Day / Typewriter Patented (1868) / Canada's 1 st National Park Created (Banff – 1887) / 1 st SAT Exam (1926) / National Pink Day / Typewriting Day / National Columnists Day
Tue, Jun 24	Celebration of the Senses / UFO Day / Descendants Day / Museum Comes to Life Day / St. Jean Baptiste Day / Swim a Lap Day / International Fairy Day / National Pralines Day

JULY 2014

Birthstone: Ruby
Birth Flower: Water Lily

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Blondie and Deborah Harry Month

National Bikini Month

National Culinary Arts Month

National Tennis Month

National Ice Cream Month

National Grilling On the Old BBQ Month

National Make A Difference to Children Month

National Wheelchair Beautification Month

Unlucky Month for Weddings

National Dog House Repairs Month

National Bison Month

National Recreation and Parks Month

Anti-Boredom Month

Picnic Month

Women's Motorcycle Month

Cell Phone Courtesy Month

Family Reunion Month

Baked Beans Month

Hot Dog Month

National Blueberry Month

Adopt a Rescued Rabbit Month

Wild about Wildlife Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: Special Recreation Week / Freedom From Fear of Speaking Week / Be Nice To New Jersey Week

Second Week: National Therapeutic Recreation Week / Nude Recreation Weekend

Third Week: Rabbit Week / National Independent Retailers Week / Captive Nations Week / Hug Week / National Farriers Week / Coral Reef Awareness Week

Fourth Week: Single Working Woman's Week / National Salad Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

Summer Fun

Holidays/Vacations

Boating/Water skiing

British Open Golf

Baseball All-Star Game

Tour de France

July 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
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13	14	15	16	17	18	19	
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June 25, 2014 - Jul 1, 2014

Wed, Jun 25	Please Take My Children To Work Day / Log Cabin Day / National Catfish Day / LEON Day (LEON is NOEL backwards – 6 months till Xmas)* / National Strawberry Parfait Day
Thu, Jun 26	International Day in Support of Torture Victims / International Day Against Drug Abuse Day / National Columnists Day / Xmas declared federal holiday (1870) / Beauticians Day / National Chocolate Pudding Day / Forgiveness Day / National Handshake Day
Fri, Jun 27	National HIV Testing Day / Decided to be Married Day / World's 1 st ATM installed (London – 1967) / National Orange Blossom Day / Sunglasses Day
Sat, Jun 28	Paul Bunyan Day / Insurance Awareness Day / International Caps Lock Day / Ramadan / Great American Backyard Compout / National Tapioca Day
Sun, Jun 29	Chicken Wings Day / Remote Control Introduced (1964) / National Camera Day / Waffle Iron Day / Hug Holiday / National Almond Butter Crunch Day
Mon, Jun 30	Meteor Day / Last Day of the 1 st half of the year / Shades Day / Royal Canadian Mint introduces the \$1 coin (a.k.a the Loonie – 1987) / Social Media Day
Tue, Jul 1	Canada Day / Freedom from Fear of Speaking Day / International Joke Day / Financial Freedom Day / 1 st US Zoo Opened (1874) / Children's Art Day / National Creative Ice Cream Flavor Day / National Ginger Snap Day / America Zoo Day

July 2, 2014 - July 8, 2014

Wed, Jul 2	I Forgot Day / Ernest Hemingway shoots himself (1961) / 1 st Wal-Mart opens (Arkansas – 1962) / World UFO Day
Thu, Jul 3	Compliment Your Mirror Day / Stay Out of The Sun Day / Cigarette Lighter invented (1816) / Eat Beans Day / National Compliment Your Mirror Day / Disobedience Day / National Chocolate Wafer Day
Fri, Jul 4	Independence Day / National Country Music Day / Filipino-American Friendship Day / Hot Mail Email Service began (1996) / Sidewalk Egg Frying Day
Sat, Jul 5	Work-a-ohlics Day / Bikini 1 st introduced (1806) / Salvation Army founded (1865) / Spam (luncheon meat) introduced (1937) / National Graham Cracker Day
Sun, Jul 6	Take Your Webmaster to Lunch Day / International Children's Games / National Fried Chicken Day / Build a Scarecrow Day
Mon, Jul 7	Chocolate Day / Bonza Bottler Day* / Pinocchio 1 st printed (1883) / Sliced Bread is sold for 1 st time (1928) / Tell the Truth Day / Macaroni Day / National Strawberry Sundae Day
Tue, Jul 8	Ice Cream Sundae 1 st introduced (1881)* / Wall Street premieres (1889) / World's 1 st supermarket opens (USA – 1912) / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / Don't Put All Your Eggs in One Omelet Day / Video Game Day / Chocolate with Almonds Day

July 9, 2014 - July 15, 2014

Wed, Jul 9	Don't Step on a Bee Day / Doughnut is patented (1872) / National Sugar Cookie Day
Thu, Jul 10	1 st Police Radio System Operated (New York – 1933) / World News Tonight premiers on ABC (1978) / National Clerihew Day / National Piña Colada Day / Teddy Bear Picnic Day / Don't Step on a Bee Day
Fri, Jul 11	World Population Day / National Cheer Up The Lonely Day / National Blueberry Muffin Day / All American Pet Photo Day / National Collector Car Appreciation Day
Sat, Jul 12	Hot Dog Day / Etch-A-Sketch introduced (1960) / Rolling Stone's 1 st concert (London – 1962) / Different Colored Eyes Day / National Pecan Pie Day / Simplicity Day / Cow Appreciation Day
Sun, Jul 13	Fool's Paradise Day / International Puzzle Day / Embrace Your Geekness Day / Vacuum Cleaner invented (1881) / Bean 'n' Franks Day / National French Fries Day / Barbershop Music Appreciation Day
Mon, Jul 14	Pandemonium Day / National Nude Day / Billy the Kid shot dead (1881) / US's \$500, \$1000, \$5000 & \$10000 bills are withdrawn from circulation (1969) / Bastille Day
Tue, Jul 15	Shark Awareness Day / Cow Appreciation Day / Gummi Worm Day / 24 hour all news - MSNBC - debuts on TV & Internet (1996) / National Respect Canada Day / Tapioca Pudding Day / National Get Out of the Doghouse Day / National Pet Fire Safety Day / I Love Horses Day

July 16, 2014 - July 22, 2014

Wed, Jul 16	National Out of the Doghouse Day / World's 1 st parking meter installed (Oklahoma – 1935) / National Corn Fritter Day / National Personal Chef Day World Snake Day
Thu, Jul 17	World Day for International Justice / Peach Ice Cream Day / Fingerprint 1 st used to ID (1858) / Disneyland Opened (1955) / Yellow Pig Day
Fri, Jul 18	British introduce voting by secret ballot (1872) / Crayola introduces scented crayons (1994) / National Caviar Day
Sat, Jul 19	Customer Appreciation Day / Count Dracula claims 1 st victim (1587) / 1 st Women's Rights Convention (1848) / National Daiquiri Day / National Flitch Day / National Raspberry Cake Day
Sun, Jul 20	National Lollipop Day / Robin Hood Day / Moon Day / Plastic invented (1866) / National Ugly Truck Contest Day / National Ice Cream Day
Mon, Jul 21	Carry Away the Clutter Day / Monkey Day / Robert Burn's B-day / National Junk Food Day / National Tug-Of-War Tournament Day / National Ice Cream Day
Tue, Jul 22	Hammock Day / Pied Piper arrives in Hamelin (1264) / National Ratcatcher's Day / Spoonerism Day

July 23, 2014 - July 29, 2014

Wed, Jul 23	Gorgeous Grandma Day / Pneumatic Tire invented (1888) / National Hot Dog Day / National Vanilla Ice Cream Day / Mosquito Day
Thu, Jul 24	Tell An Old Joke Day / Cousins Day / 1 st greeting telegram sent (Britain – 1935) / Amelia Earhart Day / National Tequila Day
Fri, Jul 25	System Administrator Day / Threading the Needle Day / 1 st flight over English Channel (1909) / Culinaricians Day / National Hot Fudge Sundae Day
Sat, Jul 26	Parent's Day / Aunt's & Uncle's Day / All or Nothing Day / Disability Independence Day / National Day of the Cowboy / National Dance Day / National Coffee Milkshake Day /
Sun, Jul 27	Take Your Plants for a Walk Day / Cocktail invented (Manhattan – 1928) / Bagpipe Appreciation Day / Walk on Stilts Day / Parents' Day / National Scotch Day
Mon, Jul 28	Accountant's Day / National Cowboy Day / National Milk Chocolate Day / World War began (1914) / Parents Day / Eid Al-Fitr
Tue, Jul 29	Rain Day / National Lasagna Day / NASA established (1958) / National Cheese Sacrifice / Purchase Day

AUGUST 2014

Birthstone: Peridot

Birth Flower: Gladiolas or Poppies

MONTHLY EVENTS:

National Inventor's Month	Black Business Month
National Win With Civility Month	Get Ready for Kindergarten Month
National Golf Month	Happiness Happens Month
National Eye Exam Month	Spinal Muscular Atrophy Awareness Month
National Back to School Month	Romance Awareness Month
National Immunization Awareness Month	Women's Small Business Month
National Catfish Month	Family Fun Month
Water Quality Month	Peach Month
	National Picnic Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: World Breastfeeding Week / National Fraud Awareness Week / Sturgis Motorcycle Rally / Simplify Your Life Week / Shark Week (Aug 4-10)

Second Week: Don't Wait! Celebrate Week / Psychic Week / National Smile Week / International Dog Assistance Week (Aug 4-10) / Shark Week (Aug 4-10)

Third Week: Thanks For All The Gifts Week / Weird Contest Week / National Aviation Week / Friendship Week

Fourth Week: Be Kind To Humankind Week / Daniel Boone Day / National Bowling Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

Back To School

PGA Championships (Golf)

US Open Tennis

Moving Month

Tax-Free Sales Events

End of Summer

High School (fall sports & band practices begin across the USA)

August is the only month without a major (religious or federal official) holiday in the USA

August 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
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24	25	26	27	28	29	30	
31							

July 30, 2014 - Aug 5, 2014

Wed, Jul 30	Father-In-Law Day / Henry Ford's B-day / Jimmy Hoffa disappears (1975) / National Cheesecake Day
Thu, Jul 31	Cat Day (Spain) / 1 st World's Water Skis rode (Minnesota – 1912) / Mutt's Day / Jump for Jelly Beans Day
Fri, Aug 1	Girlfriend's Day / Respect for Parent's Day / Swiss National Day / World Wide Web Anniversary (1990)* / National Raspberry Cream Pie Day / Lughnasadh / International Beer Day / DOGust Universal Birthday for Shelter Dogs
Sat, Aug 2	Friendship Day / Hypnosis Day / Signing of the Declaration of Independence (1776) / 1 st US census conducted (1790) / National Ice Cream Sandwich Day
Sun, Aug 3	Kid's Day / National Chocolate Chip Day / National Watermelon Day / Pencil Eraser invented (1770) / Grab Some Nuts Day / Mustard Day / Sisters Day / Friendship Day
Mon, Aug 4	New Brunswick Day (New Brunswick) / Champagne Day / U.S. Coast Guard Day / Gestapo arrest Anne Frank (1944) / International Forgiveness Day / Heritage Day in Alberta / Natal Day (Nova Scotia, Pr. Edward I) / Civic/Provincial Day (Many regions) / British Columbia Day (British Columbia)
Tue, Aug 5	Twin Festival Day* / National Gymnastics Day / Martial Law imposed (Japan – 1882) / 1 st electric traffic light installed (Ohio – 1914) / Nelson Mandela jailed (1962) / Civic Holiday in Canada / Work Like a Dog Day / National Assistance Dog Day

Aug 6, 2014 - Aug 12, 2014

Wed, Aug 6	Peace Day / National Fresh Breath Day / National Salvadoran-American Day / Wiggle Your Toes Day / National Root Beer Float Day
Thu, Aug 7	Particularly Preposterous Packaging Day / Sea Serpent Day / National Lighthouse Day / National Raspberries in Cream Day
Fri, Aug 8	Happiness Happens Day / Bonza Bottler Day's Birthday* / Bodacious Bonza Bottler Day / 1 st Canadian Turtle Derby (1972) / National Zucchini Day / National Dollar Day / World Cat Day
Sat, Aug 9	International Day of the World's Indigenous People / National Polka Day / Exclamation mark invented / Book Lover's Day / National Rice Pudding Day
Sun, Aug 10	International Biodiesel Day / Lazy Day / Kool-Aid Day / S'mores Day / Smithsonian Institution founded (1846) / Spoil Your Dog Day
Mon, Aug 11	National Garage Sale / Son & Daughter's Day / Presidential Joke Day / Play in the Sand Day / National Raspberry Tart Day
Tue, Aug 12	Middle Child's Day / 1 st time 2 people in space (1962) / King George IV's B-day / Vinyl Record Day / International Youth Day / Julianne Fries Day

Aug 13, 2014 - Aug 19, 2014

Wed, Aug 13	International Left-Handers Day / National Underwear Day* / Alfred Hitchcock's B-day / National Filet Mignon Day
Thu, Aug 14	Marshmallow Lasting Day / National Creamsicle Day / 1 st Beauty Contest held (England – 1908) / National Navajo Code Talkers Day / World Lizard Day
Fri, Aug 15	Best Friend's Day / National Men's Grooming Day / National Relaxation Day / Panama Canal Opened (1914) / National Failures Day / Assumption Day / Lemon Meringue Pie Day
Sat, Aug 16	Stay Home With Your Kids Day / Bratwurst Festival / 1 st Department Store opens (1848) / National Rum Day / National Tell a Joke Day / International Homeless Animals' Day / National Roller Coaster Day / International Homeless Animals Day
Sun, Aug 17	National Thrift Shop Day / Sandcastle Day / David Crockett's B-day / National Vanilla Custard Day / National Homeless Animals Day
Mon, Aug 18	National Bad Poetry Day / Homeless Animal Day / National Person Chef's Day / National Soft Ice Cream Day
Tue, Aug 19	National Aviation Day / National Potato Day / 1 st American Soap Box Derby held (Ohio – 1934) / World Orangutan Day

Aug 20, 2014 - Aug 26, 2014

Wed, Aug 20	National Radio Day / 1 st plane to exceed 1800 mph/2897 kph (California – 1955) / Lemonade Day / World Mosquito Day
Thu, Aug 21	Senior Citizen's Day / Hawaii Statehood Day / Mona Lisa Stolen (1911)* / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / National Spumoni Day
Fri, Aug 22	Daffodil Day / Be an Angel Day / 1 st Movie Show (Australia – 1896) / National Tooth Fairy Day / National Take Your Cat to The Vet Day
Sat, Aug 23	National Sponge Cake Day / Rudolf Valentino dies (1929) / Ride The Wind Day
Sun, Aug 24	National Peach Pie Day / 1 st Women Jockey (England – 1804) / Panic of 1857 (most severe economic crises in US history – 1857) / National Knife Day / National Waffle Day / Vesuvius Day
Mon, Aug 25	Kiss & Make-Up Day / National Banana Split Day* / Yellow cab is founded (1910) / Whiskey Sour Day
Tue, Aug 26	Women's Equality Day / Pony Express Day / Cleopatra & Mother Teresa's B-Day's / National Dog Day / National Cherry Popsicle Day

SEPTEMBER 2014

Birthstone: Sapphire
Birth Flower: Aster or Morning Glory

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Self-Awareness Month	Women of Achievement Month
International Strategic Thinking Month	Organic Harvest Month
National Coupon Month*	Jazz Month
National Hispanic Heritage Month	Fall Hat Month
National Skin Care Awareness Month	Children's Good Manner's Month
National Courtesy Month	Self Improvement Month
Be Kind To Editors and Writers Month	Tiger Month
Million Minute Family Challenge	Hispanic Heritage Month
Reunion Planning Month	Baby Safety Month
Shameless Promotion Month	Library Card Sign-Up Month
Update Your Resume Month	National Guide Dogs Month
AKC Responsible Dog Ownership Month	Pet Health Insurance Month
Pet Smile Month	Senior Care Health Month
World Animal Remembrance Month	Happy Cat Month
Save the Koala Month	

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: National Childhood Injury Prevention Week / Self-University Week / Play Days / Popcorn Week / National Payroll Week

Second Week: Minority Enterprise Development Week/ National Assisted Living Week / Suicide Prevention Week:

Third Week: National Singles Week / National Clean Hands Week / National Love Your Files Week / International Women's E commerce Days / National Dog Week / National Farm Animals Awareness Week / Sea Otters Awareness Week

Fourth Week: Deaf Awareness Week / Religious Freedom Week / Banned Books Week - Celebrating the Freedom to Read / Dog Week / Adopt a Less Adoptable Pet Week / National Deaf Dog Awareness Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

NFL Opens

First Day of Fall

Fall premieres for Networks*

Ryder Cup (Golf)

Rosh Hashonah, Yom Kippur (Jewish)

September 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	
7	8	9	10	11	12	13	
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	
21	22	23	24	25	26	27	
28	29	30					

Aug 27, 2014 - Sep 2, 2014

Wed, Aug 27	Global Forgiveness Day / 1 st successful oil well drilled (Pennsylvania– 1859) / Just Because Day / National Petroleum Day / Banana Lovers Day
Thu, Aug 28	Crackers Over the Keyboard Day / Dream Day / UPS founded (Seattle – 1907) / National Cherry Turnover Day / Race Your Mouse Day
Fri, Aug 29	More Herbs Less Salt Day / Chop Suey Day (invented 1896) / Goodyear Tire Co. founded (1898) / Beatles perform last concert (San Francisco – 1966) / Lemon Juice Day
Sat, Aug 30	International Day of the Disappeared / National Toasted Marshmallow Day / Drinking chocolate invented (1656) / Frankenstein Day / National Holistic Pet Day / International Whale Shark Day
Sun, Aug 31	International Blog Day / National Trail Mix Day / Love Litigating Lawyers Day / Eat Outside Day
Mon, Sep 1	Liberty Bell arrives in Philadelphia (1752) / Emma M. Nutt Day / National No Rhyme (Nor Reason) Day / Labour Day (US/Canada) / National Cherry Popover Day
Tue, Sep 2	Fight Procrastination Day / National Beheading Day / U.S. Treasury Dept. established (1789) / National Blueberry Popsicle Day / V-J Day

Sep 3, 2014 - Sep 9, 2014

Wed, Sep 3	Welsh Rarebit Day / Wizard of Oz published (1900) / eBay founded (1995)* / Skyscraper Day / US Bowling League Day
Thu, Sep 4	Newspaper Carrier Day / Great Fire of London (1666) / Eat an Extra Dessert Day / National Macadamia Nut Day / National Wildlife Day
Fri, Sep 5	Be Late for Something Day / 1st Labor Day Parade (New York 1882) / 1 st Petrol Pump delivered (1885) / National Cheese Pizza Day / College Colours Day
Sat, Sep 6	Cigarettes made commercially (1843) / Star Trek debuted on TV (1966) / National Fight Procrastination Day / Read a Book Day / National Coffee Ice Cream Day / National Hummingbird Day
Sun, Sep 7	International Angel Day / National Feel the Love Day / Neither Rain Nor Snow Day / Google Commemoration Day / National Acorn Squash Day / Grandparents Day / Salami Day
Mon, Sep 8	Bold is Beautiful Day / National Pardon Day (President Ford pardoned Nixon for Watergate (1974) / International Literacy Day / National Pet Memorial Day / I'm on Top of It Day / National Hug Your Hound Day / National Iguana Awareness Day
Tue, Sep 9	Bonza Bottler Day* / Wonderful Weirdo's Day / Aunt's Day / Fire Extinguisher invented / National Teddy Bear Day / Weinerschnitzel Day

Sep 10, 2014 - Sep 16, 2014

Wed, Sep 10	Swap Ideas Day / Sewing Machine patented (1846) / 1,000 Boeing 747 jumbo plane produced (1993) / TV Dinner Day
Thu, Sep 11	Patriot Day / Remember Freedom Day / No News Is Good News Day / World's 1 st TV play (1928) / "I Want to Start My Own Business" Day / Make Your Bed Day / 911 Memorial Day / National Hot Cross Bun Day
Fri, Sep 12	Video Games Day / 1 st Steam Railway opened (Australia – 1854) / Cave paintings discovered (France – 1940) / National Chocolate Milkshake Day
Sat, Sep 13	Positive Thinking Day / National Fortune Cookie Day / National Defy Superstition Day / National Peanut Day / Snack a Pickle Time / Uncle Sam Day / Blame Someone Else Day
Sun, Sep 14	Typewriter Ribbon patented (1886) / Football pools launched (UK – 1922) / National Cream Filled Doughnut Day / Eat a Hoagie Day
Mon, Sep 15	International Sing-Out-Loud Day / International Eat an Apple Day / Wife Appreciation Day / Make a Hat Day / National Felt Hat Day / National Linguine Day
Tue, Sep 16	Stay Away from Seattle Day / Collect Rock's Day / National Student's Day / Women's Friendship Day / Step Family Day / "Miami Vice" premiers (1984) / Troy White's Birthday :O) / Mayflower Day / Mexican Independence Day / National Cinnamon Raisin Bread Day / National Play Doh Day / Working Parents Day / National Guacamole Day

Sep 17, 2014 - Sep 23, 2014

Wed, Sep 17	Citizenship Day / Jewish New Year Rosh Hashanah / Constitution Day / National Apple Dumpling Day
Thu, Sep 18	Royal Opera House opened (London – 1809) / Tiffany & Co founded (1837) / Greta Garbo's B-day / National Cheeseburger Day / Rice Krispies Treats Day / Emmy Awards
Fri, Sep 19	International Talk Like a Pirate Day / Mickey Mouse debuted (1928) / National Butterscotch Pudding Day
Sat, Sep 20	International Student Day / Big Whopper Liar Day / 1 st Cannes Film Festival held (1946) / National Punch Day / Oktoberfest
Sun, Sep 21	World Alzheimer's Day / World Gratitude Day / International Day of Peace / 1 st gift coupon introduced (New York – 1865) / NFL Monday Night premiers (1970) / International Rabbit Day / Miniature Golf Day / National Pecan Cookie Day / Puppy Mill Awareness Day / Responsible Dog Ownership Day
Mon, Sep 22	Dear Diary Day / National Hunting & Fishing Day / Elephant Appreciation Day* / American Business Women's Day / "Friends" TV series premiers (1994) / World Car Free Day / Fall Equinox / National Hobbit Day / National Ice Cream Cone Day / National White Chocolate Day / Responsible Dog Ownership Day / World Rhino Day
Tue, Sep 23	Billy the Kid 1 st arrested (1875) / 1 st movie becomes TV series "How To Marry A Millionaire" (1961) / National Checkers Day / National Dogs in Politics Day / Rosh Hashanah

Sep 24, 2014 - Sep 30, 2014

Wed, Sep 24	Energize Day / National Women's Health & Fitness Day / World's Longest Kiss recorded (17 days, 10.5hrs (1984) / National Cherries Jubilee Day / Schwenkfelder Thanksgiving / National Punctuation Day / National Bluebird of Happiness Day
Thu, Sep 25	National One Hit Wonder Day / 1 st IQ test devised (1905) / National Comic Book Day / Crab Meat Newburg Day
Fri, Sep 26	Love Note Day / National Good Neighbour Day / Native American Day / Johnny Appleseed's B-day / Yom Kippur / National Pancake Day / Shamu the Whale Day / Save the Koala Day
Sat, Sep 27	World Tourism Day / World Maritime Day / Ancestor Appreciation Day / 1 st Skyscraper opened (New York - 1932) / National Crush A Can Day / National Thank You Day / National Chocolate Milk Day / National Corned Beef Hash Day / Fish Amnesty Day / International Rabbit Day
Sun, Sep 28	World Heart Day / Ask a Stupid Question Day / Drink Beer Day / Strawberry Cream Pie Day / World Rabies Day / National Public Lands Day
Mon, Sep 29	US Army established (1789) / John D. Rockefeller becomes 1 st billionaire (1916) / Confucius Day / Happy Goose Day / National Coffee Day / National Poisoned Blackberries Day / Family Day
Tue, Sep 30	International Translation Day / Chewing Gum Day / Vacuum Cleaner patented (1901) / James Dean dies in car crash (1955) / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / National Mud Pack Day / National Hot Mulled Cider Day

OCTOBER 2014

Birthstone: Opal
Birth Flower: Calendula or Camellia

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Strategic Planning Month	Dental Hygiene Month
National Cookbook Month	Fire Prevention Month
National Cookie Month	Halloween Safety Month
National Roller Skating Month	Diversity Awareness Month
National Stamp Collecting Month	Women's Small Business Month
National Seafood Month	Dinosaur Month
National Arts & Humanities Month	Sarcastic Awareness Month
National Pizza Month*	Healthy Lung Month
National Gain the Inside Advantage Month	Health Literacy Month
World Blindness Awareness Month	Cosmetology Month
Computer Learning Month	Italian-American, Filipino-American & Polish-American Month
Awareness Month	Pharmacist Month
Breast Cancer Awareness Month	Applejack Month
Eat Country Ham Month	Domestic Violence Awareness Month
National Pet Wellness Month	Adopt a Dog Month
National Animal Safety and Protection Month	National Squirrel Awareness Month
National Pit Bull Awareness Month	Adopt a Shelter Dog Month
National Service Dog Month	Wishbones for Pets Month
Bat Appreciation Month	Feral Hog Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: National Newspaper Week / World Space Week / Customer Service Week / Squirrel Appreciation Week / Get Organized Week / National Walk Your Dog Week

Second Week: Pickled Pepper Week / National Pet Peeve Week / Home-Based Business Week / Mystery Series Week* / School Lunch Week / Teller Appreciation Week / Wildlife Week / Fire Prevention Week / Animal Welfare Week

Third Week: National Chemistry Week / National School Bus Safety Week / Build Your Business with Business Cards Week / Pharmacy Week / Wolf Awareness Week (13-19) / Pastoral Care Week / National Veterinary Technician Week

Fourth Week: World Rain Forest Week / National Business Women's Week / Celebrate Job Loss Week / Magic Week / National Get of Your Ass and Start Advertising Week

Fall Clean Up
NHL Opening Night
World Series/Baseball Playoffs
Winston Cup (Nascar Championship)

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
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Oct 1, 2014 - Oct 7, 2014

Wed, Oct 1	World Vegetarian Day / World Habitat Day / International Day for the Elderly / Scare a Friend Day / Homemade Cookies Day / Balloons Around the World Day / Fire Pup Day / International Raccoon Appreciation Day
Thu, Oct 2	Guardian Angel's Day / World Farm Animal's Day / Peanut's cartoon strip debuted (1950) / Gandhi's Birthday / National Custodial Worker Day / National Name Your Car Day National Fried Scallops Day / Yom Kippur
Fri, Oct 3	World Smile Day / National Diversity Day / Jelly babies invented (1870) / National Virus Appreciation Day / Techie's Day / Lee National Denim Day / National Caramel Custard Day / Butterfly and Hummingbird Day
Sat, Oct 4	National Gold Day / National Taco Day / International Toot Your Flute Day / National Vodka Day / National Frappe Day / Dussehra / St. Francis of Assisi's Feast Day / World Pets' Day / World Pet's Day
Sun, Oct 5	National Child Health Day / National Storytelling Day / International World Teacher's Day / International Walk to School Day / Do Something Nice Day / National Apple Betty Day / International Frugal Fun Day
Mon, Oct 6	Come & Take It Day / National German-American Day / Mad Hatter Day / National Noodle Day / Physician Assistant Day / World Habitat Day
Tue, Oct 7	Clergy Appreciation Day / Edgar Allen Poe dies (1849) / American Bandstand premiers (1957) / Motion Picture Association adopts film rating system (1968) / Bathtub Day / National Frappe Day / Bald and Free Day / Sukkot

Oct 8, 2014 - Oct 14, 2014

Wed, Oct 8	American Touch Tag Day / Great Chicago Fire (1851) / 1 st photocopier marketed (1907) / Children' Day / National Fluffernutter Day
Thu, Oct 9	World Egg Day / World Sight Day / Leif Erickson Day (celebrating 1 st European landing in North America) / Curious Events Day / Fire Prevention Day / National Moldy Cheese Day / Submarine-Hoagie-Hero-Grinder Day / World Post Day
Fri, Oct 10	Bonza Bottler Day* / World Mental Health Day / National Angel Food Cake Day / Potato Chips 1st made (1853) / King Tut's treasures photographed (1924) / National Cake Decorating Day / Universal Music Day / World Egg Day / Troy White's Daughters Birthday :O)
Sat, Oct 11	National Coming Out Day / It's My Party Day / Adding Machine patented / Saturday Night Live debuts (1975) / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / Take Your Teddy Bear to Work Day / International Day of the Girl / National Sausage Pizza Day / National Pet Obesity Awareness Day
Sun, Oct 12	International Moment of Frustration Day / Scream Day / Farmer's Day / International Moment Of Frustration Scream Day / National Gumbo Day / Cookbook Launch Day
Mon, Oct 13	Canadian Thanksgiving Day / National Kick Butt Day / 1 st paperback book published (1841) / International Skeptics Day / Columbus Day / National Yorkshire Pudding Day
Tue, Oct 14	Be Bald & Be Free Day / National Dessert Day / Peace Corp's B-day (1961) / national lowercase day / National Chocolate-Covered Insects Day

Oct 15, 2014 - Oct 21, 2014

Wed, Oct 15	Love Your Body Day / National Grouch Day / Support Your Local Chamber of Commerce Day / 1 st American fishing magazine published (1881) / National Mushroom Day / National White Cane Safety Day / National Chicken Cacciatore Day / Wishbones for Pets
Thu, Oct 16	World Food Day / National Bosses Day* / Dictionary Day / Department Store Day / Simchat Torah / National Liqueur Day / National Feral Cat Day
Fri, Oct 17	Sweetest Day* / National Edge Day / International day for the Eradication of Poverty / Al Capone convicted to tax evasion (1931) / Four Prunes Day / National Pasta Day / Wear Something Gaudy Day
Sat, Oct 18	Alaska Day / No Beard Day / Coca 1 st sold (1828) / Grand Ole Opry opens (1925) / Nintendo released (1985) / National Chocolate Cupcake Day / Sweetest Day
Sun, Oct 19	Evaluate Your Life Day / National Forest Products Day / Largest Mass of Gold found (1872) / National Seafood Bisque Day / Rainforest Day
Mon, Oct 20	Monster Mash Day / National Brandied Fruit Day / World Osteoporosis Day
Tue, Oct 21	National Babbling Day / Apple Day / Edison invents the light bulb (1879) / Count Your Buttons Day / National Pumpkin Cheesecake Day / Reptile Awareness Day

Oct 22, 2014 - Oct 28, 2014

Wed, Oct 22	Young Women's Day of Action / Toastmasters International Founded (1924) / Walt Disney World's 100-millionth guest (1979) / International Stuttering Awareness Day / National Nut Day / International Caps Lock Day
Thu, Oct 23	Television Talk Show Host Day / Mole Day / 1st heart transplant (Australia – 1968) / National Boston Cream Pie Day / Diwali
Fri, Oct 24	United Nations Day / World Development Information Day / International Bandanna Day / National Bologna Day / World's 1 st Plastic Surgery (1814) / Take Back Your Time Day / Good and Plenty Day
Sat, Oct 25	Micro-Oven Debuted (1955) / 1 st electronic watch on sale (New York – 1960) / Punk for a Day / Sourest Day / World Pasta Day / National Greasy Foods Day / Make a Difference Day*
Sun, Oct 26	Pan Am flies 1st transatlantic jet trip (New York to Paris – 1958) / 2 Gray Whales freed from ice (1966) / National Mule Day / Worldwide Howl at the Moon Night / National Mincemeat Day / National Pumpkin Day / Mother-in-Law Day / National Mule Day
Mon, Oct 27	Cranky Co-Worker's Day / Navy Day / Sylvia Path Day / James Cook's B-day (1728) / Emily Post's Birthday / Tell a Story Day / American Beer Day / Pit Bull Awareness Day
Tue, Oct 28	Plush Animal Lover's Day / Harvard College Founded (1636) / Statue of Liberty Dedicated (1886) / Wild Foods Day / Global Champagne Day

NOVEMBER 2014

Birthstone: Topaz or Aquamarine

Birth Flower: Chrysanthemum

MONTHLY EVENTS:

International Drum Month
National Inspirational Role Models Month
National Roasting Month
National Peanut Butter Lovers Month
National Novel Writing Month
National Homeless Youth Month
Aviation History Month
Adoption Awareness Month
National Model Railroad Month
Real Jewelry Month
National Sleep Comfort Month
Pet Diabetes Month
National Pet Awareness Month
National Senior Pet Month

I Am So Thankful Month
Family Story Month
Christmas Seal's Month
Hospice Month
Alzheimer's Disease Awareness Month
Pancreatic Cancer Awareness Month
Aviation History Month
Child Safety Protection Month
Native American Heritage Month
Peanut Butter Lovers Month
Pet Cancer Awareness Month
Wishbones for Pets Month
Adopt a Senior Pet Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: World Communication Week*/Dear Santa Letter Week / National Care Week / Medical Staff Services Week / Chemistry Week / National Animal Shelter and Rescue Appreciation Week (Nov 3-9)

Second Week: American Education Week / National Children's Book Week / National Hunger & Homeless Awareness Week / World Kindness Week

Third Week: National Game and Puzzle Week / National Bible Week / Lung Cancer Awareness Week

Fourth Week: National Geography Awareness Week / National Leftover Awareness Week / Better Conversation Week / Adoption Week / Family Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

Black Friday (Busiest Shopping Day)

Christmas Sales Cycle

NBA Opening Night

November Sweeps for Television

Winter Activities (Skiing/Snowboarding/Skating)

November 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
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30							

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Oct 29, 2014 - Nov 4, 2014

Wed, Oct 29	Bring your Jack-O-Lantern to Work Day / Great Stock Market Crash (1929) / National Hermit Day / National Cat Day / National Oatmeal Day
Thu, Oct 30	Mischief/Devil Night / International Orthopedic Nurse's Day / National Candy Corn Day / 1 st daily newspaper comic strip (1904) / War of the World Broadcast (1938)
Fri, Oct 31	Halloween / National Knock-Knock Joke's Day / National Magic Day / Books for Treats Day / Nevada Day / Harry Houdini, famous magician & escape artist dies / Carve a Pumpkin Day / National Increase Your Psychic Powers Day / Frankenstein Friday / National Caramel Apple Day
Sat, Nov 1	World Vegan Day / All Saint's Day / National Author's Day / Teach a Friend How to Homebrew Day / Mexico Day of the Dead Celebrations / 1 st Meteorological Forecast (1870) / National Plan Your Epitaph Day / National Deep Fried Clams Day / National Cook for Your Pets Day
Sun, Nov 2	National Deviled Egg Day / Digital Scrapbooking Day / 1 st radio broadcast (USA – 1920) / All Soul's Day / Look for Circles Day
Mon, Nov 3	National Sandwich Day* / Housewife's Day / Bean Day / Cliché Day / 1 st dog orbited earth (1957) / Daylight Savings Time Ends (US/Canada)
Tue, Nov 4	Use Your Common Sense Day / Waiting for the Barbarians Day / Machine gun patented (1862) / King Tut Day / National Candy Day / Election Day

Nov 5, 2014 - Nov 11, 2014

Wed, Nov 5	1 st US patent for a car (1895) / American Football Day / Guy Fawkes Day / National Gunpowder Day
Thu, Nov 6	Guinness World Record Day / National Men Make Dinner Day / Motor car bumpers patented (1905) / Regan re-elected by a landslide (1984) / Marooned Without A Compass Day / National Saxophone Day / National Nachos Day
Fri, Nov 7	Symbol for the Republican party (elephant) 1 st appeared (1874) / Canadian Pacific Railway completed (1885) / National Hug A Stuffed Bear Day / Bittersweet Chocolate with Almonds Day
Sat, Nov 8	Dunce Day / Bram Stoker's (Dracula Creator) B-day / Cook Something Bold Day / National Cappuccino Day / National Harvey Wallbanger Day
Sun, Nov 9	National Young Reader's Day / Lost Sock Memorial Day / Chaos Never Dies Day / 1 st Jewish Knight (England – 1837) / Berlin Wall opened (1989) / National Scrapple Day / International Tongue Twister Day
Mon, Nov 10	Forget-Me-Not-Day / Gingerbread Day / 1 st long distance phone call w/o operator assistance (1951) / USMC Day / National Vanilla Cupcake Day
Tue, Nov 11	Bonza Bottler Day* / Remembrance Day / Veterans Day / "God Bless America" written by Irving Berlin, 1 st performed in 1938 by Kate Smith / Origami Day / National Sundae Day

Nov 12, 2014 - Nov 18, 2014

Wed, Nov 12	National Pizza with the Works Except Anchovies Day / 1 st known photo of Loch Ness Monster taken (1933) / Grace Kelly's B-day / Chicken Soup for the Soul Day Young Readers Day
Thu, Nov 13	National Indian Pudding Day / Bra Patented (USA – 1914) / World Wide Web 1 st began (1990) / World Kindness Day / Sadie Hawkins Day
Fri, Nov 14	World Diabetes Day / Loose Up & Lighten Up Day / Operation Room Nurse Day / American Teddy Bear Day / Prince Charles's B-day / National Spicy Guacamole Day / National Pickle Day
Sat, Nov 15	America Recycles Day / I Love to Write Day / Teddy Bear Day / National Clean Out Your Fridge Day / 1 st rubberized raincoat (1747) / National Philanthropy Day / National Raisin Bran Cereal Day
Sun, Nov 16	International Day of Tolerance / Love a Tree Day / Animal Day / Button Day / 1 st edition of New York Evening Post (1801) / Have a Party With Your Bear Day / National Fast Food Day
Mon, Nov 17	World Peace Day / International Student's Day / Use Less Stuff Day / Take A Hike Day / Homemade Bread Day / Electronic Greeting Card Day / National Black Cat Day
Tue, Nov 18	Married to a Scorpio Support Day / Scooter invented (1897) / Mickey Mouse's B-Day (1928) / Use Less Stuff Day / Occult Day / National Vichyssoise Day

Nov 19, 2014 - Nov 25, 2014

Wed, Nov 19	The Great American Smoke Out / Equal Opportunity Day / Have A Bad Day Day / World Toilet Day / National Fearless Day / Pop Tarts Created (1965) / National Blow Bagpipes Day / International Men's Day
Thu, Nov 20	Name Your PC Day / Universal Children's Day / Absurdity Day / McDonald's made it's 50 billionth hamburger* / TV Pitchman Mr. Whipple dies – "Charmin Toilet Paper" (2007) / Beautiful Day / Great American Smokeout / National Peanut Butter Fudge Day
Fri, Nov 21	World Hello Day / World Television Day / National Adoption Day / National Stop the Violence Day / 1 st Hot-Air Balloon Flight (1763) / 1 st color newspaper supplement (1883) / False Confession Day
Sat, Nov 22	National Family Volunteer Day / Start Your Own Country Day / John F. Kennedy assassinated (1963) / Antarctic Day / Go For a Ride Day / National Cashew Day
Sun, Nov 23	Your Welcome Giving Day / Eat a Cranberry Day / National Espresso Day
Mon, Nov 24	Celebrate Your Unique Talent Day / What Do You Love About America Day / Use Even if the Seal is Broken Day / Origin of the Species Published (1859) / Tie One On Day / Fur Free Day
Tue, Nov 25	Buy Nothing Day (environmentalists/concerned consumers buy nothing due to consumption) / Parfait Day / Wind-Up Car Patented / Andrew Carnegie's B-day

DECEMBER 2014

Birthstone: Turquoise or Topaz

Birth Flower: Narcissus or Holly

MONTHLY EVENTS:

National Write A Business Plan Month

National Tie Month

National Sign Up for A Summer Camp

National Stress – Free Family Holidays Month

Hi Neighbor Month

Safe Toys & Gifts Month

Bingos' Birthday Month

Learn A Foreign Language Month

Spiritual Literacy Month

Read A New Book Month

WEEKLY EVENTS:

First Week: Recipe Greetings For the Holidays / Cookie Cutter Week / Tolerance Week

Second Week: National Hand Washing Awareness Week / Operation Santa Paws Week / Coats for Kids

Third Week: Human Rights Week / International Language Week

Fourth Week: It's About Time Week

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS TO FOCUS ON:

Winter Activities* (Skiing/Snowboarding/Skating)

New Years Resolutions

Hanukkah

Good Samaritan Stories

December 2014

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	
7	8	9	10	11	12	13	
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	
21	22	23	24	25	26	27	
28	29	30	31				

Nov 26, 2014 - Dec 2, 2014

Wed, Nov 26	National Hockey League formed (1917) / Price of Right premiers (1956) / National Shopping Reminder Day / National Cake Day
Thu, Nov 27	Pins & Needles Day / 1st Macy's Thanksgiving Day Parade (1924 – New York) / Thanksgiving Day US / National Bavarian Cream Pie Day
Fri, Nov 28	Flossing Day / 1 st automobile race took place b/w Chicago & Waukegan, Ill. (1925) / 26 Shopping Days until Christmas / Make Your Own Head Day / Red Planet Day / Black Friday / National French Toast Day / Sinkie Day
Sat, Nov 29	Square Dance Day / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / Electronic Greeting Card Day / You're Welcome Day / National Lemon Cream Pie Day
Sun, Nov 30	Computer Security Day / Stay at Home b/c You're Well Day / Winston Churchill's & Mark Twain's B-Day / Small Business Saturday / National Mousse Day
Mon, Dec 1	National Pie Day / Eat a Red Apple Day / Rosa Parks Day / World AIDS Day / Cyber Monday
Tue, Dec 2	National Day of United Arab Emirates / Special Education Day / Razor Blade patented (1901) / Neon Lighting introduced (1910) / National Fritters Day / Safety Razor Day / Giving Tuesday / National Mutts Day

Dec 3, 2014 - Dec 9, 2014

Wed, Dec 3	International Day of Disabled Persons / National Roof Over Your Head Day / 1 st heart transplant (1967)
Thu, Dec 4	Extraordinary Work Team Recognition Day / Wear Brown Shoes Day / National Dice Day / 1 st CFL Grey Cup (1909) / National Cookie Day / Santa's List Day / World Wildlife Conservation Day
Fri, Dec 5	International Volunteer Day / Bathtub Party Day / Prohibition Repealed (USA – 1933) / Day of the Ninja
Sat, Dec 6	Miner's Day / Edison invents phonograph (1877) / 1 st taxicabs (London – 1897)* / National Gazpacho Day / Microwave Oven Day / Put On Your Own Shoes Day / St. Nicholas Day
Sun, Dec 7	Cotton Candy Day / Encyclopedia Britannica Launched (1768) / Pearl Harbor Remembrance Day / International Civil Aviation Day / Letter Writing Day
Mon, Dec 8	National Brownie Day / Take it in the Ear Day / Henry Laurens is the 1 st cremation (USA – 1792) / International Children's Day
Tue, Dec 9	International Children's Day of Broadcasting / National Pastry Day / 1 st Christmas Card Sent */ Computer Mouse invented (1968) / Christmas Card Day

Dec 10, 2014 - Dec 16, 2014

Wed, Dec 10	Human Rights Day / Nobel Peace Prizes Awarded / Grateful Dead plays 1 st concert (1965) / National Lager Day / Dewey Decimal System Day / National Day of Animal Rights
Thu, Dec 11	Anniversary of the Statute of Westminster / International Mountain Day / National Noodle-Ring Day / 1 st yacht race across Atlantic Ocean (1866)
Fri, Dec 12	Poinsettia Day / National Ding-A-Ling Day / Bonza Bottler Day* / Golf Tee patented / Tide detergent introduced (1946) / Festival of Unmentionable Thoughts / National Ambrosia Day
Sat, Dec 13	International Shareware Day / Ice Cream Day / World's 1 st motor show (1984) / National Cocoa Day / National Violins Day / National Day of The Horse
Sun, Dec 14	Tell Someone They Are Doing A Good Job Day / South Pole discovered (1911) / Nascar founded (1947) / Monkey Day / National Bouillabaisse Day
Mon, Dec 15	Bill of Rights Day / Cat Herder's Day / National Lemon Cupcake Day / Sitting Bull died (1890) / Basketball invented (1891)
Tue, Dec 16	National Chocolate Covered Anything Day / Beethoven's B-day (1770) / Boston Tea Party (1773) / Hanukkah / National Re-Gifting Day

Dec 17, 2014 - Dec 23, 2014

Wed, Dec 17	Clean Air Day / National Maple Syrup Day / Wright Brother's fly (1903)
Thu, Dec 18	International Migrant's Day / Bake Cookies Day / Mohamed Ali's B-day / National Roast Suckling Pig Day / National Wear a Plunger on Your Head Day
Fri, Dec 19	Oatmeal Muffin Day / Christmas Crackers invented (1861) / Look for an Evergreen Day / National Hard Candy Day
Sat, Dec 20	Games Day / Jelly Beans 1 st made (1874) / Go Caroling Day / Mudd Day / National Sangria Day / National Fried Shrimp Day / Underdog Day
Sun, Dec 21	Humbug Day / Look at the Brightside Day / National Flashlight Day / 1 st feature length color & sound cartoon premiers (Snow White – 1937) / Winter Solstice / Forefathers Day / Kiwi Day
Mon, Dec 22	Maritime Day / 1 st string of Christmas tree lights created by Edison (1882) / 1 st cloned pet born (2001) / National Date Nut Bread Day
Tue, Dec 23	National Roots Day / 1 st non-stop flight around the world (1986) / Festivus / National Pfeffernuesse Day

Dec 24, 2014 - Dec 30, 2014

Wed, Dec 24	Christmas Eve / Remember to Read the Instructions the 1 st Night Day (the night to assemble toys) / National Eggnog Day / Anniversary of Silent Night (1818) / National Chocolate Day
Thu, Dec 25	Christmas Day / National Pumpkin Pie Day
Fri, Dec 26	Boxing Day / National Whiner's Day / FM radio patented (1933) / Federal Employees extra day off for Christmas / Kwanzaa (12/26-1/1 annually) / National Candy Cane Day
Sat, Dec 27	Visit the Zoo Day / National Fruitcake Day / Peter Pan on stage (1904) / Make Cut Out Snowflakes Day
Sun, Dec 28	Card Playing Day / Chewing gum patented (1869) / 1 st American test tube baby born (1981) / National Chocolate Candy Day
Mon, Dec 29	Tick Tock Day / National Chocolate Day Again / Barbara Streisand's 1 st recording at age 13 (1955) / National Pepper Pot Day
Tue, Dec 30	Festival of Enormous Changes at the Last Minute Day / Fountain pen invented (1656) / Make Up Your Own Holiday Day / National Bicarbonate of Soda Day

Dec 31, 2014 - Jan 6, 2015

Wed, Dec 31	New Year's Eve / Make Up Your Mind Day / General Motors Corp. becomes 1 st US corporation to make over \$1 Billion USD in a year (1955) / National Champagne Day
Thu, Jan 1	New Year's Day / Given birth date to refugees who are unable to document date of birth / United States Navy Seals established (1962) / Internet's Domain System created (1985) / Bonza Bottler Day / National Bloody Mary Day / National First Foot Day
Fri, Jan 2	Happy Mew Year for Cats Day / Science Fiction Day / National Buffet Day / National Run Up the Flagpole and See if Anybody Salutes It Day
Sat, Jan 3	Rock and Roll Hall of Fame inducts 1st female artist Aretha Franklin (1987) / Festival of Sleep Day / Fruitcake Toss Day / Humiliation Day / Memento Mori "Remember You Die" Day / National Drinking Straw Day
Sun, Jan 4	Free Flower Basket Day / Trivia Day / World Hypnotism Day / Spaghetti Day / Braille Day
Mon, Jan 5	1st National Hockey Association game (Victoria) (1912) / National Whipped Cream Day / National Bird Day
Tue, Jan 6	Joan of Arc's B-day (1412) Roman Catholic Saint & Heroine of France / Apple Tree Day / National Bean Day / National Shortbread Day / Epiphany

2015

January

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MARKETING TEMPLATES AND IDEAS YOU CAN USE

(tons more inside the 2014 Cash Flow Marketing Calendar Supplement)

Winter Festival Program (you can use this in any of the cold months – January/February/March etc. depending on your location)

Idea: Have your website decorated (much like Google does) with a winter theme. Or, if in a retail environment, have windows painted, or snowflakes pasted on windows, or have skis hanging in front window, or ice skates, etc. Your staff (again – if retail or restaurant) wearing winter clothing. Serve hot drinks. Offer snowman building contests, or have wooden cutouts of you with a snowman – offer free photos to be taken and mailed to them.

Themes to consider using: Hot Bonuses on a Cold Day, It's Snowing Special Prizes, Winter Wonderland of Savings, Meltdown to Spring Program, Ski Jump your Success this year, off Snow Day specials that give extra bonuses or incentives whenever it snows.

Consider using a cover letter much like this:

Dear Mother Nature,
Somewhere where it's hot blvd

From: Your name

THIS IS NO LONGER FUNNY!! We surrender – ENOUGH already. Please be advised that we no longer appreciate your sense of humor with our weather. Your funniest one yet – giving us 2 feet of snow on a recent Monday morning. Real funny. I loved driving to work that day, sitting in traffic for 3 hours, shoveling enough snow to make an igloo, and hurting my back in the process.

Due to your recent attitude towards us, we will be making your special prize available to another more deserving Mother (or Father). We know there are a lot of VERY deserving mothers and father out there, ones that really do appreciate us and enjoy seeing us happy (not buried in snow).

Also, we have canceled your order you recently placed with us for a _____, and would like to advise you that until you change your current weather attitude towards us, we will be unable to accommodate you any further. It is regrettable that such a letter was necessary, but again, we repeat – NOT FUNNY, AT ALL.

Best regards, (I hope you have a blizzard at your house today)

<name>
Business

And then use this as the next page:

Headline: Mother Nature's Loss is Your Gain...

Mother nature has been unnecessarily cruel to us this winter – and I want you to benefit from her nasty attitude.

As you saw on the previous letter, we are not impressed with her... but we are impressed with you.

In fact, as one of our best customers, we want to offer you a special Meltdown to Spring Program. During the month of February (or March) we are offering you a free membership into our Gold Star Program, exclusively for our best customers. When you become a member of our Gold Star Program, you get the following benefits:

- 1) Regular special offers and discounts – minimum of 10% off future purchases
- 2) Our monthly Gold Star Newsletter mailed directly to your home or office
- 3) Private members only parties – 3 times a year we will host a special party just for you. Come and meet new friends, get free food and drinks, be entertained by our fabulous _____ (band, magician, hypnotist, etc). And, for Gold Members only, there is a private viewing room that showcases our brand new products – you get them at special prices that are not available to anyone else
- 4) Hanging out with celebrities! Each party will bring in celebrities for you to mingle with, have your photo taken with, or even get their signatures. (some of the celebrities we have

- booked for the next 3 meetings are _____)
- 5) Birthday clubs. On your birthday, not only will we buy you lunch at our favorite restaurant, _____, we will also offer you a special deal only available to you on your birthday.

All you need to do to become part of the Gold Star Program is to _____. Try it out for the first year for free, and let us know your thoughts.

Mother nature does NOT get this program – nor will she be allowed to until she changes her current attitude towards us.

I hope this helps you warm up a little on a frosty day.

Here's to spring!!!

<name>

January – National Thank Your Customer's Month

Idea: According to the Direct Marketing Association, the #1 reason people stop buying from you is that they feel ignored or unappreciated. 83% of people who switched suppliers did so because they felt taken advantage of. The easy solution? SAY THANK YOU!

- 1) A personalized thank you card or postcard for every new client. Handwritten is even better (www.ThinkInkMarketing.com does hand addressing of envelopes, tear sheet mailings and personalized post it notes.)
- 2) Thank your clients anytime they give you feedback on your products, your services, or your customer service. If the feedback is negative - be thankful that they are helping you fix a problem in your business. If the feedback is positive - be thankful they took the time to let you know.
- 3) A thank you for repeat business. Send a thank you card or postcard to those who order any products or services you recommend. "Thank you for your trust in me" is all you have to say.
- 4) When customers refer you to their friends, family or associates. It takes a lot of trust in you for them to send over their personal contacts. And it is the best form of advertising you will ever get. You may even send them a small gift with your thank you card.
- 5) When they defect to the competition. As mentioned earlier, 83% of them will leave because they think you don't care. So, if it is too late and they have moved on - make sure you show them you DO care, and that you would do anything to get them back. Create some internal systems that notify's you when a certain amount of time has gone by and a customer hasn't bought. This flag that goes up when they haven't been buying on a regular basis will prompt you to stay in touch and hopefully win them back.
- 6) When they say no. One of the best things you can do when a potential customer says no to your proposal or sales pitch is to say thank you. Telling them you do care and still want their business in the future is a sure fire way to show them you are serious. Put them on your mailing list and make sure they stay up to date with your business. Newsletters are an exceptional way to keep them in your funnel and up to date with the success your existing clients are experiencing.
- 7) Send them a thank you note whenever they do say something that makes you smile. Send them something back that makes their day as well.

It truly doesn't take much to stand out to your customers. Saying thank you is a proven way to make sure they know you care. And a customer that knows you care, will remain a loyal buyer. The amount of time it takes is miniscule compared to the results you will see in return.

January 1st – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Bonza Bottler Day is an excuse to celebrate each month and happens when the day and date are the same (e.g. January 1 (01/01), February 2 (02/02), March 3 (03/03) etc. When the year also coincides with the number of the day and month (October 10, 2010) – this is even a bigger celebration known as Bodacious Bonza Bottler Day.

This day was created by Elaine Fremont in 1985 when she realized there were no repeat special occasions to celebrate once a month. She decided to give herself a reason to have a party and some fun each other. The proper way to celebrate these days are with a party – but if that is not possible – a person should at least wish other people a "Happy Bonza Bottler Day".

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special. For example:

For your first Bonza Bottler promotion, you might want to explain a bit of the story to your clients. Simply tell them that you want to celebrate something every month and couldn't figure out a better way to do it than celebrating Bonza Bottler days.

January Examples:

"Good Resolutions are like babies crying in church. They should be carried out immediately"- Charles M. Sheldon

"The gardening season officially begins on January 1 and ends on Dec 31" – Marie Huston

"To read a poem in January is as lovely as to go for a walk in June" – Jean-Paul Sartre

Ring Out The Old, Ring In The New,
Ring Happy Bells, Across the Snow;
The Year is Going, Let Him Go;
Ring Out The False, Ring in the True"
- Lord Tennyson Alfred

January 8th – Show and Tell At Work Day

Idea: Don't be afraid to ask your most satisfied customers to tell their colleagues, friends and/or family about your business. Create some exclusive service or benefits that they can "show and tell" to their friends. Create a friends and family email newsletter list that goes out to your best clients and offering sales and promotions before anyone else gets them. Make sure you create a link that allows them to forward your message to their friend or a website link that they can send offering the special offer. Soon, your special email list will grow as their friends will want in also.

January 9th – National Clean Off Your Desk Day

Idea: It's the New Year and perfect time to start tackling messy desktops. Desktop management is critically important to everyone's well-being as it makes it extremely difficult to concentrate on particular tasks when your desk is bombarded with piles of paper.

Let your clients know that you care about their physical, mental and psychosocial well-being. Tell them that you want to simplify their life and their office and find peace and comfort in their surroundings.

Grabber: a garbage bag to help them declutter, file folders (even logo these with your business information)

January 10th – "Where's The Beef" Day

Idea: In 1984, Wendy's Burger Chain aired it's "Where's The Beef" ad campaign today. It is now a catch phrase since used for the all-purpose phrase of questioning the substance of an idea, event or product.

The ad known as the "Fluffy Bun" featured three elderly ladies examining an exaggeratedly large hamburger bun topped with a tiny hamburger patty – the ladies amused each other with comments such as "it certainly is a big bun" and "it's a big fluffy bun". The main actress (Clara Peller) finally interrupts with an outraged voice "Where's The Beef". The phrase has been used in Presidential campaigns, numerous TV shows etc.; even though the advertising campaign ended in 1985 – "Where's The Beef" lives on.

Which leads to "Where's Your Beef" – do you have a campaign slogan? A slogan is a very important element for branding as it makes it easier to increase a consumer's retention rate and desire. Don't be confusing about your slogan – make it concise and precise. A slogan that takes up a whole sentence to convey your brand is less effective than a slogan with 3 or 4 words. The less words, the easier for people to remember.

According to AdAge.com, here are the top 10 slogans of the century:

1. Diamonds are forever (DeBeers)
2. Just do it (Nike)
3. The pause that refreshes (Coca-Cola)
4. Tastes great, less filling (Miller Lite)
5. We try harder (Avis)
6. Good to the last drop (Maxwell House)
7. Breakfast of champions (Wheaties)
8. Does she ... or doesn't she? (Clairol)
9. When it rains it pours (Morton Salt)
10. Where's the beef? (Wendy's)

January 14th - NBC's "Today" show premiered (1952)

On December 24, 2008, Jay Leno informed his viewers about his plan to host a 10 p.m. program every weeknight on the network, he joked that it would start "right after the last hour of the 'Today' show. The joke had some truth to it though, the 'Today' show (now expanding to four hours each weekday) held an hour primetime show in the evening for a holiday special called "Today Looks Back". The show counted down the year's top news stories, fascinating people etc. The special was an unusual way for NBC to fill in its holiday air time.

Idea: What can you re-package from 2013?

Take a look at your top selling products from the past year and put together a limited time re-bundled product for your clients. State the facts on why it was your most popular product of 2013 and the benefits and/or testimonials from your clients.

January 15th - "Happy Days" begins an 11 year run on ABC (1974)

Idea: Happy Days was one of the most successful series of the 1970's but when it ended – it became famous for another reason. Happy Days coined a new phrase called "jumping the shark". It now refers to a tipping point when a show's writers have run out of ideas. The last Happy Days episode, in which Fonzie literally jumps over a shark on water skis, signaled the creative collapse of the writers.

Are your clients out of ideas? Can you spark them with some new ideas to get their business going? Send them a list of things you can do for them to help get their business out of a rut. Let them know that you don't want to see them "jumping the shark".

Grabber: swimming goggles, a plastic shark toy, or a happy face sticker

January 21st – National Hugging Day

The most successful butcher doesn't sell meat!

Think about the butcher business – price is typically how they advertise and compete. Yet, most people will pay a little more if given a good reason to. If you are hosting a special dinner party – the price of the meat is not your main concern – it is what the end result of the meal is. If your guests rave about it being the best they have ever had – then you are happy. And are willing to pay a premium to guarantee the meal is the best they ever had.

A success story about a butcher.

10 years ago Lori Prokop scraped together her savings to attend a seminar being put on by Ted Nicholas (a direct marketing master and copywriting genius). She got his attention during the break and told him the story. Her and her husband had been struggling with the butcher shop (and almost to the point of closing the doors), as the entire parking lot was ripped up and unusable for 6 months – totally destroying their customer flow.

So how could she get more customers in?

Ted started asking some questions and found out that her husband was quite a tall man, and he loved to hug people as well.

Ted gave her the one single piece of advice
that turned their lives around almost immediately.

He said *"when you get back home – first thing I want you to do is call your butcher shop **"The Hugging Butcher"** – advertise it everywhere, new signs and all over your marketing. Use direct response style marketing and make that husband of yours the hugging butcher and have him stand at the front door and hug everyone that walks through – men, women and children."*

She followed Ted's advice to a T. Quicker than she ever could have dreamed – business was booming! People couldn't wait to visit the hugging butcher – business went through the roof (parking lot or not). Soon, they were able to raise the price and commanded the highest price in the market they served – and clients lined up at the door. After a few years they sold that business for a very large sum of money – **amazing what a simple differentiator can do for a business!**

Now she runs a multi-million dollar consulting business – teaching similar techniques to those that Ted teaches.

January 27th – Thomas Crapper Day

Idea: Thomas Crapper was said to invent the flushing toilet. However, it is still in debate whether he did or not.

He was definitely a plumber and operated two of the three Crapper plumbing shops in his life. Crapper does hold nine patents, four for improvements to drains, three for water closets and one for manhole covers and the last for pipe joints.

While Crapper may or not be the inventor of the product he is most associated with, he made a great contribution to England's plumbing history and still holds quite a legend.

When the World War I doughboys passed through England – they brought together Crapper's name and the toilet. They saw the words T.Crapper-Chelsea printed on the tanks and coined the slang "crapper" meaning toilet.

To find out more: <http://www.theplumber.com/crapper.html>

Regardless of the debate – you can still use this date to send out a letter to your clients, use a tag line of something like:

Are you flushing your money down the toilet?

Or feature your letter around things we take for granted (flush versus most of the world without flush). How has your product improved the lives of others etc. ?

Grabber: mini toilet, toilet paper made into coupon, flush handles

January 30th - Lone Ranger Debuted

Idea: Do you have some hidden talent within your company? Introduce some of your help to your clients – or more about yourself? Consider doing a "resume" of the skills of the person you want to introduce.

Grabber: Insert a black mask with the letter. Start your letter with the tag line (see letter below).

For a sample, I am including my letter that I sent with the above idea. Of course, you would have to develop it to work with your concept (I also included a black mask):

THOMAS CRAPPER & CO.'S Sanitary Specialities.



IMPROVED LAVATORY BASIN.

White Ware, fared with combined Overflow and
Waste, and 4 Standard Screw-down Valves... £ 10 6
Plated Fixings, Extra... 0 8 6



ELASTIC VALVE CLOSET.

No. 98—Valve Closet, with white china dish with gold
brass, and handle, white ware flanking rim base, 1 in.
supply valve, copper air regulator, complete as shown.

If with 12 in. valve	£3 9 6
" Ornamental Basin	" 0 3 6
" White and Gold Basin	" 4 8 6
" Bas. Enamelled inside	" 0 1 6
" Bas. fixed with Brass Top	" 0 0 3
" Bas. fixed with cast-iron in cabinet	" 0 3 9
" 6 in. outlet	" 0 7 9



IMPROVED SYPHON Water Waste Preventer.

Can fix 1 1/2 Gals. Branch Waste Pipes, with
Traps, Inlet Valve, and Siphoning Air Tubes,
and Brass Chain and Chain Pull... £ 1 6
Ditto, 2 gals. ditto... 1 3 6

50, 52, & 54, MARLBOROUGH ROAD, CHELSEA, LONDON, S.W.

The Lone Ranger Unmasked.... Local British Columbian Finally Bares All!

Dear Friend,

My name is Troy White and you have undoubtedly seen some of my newsletters I've mailed to you over the past few years.

Building a thriving, sustainable business is a passion and a hobby of mine.

I invest tens of thousands of dollars a year in my continuing education. I travel all over Canada and the US to attend seminars put on by some of the best entrepreneurs and business builders in the world. People who have generated hundreds of millions, some of them billions, in businesses and entrepreneurial ventures... a few of them like to share how they do it in a step-by-step manner.

**So when I find a certified genius in income creation
for Canadian businesses... I had to share.**

First, you must know that I personally am writing you this from Calgary, and would not miss hearing what Doug White is revealing on December 12th. In fact, I would climb over broken glass (or drive through Toronto) to be in that room, hopefully alongside you.

**As a business professional, you understand the power
of a single good idea when it is tested
and proven profitable.**

When you get the chance to create 10 or 20 profitable ideas, you can grow your revenues and profits very quickly.

In fact, I will make you a deal...

February 2nd – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

February Examples:

"Happiness is having a large, loving, caring close knit family in another city" – George Burns

"All, everything that I understand, I understand because I love" – Leo Tolstoy

"My wife and I have an exclusive relationship. We were invited to a Valentine's party and she excluded me."

Thirty days hath September,
April, June, and November.
All the rest have thirty-one
save February, with 28 fine
'til Leap Year makes it 29!

February 5th – Disaster Day

There are some dangers of making assumptions in your marketing and it can turn out to be a disaster day if you do.

It head me on the head like a ton of bricks... *assuming* your clients and prospects are educated about your area of expertise is costing you a ton of lost money.

As business owners and experts in our own fields we pride ourselves on knowing an extensive amount about our respective industries.

And THAT is the danger we face. When you know quite a bit about an industry - you forget that most people know nothing about it.

I gave a presentation to a group on how to find, create and structure joint ventures. Having done numerous joint ventures with clients in the past - I assumed (and we all know what happens when you ass-u-me things) that they at least knew what a joint venture was.

They had been in business for years... and had yet never even heard of the word - let alone understood how powerful it is for cash flow.

My assumption that they knew this - and my education on reality taught me 2 things that apply to your business.

1) Never assume your clients and prospects know much about your products. Educate them on what your product or service does for them (using testimonials as proof), educate them on ALL the practical uses for your product or service, educate them on all the bizarre uses of your product or service (you may just find another niche for your products), and educate them on why they should do business with you - over all of your competitors (great service and great people are not solid reasons to do business with you - everyone says that).

2) In my case - I was talking to business owners who SHOULD understand the basics of marketing (but didn't - joint ventures are a necessary staple in the marketers tool kit). So, as a business owner -make sure you study and learn how to market your business better. Marketing IS cash flow creation - nothing more and nothing less. When you know how to market your business - you make more money.

When you don't know how to market - you struggle with cash flow. So learn more - and make more.

Assumptions are deadly. Educate and learn. That is the key to your entrepreneurial success.

February 9th - The Shoelace was invented in 1790

Idea & Grabber: Think of all the different ways you could use a shoelace. You could attach one to the top of your letters and create a letter something like this:

Dear Customer,

Why have I attached a shoelace to the top of this letter? Actually there are two reasons I have done this:

- 1) The shoelace was invented on February 9th, 1790 and in celebration of this special occasion (a tool we all use every day of our lives) I wanted to share something with you.
- 2) As the letter you are about to read involves tying up some loose ends on my end for 2013, I thought it very appropriate as an attention grabber.

I need to apologize to you. In looking back over the past year, I noticed I was not in touch with you very often and I want to apologize for my mistake.

You see, 2013 was a great year and I thank you for that...but you were probably not informed about _____

February 14th - Valentines Day

Idea: Southwest Airlines specializes in promotions around love. They have a Luvlines newsletter for employees (shareholders) and for customers. They give away love themed stickers, peanuts, pamphlets, talk about how they love their customers, basically they get creative and make it all one big theme. You should do the same.

Grabber: Attach a heart, chocolate or perfume scented envelope to the top of your letter that goes out to them. The letter could start something like this:

Dear Customer,

Why do I love my customers so much?

Let me count the ways...

- 1) Without you, this not only would not be possible, but I wouldn't be able to employ a single mother of three, or provide work for people from all areas of the country.
- 2) Without you, my kids would not have such a care-free life and would not appreciate what it takes to build something from the ground up and see it thrive.
- 3) Without you, I would be stuck back in a dead-end-corporate-job.
- 4) Without you, I would not be able to write these love letters - and hear such positive response back every time I mail one out.

etc.....

February 21st - 1st Telephone Book Issued

Idea: Do you use Yellow Page advertising? Effectively? Some of the most boring advertising can be found in the Yellow Pages! And yet, 40% of your clients buy based on the research they do in the Yellow Pages - 40%! Online yellow pages and offline print directories - it makes no difference.

Flip through your section of the Yellow pages - notice that they all look the same? What possibly gives them a reason to call you over the other 15 companies advertising the same products or services in the exact same style of advertising?

If you are placing Yellow Page Ads this year - give some serious thought on headlines you can use (remember - 80 - 90% of your success is in the headline), make it look like an advertorial, and give them an incentive to pick up that phone and call YOU, not the guy in the ad next to you.

Notice that "advertorial" was mentioned?

The reason - if you use news-style advertising you will get up to 500% better response. This is proven and documented throughout the years. Make your advertising look like some interesting news, or an article - do not make it look like advertising (that is what your competitors are doing).

If it looks like advertising - most people won't read it. Think about it - do you read the articles, or the ads, in the newspapers and magazines you buy?

Make it look like an **advertorial** and see your response go through the roof.

February 22nd - First Color Photo Taken (1890)

Idea: Color plays a vitally important role in our world. It can sway thinking, cause reactions and change actions. Depending on the color, it can soothe your eyes or raise your blood pressure. Likewise, the colors used for a product, website, logos or business cards can cause powerful reactions.

What's your business color reflecting to your client? Perhaps it's time to re-look at your marketing materials and use colors that can put your customers into a buying mood or set more of a positive image.

For your clients - let them know that you are thinking about their company. Using the chart below - compare their corporate image with the color chart and write them a personalize letter regarding how their logo makes you want to do more for them. Such as the Wild West Wealth Summit (www.wildwestwealth.com) logo uses red.

Dear Customer,

I came across your "website/business card" the other day and I got to thinking about how you are doing. The red in your logo got me thinking about how *passionate* you have been with your business.

And I think I can help with that *passion*....

Here are some of the meaning of the following colors (this is intended for the North American culture):

White - Clean, Pure
Black - Elegant, Powerful, Secretive
Yellow - Warm, Alert, Happy
Red - Passion, Danger, Excitement
Orange - Playful, Vibrant, Energy
Blue - Loyal, Trustworthy, Peaceful
Purple - Wise, Royalty, Celebration
Green - Healthy, Natural, Plentiful

Grabber: of course include a color photo (send one of you with their business card in your hand)

February 23rd - Banana Bread Day

Idea: Please see June 8th for information on how you can use this day to market your service and/or products.

February 27th - National Read Your Warranty Day

Idea: Do you guarantee your products? Let your clients know about your warranty. It doesn't have to be a "legal" warranty - but just let them know that you stand behind your products and/or services. Highlight some special features that guarantees they are getting the best deal from you or show them how unlike your competition - you have a guarantee. Even mail them your competitions ads and how you can do better than them.

March 3rd - I Want You To Be Happy Day

Idea: Have you considered using emotions in your marketing? American Demographics reported that shoppers with an emotional tie to a store visit the store 24% more and spend 46% more than those without the emotional attachment.

Look at what this means to your business. Let's assume that a business has clients that visit (or buy online or by mail) once a month and spend (on average) \$65.

The simple technique of using emotional attachments in their marketing and promotions makes a dramatic difference!

Here's what happens...

After they tie in some emotion into their marketing and customer satisfaction systems they would see those same clients would visit the store 15 times in a year (versus 12) and would spend on average \$95.

Before: $12 \times \$65 = \780 in a year

After: $15 \times \$95 = \$1,470$ in that same year!

Almost double the sales - just with giving your customers an emotional reason to like you.

Simple, yet profound. What emotions do your customers feel when they use your products and services? What should they be feeling? What can you do to make them feel that more?

This simple little technique can easily double your sales this year. Maybe wanting your clients to be happy is worth a try?

March 3rd – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

March Examples:

"Why are people so tired on April 1st? Because they just finished a 31-day March"

"Spring is nature's way of saying, 'Let's party!'" - Robin Williams

"Some people march to a different drummer and some people polka"

"March is said to 'come in like a lion, out like a lamb!'"

March 10th - First Paper Money issued (first issued in 1862)

Idea: Tell your customers how you will save them some money with the use of your product or service. Tell them that you know they value their bucks. Could also be used with a St. Patrick's Day promotion by tying in money and buckets of gold? Or tie in the grabber idea with the actual invention of the game of Monopoly on March 7th.

Grabber: Paper Monopoly Money

March 14th - International Ask A Question Day

Do you have an FAQ section for your website or brochure? This is a great day to start one if not. For example, send out an email to your clients answering a list of popular questions that your clients ask you.



The email could start with something like this:

Today is International Ask A Question Day and it had me thinking that I have been meaning to address some popular questions I have received lately. Another idea would be to answer some bizarre questions about your business or yourself. You could also interview one of your employees with some interesting questions and include the article in a future newsletter

You could have this as a regular feature each month highlighting a different employee. This is a great way for your clients to get to acquainted with your staff.

Some questions you could ask could include:

- If you were ever to be reincarnated, what would you come back as?
- If you had the chance to have a super power, what would you choose?
- If you had \$5,000 to spend in one day, what would you do?

- What's the weirdest phobia you have?
- What's the first thing you do when you wake up?
- What's the last thing you do before you go to sleep?
- If you could have a luncheon with any three people (real or fictitious/ from any time period, dead or alive) , which three people would you choose and why?
- If you were stranded on a lonely beach, what are the five things that you would want to survive?

March 15th - Chatrooms debut on Internet (1974)

Idea: Chatrooms are hugely popular on the internet with the young and the old. The oldest form of true chat rooms are the text-based variety. Talkomatic, developed on the PLATO system around 1974, has a strong claim to have been the prototype of the text-only chat room.

Have you been too busy to chat with your clients lately? If so, you are missing out on a huge opportunity to connect with them. Here is a sample postcard you could start with to try and grab their attention to sit down and have a chat about your company and/or offer them a solution to save some money.

March 17th - Saint Patrick's Day

Idea: Another popular holiday! And another marketing promotion you shouldn't miss! Everyone loves the idea of getting lucky (both in winning prizes and in other non-business-related ways). Or offer them a "lucky prize" for being among the first 35 people to take you up on your Saint Patrick's day special.

Grabber: Tie your promotion around the idea of either a 4-leaf-clover or around the idea of winning something or getting a lucky break on something. Or attach a bubble gum coin, or Shamrock sticker to the top of your letter that goes out to them. The letter could start:

Dear Customer:

"Want to get lucky?" (OR Alternatively - "My luck is your good luck"... OR "I got lucky last week" - and you benefit)

It's about time I extend to you some of the good luck I have recently enjoyed. You see, the last 12 months has been absolutely incredible - and I have you to thank! If it wasn't for wonderful customers like you, we'd have been out of business long ago.

So, in honor of Saint Patrick's Day, I want to extend to you a Lucky-To-Have-Customers-Like-You Special.

If you are looking to improve the quality of your life, I want to extend to you a 40% bonus (10% for every leaf on a 4 leaf clover). Pick option A and I will upgrade what you get and add on 40% more products and services - for the same price!

Here is what you would get...etc...

"The way to get started is to quit talking and begin doing."

– Walt Disney -

March 18th – World Story Telling Day

Idea: Carnegie Mellon did a fascinating study on the power of story telling vs hard core statistics in your marketing.

You may think you know the results, but I bet you would never guess the results and the implications for marketing.

The results surprised me too.

The first test they ran involved a sales letter promoting a non-profit.

The people involved received 2 versions of the sales letter.

One version told a heart wrenching story about a girl that lived in the 3rd world country...

...the other shared the facts on what dismal living conditions the people lived in, the numbers of them without fresh water, without food, etc.

Then they measured how much each of the test groups donated to each letter.

The letter sold 118% more with the story based letter.

So despite what you may think about people who just want the facts, real life shows a very different outcome.

But it gets even more interesting...

Then they tested an approach that used *BOTH story and facts in the same letter*.

'Logic' would say that using both story and facts in the same letter would appeal to the analytical buyers and more emotional buyers all at once.

You'd think it would improve results...

But it did the opposite.

It did sell more than the pure facts approach (25.4% increase), but it sold 39.9% less than the pure story approach.

So story definitely sells far better than the facts based approach.

It gets better...

They then tested a theory that 'priming' the different groups would impact sales ad well.

One group they primed by having them do mathematical calculations before being presented with the analytical approach.

The other was primed with more emotional hot buttons and their reactions to emotional hot buttons... Prepped with the emotional words before seeing the emotional words.

Those primed with analytical exercises before the **analytical letter bought 12% LESS** than the mixed emotions/facts letter.

Those primed with emotional exercises bought basically the same as without the priming (actually 1.7% less).

The lesson?

Sales and marketing campaigns based on emotional stories will outperform anything else.

This works in business to business. This works in business to consumer

Having a great signature story in your marketing campaigns **will** improve your results...

...I guarantee it.

If one great story could improve the sales in the Carnegie Mellon study by 118%...

PS: As I was wrapping this article up, I realized this was all facts... with a little bit of story mixed in. Which, according to the study is not a good thing.

So I will end with a quick story. I have written extensively about **Kinjo Sushi in Calgary**. The fact that they are thriving in an industry that has regular business failures.

The fact that they sell out the seats in their restaurant 5-9 TIMES a day. Yes, 100% sold out over 5 times a day.

They fill the seats – feed them – entertain them – send them on their way... quickly. The fact that the owner of this place used a great story to build his last empire of 35 franchises.

The fact that they have NEVER done advertising before... every single one of their clients come to them as a result of word of mouth.

Why? It's cold, dead, fish... right? Well – they have a secret weapon... Peter Kinjo. Peter gets this. He knows that people buy when they are entertained and they are given a great story to share with others. And they do!

They tell their friends about the wacky guy and the big knife.
The free sushi they got.
The free chocolate they got.
The incredible service.

That's all it takes... a great story for your customers to share.

March 20th – Companies That Care Day

Idea: Send out a press release to try and get some media attention on this day. Make sure you read the Checklist for Sending Press Releases section before sending to get the most out of your press release.

news release

for immediate release

“Companies That Care Day” brings pride back to local business

YOUR CITY, STATE – **Today's Date** – At a time when corporations are taking over the business battle front, small businesses that still prize their community should be applauded. That is why a local business owner takes pride as they plan to celebrate Companies That Care Day on March 17 and are urging other business to do the same.

YOUR FULL NAME who owns **YOUR BUSINESS NAME** in **YOUR CITY** will be celebrating “Companies That Care Day” by giving back to their community.

“It is so important to give back to your community, especially since your business is a part of that community. Show your community that you care just as much about it as you care about your business,” **YOUR LAST NAME** says.

“What can your business do for the community?” **YOUR LAST NAME** asks. **S/He** suggests you can just write a check for a local group, but there's more fun – and the chance for more publicity by being creative.

“If you're a bakery give some bread to the local shelter,” **YOUR LAST NAME** says. “Sell an exclusive product, where all the proceeds will benefit a charity. Collect donations in a jar and present them to a nonprofit.”

YOUR LAST NAME will be giving back to **YOUR CITY** on March 17th by **what you will do for the community. For example give 20% that day to your local YMCA or other town organization or school.**

Founded in **Year**, **Name of Business** helps **your target market** to **do what** by **how you do it**

contact: **YOUR NAME**
YOUR PHONE NUMBER
YOUR EMAIL ADDRESS HERE

Credit: This press release template is given exclusively to Troy White's Marketing and Promotional Calendar recipients by Shannon Cherry.

Shannon Cherry, APR, MA is The Power Publicist. The founder of Be Heard Solutions (www.beheardsolutions.com), she helps small business owners and entrepreneurs to attract targeted prospects by using the power of publicity and promotions. Sign up for her free Publicity Power Pack, which gives you access to free publicity and marketing tips, media contacts and more at <http://www.beheardsolutions.com>

March 27th – National Joe Day (everyone who hates their name can be called Joe)

Idea: It's time to get personal with your frequent clients and stop calling them the "Average Joe". Try to remember their first name and any other tid-bit information you can about their lives.

You are losing out on a huge opportunity to create a memorable service experience – simply calling someone by their first name when they walk in the door can really make an impact. Think about the TV show "Cheers" theme song "Where everybody knows your name" – people like the experience.

April – International Customer Loyalty Month

Idea: April is a great month to start rewarding your customers for their loyalty and keep them coming back. Consider handing out frequent customer cards (nail salons, sandwich shops & flower stores use stamp cards quite frequently to keep their customers coming back). Every time your customer purchases from you, they are one step closer to a freebie item. For new customers, let them know that you will offer them a discount off their next service or purchase from you. This can build affinity with your business. Using an offer code or including a coupon with their first service will help you calculate the program's return on investment.

April – Baseball Opening Day

Idea: Hitting a homerun with wacky marketing stunts

One of the most creative industries for fun promotions?

The sports industry.

And YES, it does apply to you.

No matter what field we are talking about (pun intended), the ideas behind these promotions could easily be changed to fit your own.

The sports marketing industry is very creative and they have to draw a lot of people out to their games... so their marketing had better be good!

Imagine if you had to get 10,000 people to pay you money every single week or month... what would you do?

Many with the marketing mindset aim for product launches and successful campaigns for single products. But what would you do if you had a weekly event to sell out that delivered pretty well the same experience?

Here are some great ideas that sports teams have used to get people through the gates, money in hand.
As you go through these, PLEASE start thinking about how you could make one or more of them work in your business.

I guarantee they could... if you try.

- * The promotions could be for a sale.
- * For a launch.
- * For a fun event.
- * For a customer appreciation party.
- * Or just to get some free publicity.
- * As a co-operative promotion with other like-minded businesses
- * As a seminar or workshop
- * As a theme party you throw for all the photos and videos you could use

Or any one of a hundred different reasons to get your customers and prospects interacting with you.

Wacky Marketing from the field

Bald head night: anyone who has their head shaved gets in for free.

Mustache Appreciation Night: Fresno Grizzlies fans were encouraged to grow mustaches. They also were incited to encourage their friends to contribute \$ to a worthy cause as part of the promotion. Contests were also held for "best in show," "best Tom Selleck look-alike," and most pathetic attempt at a mustache. Great times – and great results.

Second Chance Night: Probation officers got in for free. As well as anyone who brought in a traffic ticket and promised to never do it again also got in for free.

Kevin Federline Night: The first 3,000 fans got free temporary K-Fed tattoos. They also got to watch videos of K-Feds rise through the ranks, and a dance contest between the dance troop to which Kevin Federline once belonged and the Grizzlies' mascot.

The Hagerstown (Maryland) Suns had a *McDreamy Day*: Everyone was encouraged to dress the medical part... and to know their medical lingo to win prizes.

Or what about *Anger management night* – held by the Augusta (Georgia) Green Jackets. One of their rival teams manager had a meltdown... so let's turn it into a promotion! They offered the first 250 fans free stress balls and DVDs of the movie *Anger Management*.

[Look at all the new movies out and coming out on dvd – is there any way you can tie a promotion into the theme of the movie? The newest as of this week: *Mall Cop*, *Valkyrie*, *My Bloody Valentine*, *Million Dollar Mutts*, *The Last Word*, *The Grudge*, *Flirting With Forty*, *The Curious Case of Benjamin Button*, *New In Town*, *Addicted to Plastic*, *Defiance*, *Gran Torino*. *Street Fighters*, *45 RPM*, to name just a few]

How can you go wrong with a *Britney Spears promo*? She certainly gives us all lots of great opportunity to make fun of her antics. The Newark (New Jersey) Bears held a Britney Spears Baby Safety Night. Anyone who dressed as a baby, brought a baby toy, or brought an actual baby got in for free. Everybody else that attended received a brochure about baby safety.

[NOTE: before you get uptight about how "hokey" or "unprofessional" these events sound... remember how many TICKETS they sold. Thousands and thousands of tickets sold per event. They didn't worry about the "hokeyness" of the event... they cared about the newsworthy parts of the promotion only. News and buzz gets people talking about buying... these events did everything you and I should be aiming for!]

The San Antonio Missions held a *Used Car Night* and gave away a dozen luxury used automobiles randomly.

Or how about the Southwest Michigan Devil Rays and their *College Course Giveaway Night*? Each fan received a free three-credit course of their choice at nearby Kellogg Community College.

The Charleston RiverDogs minor league baseball team is a master at using wacky promotions to get people in the seats. Some of their events: a *Run, Forrest, Run 5-K Race*; *My Hot Dog Is Green Night* and *Salute to the G-string Night* in which select fans will receive a G-string.

Get this... they even had a *Vasectomy Night* where a lucky male fan would win a vasectomy. That was canceled after management received complaints. Talk about getting some press!

Or this: they even staged a *Nobody Night*, locking out fans at the door as the club attempted to set a minor league record for lowest attendance at a game.

Steal of a deal. Recessionary promotion gone wild with the Minnesota twins offering an entire season (81 games) for only \$250. Comparable seats in New York go for \$250 per seat – per game.

Hungry fans unite! The Athletics, Orioles, Rangers, Royals, Braves, Dodgers and Padres all have designated *All-You-Can Eat sections* for fans hungry to see more than a game. Ranging from \$30 – \$45 per person to eat their way through the game.

Musical fan fare. The Pirates have offered up *REO Speedwagon and Collective Soul* and the Marlins offer *KC and the Sunshine Band*. The Devil Rays have the most interesting series featuring The Commodores, Trace Adkins, Kool And The Gang, LL Cool J and MC Hammer. (could you not offer something like this in any of your promotions with lesser know artists?)

Luring them in. The Twins promotion department hooked some new fans by offering a *Joe Mauer fishing lure*. Only available to the first 5,000 fans, this was a run away winner.

How about some NON sports promotions?

What about the *Beer-for-Bags event*, which the company promoted that they would accept beer for merchandise. They grew their sales by 20% using this promotion (including all the free publicity they received as well). The company hopes to make "Beer For Bags" an annual event, as it is in Australia.

Gonigam's World Furniture Mall near Chicago offered customers up to \$10,000 of free furniture if the Chicago Bears shut out the Green Bay Packers (which they did). The company had prize reimbursement insurance to cover their backs. They saw huge traffic growth to their site and an increasing amount of new sales to people who never bought from them before.

Long John Silver's offered to give customers free "Giant Shrimp" if NASA found conclusive evidence of an ocean on Mars.

This is a great list you could use anytime you need a promotion.

The key is to MAKE IT FIT.

I realize 99% of those who read this blog are NOT in the sports marketing business. But... so what? Why can't you put some time and effort into this list and find some ways to use these ideas?

Keep your eyes on the local news, industry news, Hollywood movies, strange trends, technology trends, and pretty well anything you see on the covers of the magazines like Star, National Enquirer, The Globe, etc (those are the ones the majority of the population reads... and you should be finding a way to tie into them!)

All it takes is some effort – and the results could be exceptional.

You won't know until you try... right?

April 4th – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

April Examples:

"In the spring I have counted one hundred and thirty-six different kinds of weather inside of four and twenty hours." - Mark Twain

"Isn't it appropriate that the month of tax begins with April Fool's Day and ends with cries of "May Day"!"

"The IRS should change their initials to IOS – Internal Organ Service. On April 15th, they bill you for the service of ripping out your guts"

"April comes like an idiot, babbling and stewing flowers" – Edna St. Vincent Millay

April cold with dropping rain.
Willows & Lilacs Brings again,
The whistle of returning birds
And trumpet-lowing of the herds
Ralph Waldo Emerson

April 5th – Go For Broke Day

Are you a gambler? Then today could be your day. It's Go For Broke Day. Put it all on the line and take a chance. It might be money or could be time to initiate a risky project or just put yourself out there.

We tend to go around daily playing it safe and not taking big chances but without a risk you can find yourself without a gain.

For example, a simple change below can make a huge different in your financial future.

Some people amaze me. They will go out and spend \$3,000 on a big screen television, yet whine and complain about having to invest \$500 in their financial future.

How can that be so?

Does a television help you become more successful? Maybe if you are watching training dvds or educational shows. But you certainly don't need a 60" screen for that now, do you?

So how can it be so easy for people to justify that kind of expense... yet whine and complain about the price of coaching programs, training packages – and live seminars?

It just doesn't make sense to me.

In fact, it boggles my mind.

That tv will not make you money. It will not help you accomplish more in your business. It will not give you the edge in your marketing. It will do absolutely NOTHING to help you realize your dreams.

The two things it will do?

Cause you to LOSE money (never heard of a tv that appreciates in value)... and cause you to LOSE motivation towards doing the things that are important.

Yes, they look great – and yes, they are a nice "toy" to have.

But, if you have ever complained about your financial situation – and you DO own a large tv – give your head a shake!

That same amount of money can be invested in an advertising campaign that could make you \$10,000 profits (or much more).

That same amount of money could be invested in hiring a coach – that helps you DOUBLE your revenues over the next 12 months. Or it could buy you that home study course that finally helps you understand how to write better ads and sales letters – and finally helps you achieve that consistent cash flow you want.

That same amount of time you spend GLUED to your behemoth tv, you could be using to connect with others, or writing articles to attract search engine traffic, or writing a new sales campaign to test against your existing one.

A few hours a night X 5 nights a week watching the tube is the equivalent to a FULL WEEK of work (focused work that is).

Think about it – when you watch tv, you are stuck to the tv, absolutely focused on what is going on, scared to miss a plot line. If you FOCUSED like that for a full 3 hours a night on your business, WOW!, would you ever accomplish a lot more.

Next time you sit down to your tv, think hard about how else you could invest your time.

Financial freedom... or a big screen tv... not a tough choice to make (at least it shouldn't be).

April 7th - Empowered Women Entrepreneurs Day & No Housework Day

Idea: Know some successful women entrepreneurs that could use a break?

A woman's work is never done may sound like a tired old cliché - but it may be more true than ever. According to a new survey a woman's working week is now half a day longer than it was five years ago - and that's without housework.

The increase is down to the growing number of women in more high-powered management and professional jobs, say researchers. In contrast, the total number of hours worked by men has fallen slightly over the same period - from 45.5 hours to 44.8 hours.

Tell them how much you know and appreciate their work (both inside and outside of the home).

Grabber: Send them a gift certificate for a day's maid service

April 13th – Blame Someone Else Day

Of course, it is always easy to Blame Someone Else for your problems and imagine all the mistakes and errors you can heap on someone else today. But one thing I have noticed is that while you busy putting the blame elsewhere, someone might just be putting the blame on you.

One of the biggest "blaming" I hear all the time is that many business owners use the "lack of time" card as an excuse for everything. And it is time to stop using this excuse and ignoring a simple way that you can fix it.

Hire it out! And stop using the blame game.

You can find very inexpensive help that are experts available to you.

Go to <http://www.elance.com> and post a project request and see if you can find someone qualified to help you out.

Elance.com is one of the best places online to find qualified help at pennies on the dollar! Test it out next time you have some writing to be done, web work, graphic design – you name it.

Note: But, if you are looking for qualified copywriters, elance.com is not your best bet. Why? Because any good quality copywriter avoids elance like the plague. It is designed for price competitive buyers – not performance based results. You may get decent copy done – but if results are important to you – hire someone who prides themselves in the results they get – not how cheap they are!

"The more informative your advertising, the more persuasive it will be."

– David Ogilvy -

April 14th – Noah Webster 1st Dictionary Copywritten

In appreciation of the dictionary, today is a good day to think about how words have changed your life. Remember back to the day when your favorite teacher paid you a compliment on your school work.

Or your friend said something that hurts you still to this day. The first time someone said "I love you" or "I hate you."

It's amazing how words can stay with us for years, even decades, and completely change our self confidence and our decisions to do things.

Words - something we are born listening to, we learn how to speak them in a very short period of time, and by the time we are 5 years old we have grasped thousands of words and their meanings.

When we are 5, we know that "I hate you" will make our parents cry. Or "I love you" will make them smile.

At 5 years old, we are already learning how to manipulate words to suit our needs and to get what we want.

At 15, we use words to get ourselves out of trouble.

At 25, we use words to help us get a job if just getting out of college. Or if we didn't go to college, we use words to get ourselves better and better jobs that suit our lifestyle and our dreams.

At 35, we are using words to try and teach our own children the right things to do and say.

Each decade has new teachings and new discoveries on the power of words.

What you must always question - are you using your words to maximum effectiveness?

What if simple 5 word sentence could get you almost any job you want?

Or 3 words that will always get you the best seat in a restaurant, anywhere in the world.

When you learn the power of words and how to train yourself to use more effective words - everything changes.

Things come to you easier, at less cost and with less hassle.

Sales increase dramatically when you find the words that convinces people to buy. Changing one word in your sales script can double your sales - is that not a lot of power held in one single word?

Small businesses are constantly battling for more sales, more profits, more growth. Without those - you are out of business, people lose jobs and families can be broken.

Yet, the power of words is a learnable skill.

Anyone - no matter what background or education, can become a master with using words to influence.

And if you take your business, your income and your future seriously you will spend some time learning more about words and how they can change everything in your life in a very rapid amount of time.

Put some effort into understanding words and how they can help you achieve your goals.

When you are out shopping at the mall, notice the stores that are busy, notice the sales people and how they ask questions or handle objections.

When you are reading newspapers and magazines - notice the articles, or advertisements that make you stop and read. At times they will make you buy something - sight unseen. Almost all of us have done it - bought something through a catalog, an advertisement, a web site etc.

What made you buy?

April 19th – Get To Know Your Customer's Day

Idea: Send out a press release to try and get some media attention on this day. Make sure you read the Checklist for Sending Press Releases section before sending to get the most out of your press release.

news release

for immediate release

Local Business Celebrates Its Customers on "Get To Know Your Customer Day"

YOUR CITY, STATE – **Today's Date** – What good is business without customers? On January 20th, one local business has decided to show **his/her** appreciation for **his/her** customers. It's "Get to Know Your Customer Day" and getting to know the customers better personally is the goal.

"Get to Know Your Customer Day" focuses primarily on the most important aspect of a business; the customers. "I love this day. It truly shows how much we appreciate and care about our customers," explains **Your Full Name**, who owns and runs **Name of Business** in **Name of City**. "Of all the companies you patronized, how many told you in some fashion how much they appreciated your business? One? Two? Five? Ten? Unfortunately, the answer is often none! But that's all changing – at least for our business. Starting on Get to Know Your Customer Day, our goal will be creating a true relationship with every customer."

Founded in **Year**, **Name of Business** helps **your target market** to **do what** by **how you do it**.

As part of the celebration, **Name of Business** will be offering **name of thing offered (discount, bonus, free shipping, special gift, etc)** to every customer on January 20.

"Good customer service is the lifeblood of any business. You can offer promotions and slash prices to bring in as many new customers as you want, but unless you can get some of those customers to come back, your business won't be profitable for long." says **Your Last Name**.

For more information, contact **Name of Business** at **Business Phone Number** or visit online at **Your website**.

contact: YOUR NAME HERE
YOUR PHONE NUMBER HERE
YOUR EMAIL ADDRESS HERE

Credit: This press release template is given exclusively to Troy White's Marketing and Promotional Calendar recipients by Shannon Cherry.

Shannon Cherry, APR, MA is The Power Publicist. The founder of Be Heard Solutions (www.beheardsolutions.com) , she helps small business owners and entrepreneurs to attract targeted prospects by using the power of publicity and promotions. Sign up for her free Publicity Power Pack, which gives you access to free publicity and marketing tips, media contacts and more at <http://www.beheardsolutions.com>

"I didn't have time to write a short letter, so I wrote a long one."

– Mark Twain -

April 27th - South American Millipede Found with 784 legs (in 1669)

Idea: Use the following promotion idea and letter suited to how you can save time for your customers (either through your product or service).

Grabber: Attach plastic millipede to top of letter

Dear Customer,

Are You Running Around Aimlessly...Not Getting Done As Much As You Want?

Back in 1669, a 784 legged millipede was found in South Africa that sums up today's society. Lots of leg's, lots of places to go, but end up sticking around the same neighborhood without rhyme or reason (it is proven that despite having 784 legs, this specific breed of millipede rarely went outside a 1 mile radius).

It is tough though. All the places to see, things to do and people to meet - yet time is increasingly short.

What I want to share with you today is a fabulous new system I discovered that helps you gain back at least an extra hour of your time every day. I have used it for the past 6 months and can honestly say I now am getting done an extra 10 hours of productive time a week - which also is equating to an additional \$5,500 income each and every month from sales growth.

Before this system though, let me share with you how a typical day looked for me....etc....

May 5th - Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

Grabber:

"My mother never gave up on me. I messed up in school so much they were sending me home, but my mother sent me right back" - Denzel Washington

"A family is a unit composed not only of children but of men, women, an occasional animal, and the common cold." - Ogden Nash

"Why is there so much month left at the end of the money?" - John Barrymore

Then came fair May, the fairest maid on ground,
Deck'd all with dainties of the season's pride,
And throwing flowers out of her lap around.
Edmund Spenser

May 11th - Mothers Day

Idea: Everybody has a mother or someone close to them (sister, aunt, best friend etc.) - don't miss this marketing opportunity.

Grabber: Attach mini flowers, or a bandaid (mothers were always great at fixing boo-boos) Here is a sample letter:

Dear Customer,

Mothers Day This May 11th... Share with me your greatest joy as a mother and I will give you a 14% discount on anything and everything you want...

or...

Mothers Day Madness - Attention All Distraught Mothers Who Are In Serious Need Of Some Pampering...

You know how it works...Mothers day arrives and on the day you are supposed to be relaxing, kicking back and enjoying life, you end up cooking meals, doing laundry and pretty well doing everything you do on a typical day.

No more - not this Mothers Day.

We have something for you that your spouse and kids CAN'T argue with....etc....

May 30 - Australia's first dentist Simon Lear starts to yank out teeth (1818)

Ideas: How many ideas can you come up with around the idea of yanking teeth - or hating to visit a dentist - or a job where no one enjoys or appreciates you?

Grabber: tooth on a chain attached

June 3rd – Repeat Day

Have you been measuring & testing everything? Do you know what promotions or marketing campaigns to repeat? Since it is Repeat Day, today is a great day to measure and test your efforts. As mentioned previously,

One thing you need to do is track EVERYTHING. Noting what works, what didn't, how well it works or didn't, exactly what you did, etc.

The easiest way to do this is keep a simple excel spreadsheet (or something similar) detailing everything that has happened.

Then it is time to rank the results you got.

Rank it:

- 1 – stellar success and either brought in a ton of sales, new leads, or positive comments from your customers and prospects.
- 2 – marginally successful – broke even on profits (or small profit), got a few new leads or positive comments
- 3 – not good results at all – lost money or time for nothing, no new leads or sales, no one even noticed you during your attempt
- 4 – disgustingly bad – big loser, negative feedback and comments, complete waste of time for your business

Rank every thing you have done over the last 7 exercises – from 1 through 4.

Then separate them into 1's and 2's – then another group of 3's and 4's

The 1's and 2's you are going to do again... the rest you will hold off for now and revisit them in 6 months or so (things change – what didn't work now may work exceptionally well in 6 months – the internet and society is on warp drive right now – never throw out your test results.

You can even go further into detail and give your honest thoughts on why some things worked and didn't. These notes you make could be worth a fortune to you in 6 or 12 months. Rather than reinventing the wheel – you may find you tested it already but forgot it didn't work – or did work.

Now – rank your 1's and 2's into a 1 – 5 list or 1 – 10 or however many things you have listed. This ranking is on your favorite promotion you did that ranked a 1 or 2. What made you the most excited or gave you the most enjoyment? 1 being your most favorite – 10 being least. Take your top 3 of them. List on a new page of paper.

Now write out how you can make them better, more fun, more exciting, more profitable, more enticing, more powerful, more appealing to the emotions... anything you can think of to make it better – write it down.

Campaign	Success Ranking	Details	Notes
CD43 Postcard Campaign	1	Brought in large new client (client name) worth \$50,000, plus got 346 people on teleseminar	Simple white background – black text – teaser copy sent to web page – 5 x 5" postcard
SLS2-B Sales letter to existing clients for Halloween promotion	3	Sent out 1,000 letters at total cost of \$1,500 = total sales = \$950	Try a grabber next time – plain letter with Halloween approach and this copy did not work
Coffee Stain Postcard	1	Mailed to 540 people – brought in \$9,500 in work immediately – plus 5 new referrals for followup	"stole" look from other company – changed copy and made it look like it was stained by coffee = use as new brand for materials?
CS5-C Client Stampede Letter with small cowboy hat	2	Cost a lot to mail = but broke even on initial sales	Try again as people commented back they like the approach
\$50 Gift cert	1	\$97 investment for printing = \$3947 in sales!	Definitely run to existing clients twice a year minimum
BRG Bell Mailer	4	Mailed out bell as grabber on letter – total cost to mail \$2,500 = returns NIL = complete flop	Don't bother with copy approach taken – test completely different approach

Post these types of results on a regular basis. Keep in marketing results binder – review monthly – or whenever you need new promotion ideas.

With the above example – you would definitely want to repeat ALL the 1's at least one more time a year, test the 2's again – and don't bother running the 3's.

THINGS TO TEST

(only test one thing at a time or test is invalid, test must be run to exact same list or publication as initial control)

- Free samples
- Quantity discounts
- Referral request
- Method of payments (cash, check, ccard, multiple credit card options, purchase orders, extended payments)
- Method of response: phone, mail, email, web, fax, in-store
- Regular envelop vs larger
- Live stamps vs pre-printed
- Teaser copy on envelope vs none
- Window envelope vs regular
- Life letter (cover letter) vs none
- Form of order card (BRC or fax in)
- Signature in blue ink vs black
- Different headlines
- Handwriting in margins or spread throughout
- 1 page letter vs multiple page
- 4 page letter vs 12 page
- Opening paragraph
- Change the PS
- "up the ante" with bonuses
- Color vs black and white or 4 color vs 2 color
- Textured paper vs plain
- White paper vs color
- White order form vs color
- Font size or Different font
- Guarantee length
- Bonus bundle
- Boxes for testimonials and sidebars
- Straight line boxes or dashed lines
- Deadlines vs no deadlines
- List rental – try new sources – new lists – hotline buyers
- Write as if from you vs write as if from someone else (staff, spouse, client, supplier)

TIPS FOR REVIEWING YOUR SUCCESS PACKAGES

1. Review and note (on separate tracking file) the control package. Make a list of all the key components: copy, offer, PS, headline, graphics, envelopes. Note who exactly it was mailed to. Color or black and white?
2. Only record FACTS – never your feelings or impressions. What may seem like it won't work, can end up being your most successful package. And vice versa – what seems like your best work ever, may flop badly.
3. Once you have a control – are there ways you can do the same package – but at a lower cost? Test it again – with cheaper paper, envelopes, in black and white instead of color, etc. You may find the same results with a much cheaper package

Marketing is useless if you don't know the results. You MUST test everything – and test consistently throughout the year, logging all of your results.

The simplest of tests can reveal MASSIVE breakthroughs that put serious money in your pocket.

Start writing out your results NOW.

June 4 - French opera star becomes first women to fly in a balloon (1784)

Ideas: How to sail high above the crowds, Women breaking free of everything that held them back, From "singing to sailing

Grabber: attach a balloon to the top

June 5 – National Family Day

Ideas: Is it time to invite your customer's to be apart of your family? National Family Day is a great way to invite your customers to join into your business family or meetings. Here is a sample email letter which you will need to adapt to your services however this was used to entice individuals to become of apart of a business meeting circle.

Subject: A special Family Day notice to (your state/province) Business Owners

Happy Family Day!

I realize that family day is a day to spend with your family... but I want to invite you to become a member of a new family.

Monday night you can be surrounded by people... more like family, who really understand what being an entrepreneur is like.

Once a month we meet, Owen Garrat is the man in charge of the family meetings.

The third Monday of every month the family gets together in Calgary...1 day later, the third Tuesday of every month, the family meets in Edmonton. It's terrific to get around people who are going through the challenges of running a small business, just like we are, all meeting to share war stories, ideas and support.

We talk about business growth issues, marketing and advertising, employee challenges, and many other important questions and issues that small businesses in Alberta go through etc.

June 6th – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

June Examples:

"Spring being a tough act to follow, God created June." – Al Berstein

"There are 3 good reasons to be a teacher – June, July and August" – Billy Connolly

"If a June night could talk, it would probably boast that it invented romance" – Bern Williams

"A father carries pictures where his money used to be." ~Author Unknown

June 8 – Banana Split Day

Ideas: Have you been trying & trying to get your clients attention and having no luck? You can easily try to entice your customer's to try your new products with using this day. Simply create a postcard like below and insert your offer of your product and/or service.

You could also "sweeten" the deal by telling them if they have any questions, you would be more than willing to go buy them a banana split to explain more! Or even better – tell your client you will "split" the price with them.

June 13th - Alexander the Great dies from over eating (323BC)

Ideas: Perfect for anything fitness related, food related, over indulging, the fact that no-one is invincible

Grabber: Kings Crown, Miniature Platter of Food, Mini Coffin



The Story of 2 Brothers, a Lobster Boat, and Millions of Dollars In Revenue

In order to create fast revenue growth in your business, I first want to start with one of my favorite success stories. Rest assured, the story you are about to hear is not only true; it is documented and proven by:

- Fortune
- CBS News
- MSNBC
- CNN Money
- USA Today
- ABC
- NPR
- Incentive
- Urban Daddy
- Luxist
- Gourmet
- The Nibble
- Port City Life Portland Press
- Monterey Bay Aquarium
- Marketplace
- MaineBiz
- Manage Smarter
- Perspective
- Down East

...to name just a few.

What I love most about this story is that the gentlemen you are about to meet, took an age-old business model and completely revolutionized the way money is made.

Not only that, they are both still under 30 yrs old and run a million dollar business.

The best part: the techniques they used to build a million dollar business in months apply to YOUR business. They work with any business that is willing to try something new... and break the "traditional" ways you make money and build relationships with your customers.

What makes their story so great?

Brendan Ready and his brother John grew up in a lobster fisherman family. From a young age they were either helping out on the docks in Maine, or were out on the boat with their uncle pulling in lobsters they had caught. Eventually they had saved up enough money to buy their own boat and traps, and go out on their own.

They put together a business called Ready Seafoods, which followed the traditional path of selling lobsters off the docks, just like everyone else.

One day they had an idea they wanted to test...

...“what would happen if we bucked tradition, packed up our lobsters, drove for 2 hours, and sold them on Martha’s Vineyard?”

A fair question... one they are very glad they asked.

Next thing you know, their lobsters were sold out and they had pocketed 3 times as much revenue as they would have selling from the dock.

This very affluent island did not have lobstermen there selling their goods ... and the residents of the island were willing to pay a substantial premium to buy from the brothers. *(They were the only ones willing to do the drive up there.)*

They also found out that there were other customers out there, just like those customers on Martha’s Vineyard, who were willing to pay a premium for the best possible product and service available.

Not only that, they also started to notice that their customers were asking a lot of questions about the lifestyle of a lobsterman. They wanted to know about the experience of us going out on the water every day at 4:00 in the morning, going out with the boat as the sun rises, with the seagulls, and being independent with a passion and a dream.



Customers wanted to be a part of it, almost like belonging to that strong working waterfront industry, that strong sense of tradition, that strong sense of heritage that the Maine community has.

And the money was rolling in.

Which their mother noted. “Boys, I know you are making good money now, but don’t get too cocky... you are going back to school” she said.

Off to business school they went.

And they took their thriving lobster business with them and used the business classes as test beds for new and improved ideas they could try out in their business.

And the BIG Breakthrough Idea soon came.

A new business, called Catch a Piece of Maine, was formed (they still ran Ready Seafoods). And everyone told them they were crazy...

...no one would buy.

...you will destroy your business and reputation.



...And every other prediction of their demise was loudly stated to them.

Everyone told them how bad of an idea it was...

...until the money started pouring in.

Catch a Piece of Maine sells memberships to their lobster club.

Now, instead of buying lobsters here and there... you first pay \$3,000 for a membership.

With your membership, you get a dedicated Lobsterman, your own lobster trap, and up to 47 lobsters a year delivered to you when you want them.

So, if you are having a party this Friday night, you’d call them up on Tuesday and they would have an insulated cooler of live Lobsters delivered to your door the afternoon of your party.

Need 2 lobsters?

No problem.

Having a party for 8? No worries.

Not only did you receive the lobsters, but you also got lobster bibs, the crackers for the shells, Maine steamer clams, Maine mussels, and four servings of gourmet Maine-made desserts made from local purveyors from the state of Maine.

Each shipment of lobster that comes from your lobster trap comes with a DVD of your lobsterman showing your catch, a map of where your lobsters were caught, who your harvester is, the story of the man behind the catch, and also any other personalized gifts that you want to be sent inside of your package. They would talk about their family, talking about the lifestyle, talking about how to catch lobsters, and showing you how and when they pulled your lobsters in. You got their direct cell phone number, and you got their blog address (each lobsterman is paid to keep an active blog going).

Instead of selling lobsters...

They were now selling an experience for those customers who want more than what's offered in the marketplace.

What they did is find a way to create an interactive program where they could actually involve the high-end customer to partner with them in the industry and basically be a virtual lobsterman for an entire year.

It's a unique experience where you can have a direct relationship with your harvester.

You can follow him throughout the entire year. You have your own lobster trap where you can actually physically view it online and see how many lobsters it catches every day.

Think of it as your own personal lobster concierge service right there in Portland, Maine, where the lobster, seafood, anything else to do with Maine, is provided to you..

Did it work?

Their goal was to sell 400 memberships at \$3,000 each in their first year.

They sold 200 memberships in their first 3 months!

And more than their initial goal in the first year.

A million dollar business was born... in a way everyone said wouldn't work.

This is a very viral program, meaning that customers tell their friends about it.

Remember, they are targeting a more affluent clientele, the type of buyer who is very difficult to reach through traditional marketing and advertising. Yet, some of these affluent customers carry a picture of their lobsterman around in their purse or wallet with them, wherever they're going.

They carry their DVD with them when they go to parties, and put it in just because it's so fun for them to say they have their own lobsterman here in Maine. "Look what he sent me for my birthday."

Brilliant.

Think about it: every time they have a dinner party (which is typically also with more affluent friends as well), they are talking about their Lobsterman, their traps, they are sharing their lobsters and deserts, and they are gladly spreading the good word about Catch a Piece of Maine... *to people who are very likely to become members as well.*

The word of mouth is incredible using this model!

Their existing clients help them do their marketing, and help find them the exact type of buyer that is willing to pay the membership fee.

Not only that, the uniqueness of this business has captured the media's attention and Catch a Piece of Maine has received a substantial amount of free publicity. To pay for the type of media coverage they have gotten for free would have cost them hundreds of thousands of dollars... possibly into the million + range.



**Now, what does this have to do with you?
How can you use similar techniques
to rapidly grow your business,
even in uncertain times?**

What follows is a proven formula for growing your business, improving your cash flow, and attracting very high quality buyers into your sales funnel. We discuss how you can leverage the Catch a Piece of Maine success blueprint into your business, and how other tools can further help you make a lot more money.

Most importantly, how you can invest just an hour a day and see rapid growth in your first 60-90 days. An hour a day may seem like a lot now, but when you look at the bankable results you will get from that hour, it becomes much easier the more you do and the more experienced you get.

How To THRIVE In a Recession.

McGraw Hill Research just released some fascinating results from a major study they did. Over the period of a 5 year span, they went out and surveyed 600 businesses from a cross section of different industries. During the 5 year span, there was one recession that took place. The companies that maintained or grew their marketing efforts during the recession ended up growing 256% over the 5 years. The companies who chose to shrink their marketing efforts during the recession only grew by 19%. The same recession... one company grows by 256%... the other by a paltry 19%. **The only difference?** Those that grew most did MORE marketing, not less. The main reason you are reading this now is to improve your business and cash flow... marketing IS the key to do both. As you go through this guide, make sure you answer the questions and seriously put thought into the exercises given. If it means the difference to you between 256% growth and 19% growth... it's obvious why this is so important!]

Catch a Piece of Maine has created such a unique offering and customer relationship that a significant percentage of their business comes direct from referrals and word of mouth. Imagine if they had placed ads in all the major papers and magazines saying **"Lobster Club Memberships... \$3,000. Call with credit card number."** It would be a dismal failure, yet that is what most businesses do!

The prices and offer may be different, but the expectation of getting an order direct from a small business card sized ad is the same. It just doesn't work. Ask yourself this: what are you doing different that inspires people to want more information from you? Are you positioning yourself in the marketplace (and in front of the right kind of buyers) to stand out from your competition with your offer, or are you creating an entirely NEW market, like Catch a Piece of Maine did? How could you?

**LESSONS FROM THE
LOBSTER BROTHERS:**

- Do what your competitors **aren't willing to do** to open up new territories.
- Go where the **real money** is ... and charge appropriately.
- Find areas that are not being served properly.
- Be **creative** in how you pay your team members – get them excited about how much they can make ... and how much of a **mini-celebrity** you are making them.

Charge very high premiums for a unique service and product that creates an unforgettable experience ... **one they can't wait to share with their friends.**

Catch a Piece of Maine went out and **sold a whole new concept to the marketplace.** Rather than selling canned lobsters, or trying to compete on price, they LISTENED to their affluent buyers on Martha's Vineyard. The buyers who were paying a premium for their lobsters on the island loved asking questions about the lifestyle of a lobsterman.

They wanted to know about the early mornings on the boats, about the art and science of catching lobsters, and about the great family ties the Ready brothers got their start with.

Rather than dismissing the questions as curiosity... the brothers saw it as an opportunity and gave their affluent buyers what they wanted... direct access to the boats and fisherman, and an insiders view on what it is like to catch, ship and eat lobsters on demand.

They gave them private access to a lifestyle many of these people saw as enviable... and gave them a very interesting story they could share with their friends.

Instead of selling lobsters, they crafted their message to match what their market wanted... and a winner was born!

Questions for you to consider:

- 1) What questions are your customers asking you most often?

Do they ask you about how your products are made? Where you source your ingredients or components? How you got started? Start paying very close attention to the questions your customers are asking... those questions can be the entire foundation of your new marketing and sales campaigns.

- 2) Are you giving your customers *a unique experience* in the way they buy? How could you?
- 3) When someone buys from you, are you delivering them a good experience they would be proud to share with their friends and associates? How could you? Can you make it easier for them to tell the story about your business?

Marketing Sherpa did a major study with thousands of internet buyers to find out why they did or didn't buy from the websites they visit. **The #1 reason people didn't buy?** Lack of information. 50% of prospective buyers, ones who are ready to buy right now, will abandon your site and avoid making a purchase because you are not giving them enough targeted information to help in their purchase decision. The message is KEY. Get it right by asking them what they want, and then give it to them in a format that convinces them to buy.

Give your prospects something for free in exchange for their contact information. That way, you can stay in touch with them.

Need an example? An earlier version of the free ebook you are now reading prompted tens of thousands of people to add their names to my mailing list, as you did.

If you visit the Catch a Piece of Maine website (www.catchapieceofmaine.com), you will see a large number of videos scattered around. The videos show funny promotions they have done. They show them on the boat talking about their business. Talking about the lifestyle. Talking about what makes them unique in a very cluttered world. Those videos are very compelling to the right prospect and a large percentage of them become members on their program.

They could also add some additional free giveaways like a Lobster Cookbook, maybe an ebook of stories and photos from their fisherman, maybe even an ebook showing testimonials from their clients and how they use the membership program in their home, maybe in their business as well.

The more freebies you give people in exchange for their contact information, the easier it will be to follow up and close the sale. If they are willing to hand over their contact details, they have already said they are somewhat interested in what you do. Now is the time for doing everything you can to win them over and get them as a paying customer.

Use your lead generation system in conjunction with your ads, mailings and website to maximize your list of qualified prospects - people who like to hear from you.

Catch a Piece of Maine told their prospects right from day 1 that there were only 400 memberships available. And it was a significant factor in them selling so many, so fast.

Things you can limit:

- Quantity of products
- Quantity of memberships
- Timeline the offer is good for
- Amount of bonuses they get
- One time offers
- Free upsell to a bigger and better option
- Payment or financing offers
- Time of day you can place your order or visit your store for the specials
- Quantity or quality of person accepted into your offer
- Send no money now – pay in 30+ days

One thing the brothers that won Catch a Piece of Maine noticed was an unusually high number of clients who wanted even higher end options. They wanted more... and were willing to pay for it. They now offer high end travel packages to their members.

If you want to visit them, stay with them, go out on the boats with them... they now have a higher end option you can pay for. It certainly isn't inexpensive, but the type of buyer they have is much less concerned with the price than the experience they get.

A very important lesson is there: people will pay a high premium for an unusual experience they can share with others.

Is there any way you can offer a high end offer with a high end experience? Test it out! Even if only 5% of your customers take you up on it... the profits from your high end offer to 5% of your customers can be greater than the profits you make from the other 95%. Worth a test.

A simple way to build ties with your clients and employees

A great lesson to be learned from Catch a Piece of Maine! A profitable way to keep in touch with people is to use the people-story angle, and lock your employees in as lifetime employees is to use **them** as the star of your promotions.

Have a newsletter or promo that goes out telling a strange or unusual story about what happens in the office while you are gone. And just this time they decided to surprise the boss and offer you a deal that has never been offered before – once in a lifetime type of angle.

This brings “the underdogs” or “the people who do the actual grunt work” to the front lines and lets them give you things that are not available at any other time or way.

Also, by making your employees the star in your promotions they will love you forever. We all crave recognition – what better way than to plaster their funny story around along with their picture and send it out to thousands! You can also use your customers as the star of your story. Interview some of your best clients and see if they are interested in a write up. If you deal with other business owners, this is free publicity for them, and will gladly be accepted. If you deal directly with consumers, they will love having a story featured about them... and they will share it with their friends and associates.

Please put this into ACTION! It is the easiest way possible to grow your business by 130% OR MORE in the next 90 days or less.

It isn't rocket science either... it is a systematic formula that applies to any and every business... yes, that means YOURS.

Always remember the Catch a Piece of Maine story as well. They took a commodity business (lobster by the pound and price) and turned it into a very successful membership model that sells lobster at a significant premium to any and all other competitors.

The lobsters are the same as everyone else sells... the marketing message and system they use is the ONLY reason they were able to build a million dollar business in just a few months.

Take everything that you now know about your business and industry... and find a way to recreate the way your clients buy from you and hear from you.

It will make a major difference in the types of clients that buy from you... and from the amount of money you make from the same amount of time being put into your business.

Last, remember the McGraw Hill study. I know you would much prefer growing your business by 256% over 19%... **and more effective marketing is the key.**

No matter what the economy is doing, more marketing will always improve your bottom line results... when it is done right.

Remember, the tools in this report made these 2 young guys well over a million dollars in revenue in their first year.

The principles can EASILY be applied to YOUR business.

All it takes is some time without distraction, a pen, and a pad of paper.

Take the lessons in this and FIND WAYS to make them fit your own business.

They can easily add some serious dollars to your bank account... IF YOU USE THEM. They don't magically add millions to your pockets... YOU have to do something with them.

Once you do, and you start seeing results, reinvest the additional revenues right away into more marketing, bigger marketing, better marketing. You will easily come out of this recession an entirely new company with a serious surge of cash.

June 25th - LEON Day (LEON is NOEL spelled backwards – 6 months till Xmas)

Ideas: Christmas in June? Why not? Consider launching a Christmas program to get people to start their holiday shopping. By doing this they can prepare their budget – avoid the Christmas rush and the January credit crunch.

Consider even sending out a Christmas cards with your coupon or offer.

Grabber: ornaments, tinsel

June 26th - Fat, drunk King George IV dies from over eating (1830)

Ideas: Similar to Alexander the Great above - could combine the 2 to make for a VERY powerful introduction - 2 of the worlds greatest leaders fall to the simplest of pleasures...

Grabber: Kings Crown, Miniature Platter of Food, Mini Coffin

***"The prospect doesn't give a damn about you, your company or your product.
All that matters is, 'What's in it for me?'"***

-Bob Hacker -

July 4th – Hot Mail Email Service Began (1996)

Idea: 7 Critical Email Marketing Rules

Here's how you can increase your sales numbers and attract a better quality client

Email marketing has transformed the way we can grow businesses. From the costly (yet still highly effective) direct mail world with the postage and printing costs... to the new age of instant delivery and little out-of-pocket costs for a mailing.

Email can bring life to your marketing mix and give your prospects and customers an insiders peak into your personality and business endeavors.

That said, email marketing is not a guaranteed moola maker.

In fact, more of them go wrong than right (despite what nonsense many of the 'gurus' are feeding you this week).

It doesn't take much to sit at your computer like I am doing now, and put together a letter to your clients, much like I am to you right now.

What it DOES take is some grey matter to go into your campaign and some formulas that help ensure your odds are improved.

1) Write to ONE person... not hundreds or thousands. Know who your perfect client is. Know them like your best friend. Know what they would say if they were the one writing their life story in a journal.

What would they tell you?

What are their challenges?

What are their frustrations?

What keeps them awake at night tossing and turning?

If you don't know this – you can't write effective emails to them. They will come across as bland, stale, and without a personal connection. BUT, when you DO know who they are (intimately) your email will strike a chord with them unlike any others they receive. (fyi: I actually got to know my one client so well that I ended up marrying her) 11 years now... twin 9 years daughters to add to the mix. You could say I know her very well

Marriage and kids... the roller coaster ride of your life!

2) Leverage your personality. One of your greatest assets, yet highly unlikely being used to its potential. Here are a few key things you can use in your copy that may help.

The key to this is to let loose. This is a unique way of getting inside your head and finding real life ways to position you and your business in the buyers mind. Don't worry about if it is too much or too little... just dump your thoughts on paper.

Sometimes the most unusual of things about you can be the big breakthroughs we are looking for in the marketing and positioning of you.

Have fun... share freely.

- * Pet Peeves
- * Physical Characteristics (Uniqueness)
- * Core Beliefs
- * Politics
- * Birthplace
- * What Are You Pathological About?
- * Significant Childhood Events
- * Beliefs
- * Hobbies
- * Education

- * Skills
- * Interests
- * Family
- * Talents
- * Life Events You Remember Most
- * Adventures You Will Never Forget
- * Incompetence At?
- * Anything You Are A Legend Of?

If you invest a few hours on this, and write down the points you think of as they come to you, that document will help you write promotions, articles, blog posts and campaigns for years to come.

A definite worthwhile investment.

3) Always try and include something in your promotions that gives an insight, a tip, or something helpful. Even in your promotions, include a PS or a side bar that is helpful. It helps them justify the time they invest in your materials.

4) What makes you unique in your field? Everyone talks about a USP – but, as you’ve probably seen, they are not that simple to create. Ask anyone what the best USPs are, and you will always hear Dominos Pizza, Fedex, etc. Always the same. Why? Because they aren’t that easy to do. Especially in today’s market with soooo many competitors out there – all doing the same thing you are. But there must be something, just one thing, that makes you unique. Right? Find it – then mention it in every email that goes out. Use it on your websites. On your blog. On your invoices. Everywhere you can – spread the word about the one thing that makes you unique. It doesn’t have to be rocket science – Microsoft doesn’t have one – Coke doesn’t have one – even Apple doesn’t have one. So monster success stories didn’t always get that way with an official USP – they just found one or two things they were good at and made that the focus of their marketing.

5) Call to action. Obvious... but not used. Every email you send should have a call to action. That does not mean you sell something every time you email... that is a dangerous path to take. The call to action could be to visit your blog, or reply back with comments, or to fill out a survey (the unsung hero of getting to know your customers). Just ask them to do something.

You should aim for 4 times as much content as promotions.

So one out of every 4 – 5 emails you send can be a promotion.

6) Have more fun with graphics. I am as guilty as charged here – but have been testing different approaches with some retail clients of mine. I found some interesting conversion improves with some very untraditional graphics.

Something I recommend you try.

Think about how people ‘traditionally’ think about your business, product or industry. What is the opposite of that? What graphic could be used to show the 2 opposites? Test it – you may be pleasantly surprised with the results.

7) Always remember Murphy’s Law in your email marketing. If something can go wrong, chances are it will. Pay very close attention to (speaking from my own mess ups): Deadlines are correct, contact details are correct, dates or holidays are the right one (like my mixup on when Canada day is this week – whoops!), etc.

Plan for a contingency.

Think through your email from the point of view of a brand new prospect to your email list. How would they see it? What would they like about it? Dislike about it? Is it worthy of being passed on?

Do your best to factor these 7 rules into your marketing.

July 5th – Work-a-holics Day

Idea: Send out a press release to try and get some media attention on this day. Make sure you read the Checklist for Sending Press Releases section before sending to get the most out of your press release.

news release

for immediate release

Local Business Person Celebrates 'Workaholics Day' on July 5

YOUR CITY, STATE – **Today's Date** – According to Forbes.com, the average Frenchman 18 hours a week; the average Italian about 16.5 and the British work 21.5. But in North America, our idea of full employment is a standard 40-hour week.

Vacations are much shorter than the typical European's, as well. The U.S. worker takes 16 days of vacation each year, less than half that typically taken by the Germans (35 days), the French (37 days) or the Italians (42 days), according to the Wall Street Journal.

With so many workaholics, one local business owner is celebrating Workaholics Day July 5.

On that day, **Your Full Name** will close their doors for the day. "We don't often encourage people to value leisure," says **Your Last Name**, who owns and runs **Name of Business** in **Name of City**, "I believe that people who work hard and get work done quickly should be rewarded with more leisure time rather than with more work."

Your Last Name points to a recent analysis of research completed by the School of Business at Rutgers University showing that workaholics addiction might make it difficult or impossible for the workaholic to perform as an effective member of a team.

"Like many entrepreneurs, I believe in working hard. But simply throwing long hours at work can be inefficient. It leads to 'stay-in-seat mentality' where people will stay late out of compulsion, but not really be productive," says **Your Last Name**. "So by encouraging some time out of 'the seat,' it will actually help revive and refresh the business. I hope other organizations do the same."

Founded in **Year**, **Name of Business** helps **your target market** to **do what by how you do it**.

contact: YOUR NAME
YOUR PHONE NUMBER
YOUR EMAIL ADDRESS HERE

Credit: This press release template is given exclusively to Troy White's Marketing and Promotional Calendar recipients by Shannon Cherry.

Shannon Cherry, APR, MA is The Power Publicist. The founder of Be Heard Solutions (www.beheardsolutions.com) , she helps small business owners and entrepreneurs to attract targeted prospects by using the power of publicity and promotions. Sign up for her free Publicity Power Pack, which gives you access to free publicity and marketing tips, media contacts and more at <http://www.beheardsolutions.com>

July 7th – Sliced Bread is Sold for the 1st time (1928)

Idea: When sliced bread was introduced it was described as "the greatest forward step in the baking industry since bread was wrapped".

Do you have an improvement to a product that makes it better than the original version? If so, today is a great day to show your clients how your product is "the greatest forward step in your industry since...."

July 7th – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

July Examples:

"A lot of parents pack up their troubles and send them off to summer camp" – Raymond Duncan

"While consumers will be in the malls this July, purchases will not be made but the air conditioning will be enjoyed"

"A perfect summer day is when the sun is shining, the breeze is blowing, the birds are singing and the lawn mower is broken"

July 8th - World's first supermarket opens in USA (1912)

Idea: When convenience really matters - share the difference between how things used to be compared to how they are now then compare to your offering and how much easier you will make things

Grabber: mini shopping cart, grocery receipt, savings coupon

July 8th - 1st Ice Cream Sundae Introduced (1881)

Idea: A \$25,000 Sundae was introduced in 2008 (quite an inflation compared to 1881). This golden sundae is a blend of 28 cocoas, including 14 of the most expensive in the world. But wait - it's also infused with 5 grams of edible 23-karat gold and served in a glass goblet lined with a layer of edible gold.

At the base of the goblet is an 18-karat gold bracelet with 1 carat of white diamonds. The sundae is also topped with whipped cream covered with more gold and a side of La Madeline au Truffle from Knipschildt Chocolatier, which sells for \$2,600 a pound.

It is eaten with a gold spoon decorated with white and chocolate-colored diamonds, which can also be taken home.

There is a real solid and profitable lesson here! Besides the fact that there ARE people who are buying this sundae – people will pay these prices for a bite to eat... besides the fact that this ingenuity will get you tens or hundred of thousands of dollars in free publicity... imagine the profits you experience with this technique!

And you DO NOT have to change your entire company. You don't even need to spend a lot of money to get started with this.

You need to think about how you can do and sell something so grand, and outrageously expensive in your industry, that it would immediately get people talking about how crazy you really are.

Having something that out-prices everything else by 4-10 TIMES will immediately stop them in their tracks and get them talking about you. The more people talk, the more you will attract into your sales funnel those who ARE buyers.

And, only logical, that the more real buyers you get at these high prices, the more your profits will start going through the roof.

Put some thought into this over the next couple weeks.

Put some thought into this - what bundle could you add at the high end that will 400% - or 1000% higher than anyone else in the market? Figure something out - write up a press release announcing it and send it out through some of the online newswires like <http://prnewswire.com/> or one of the other big ones.

This IS important because 20% of your customers will buy your higher end offers. Maybe 20% won't buy a \$25,000 Sundae, but I will bet that you will be very pleasantly surprised with the number of orders you get for your new high end bundles.

When your prices are 400% higher than what you are used to, it doesn't take many orders to start seeing substantial revenue and profits gains!

July 26th - All or Nothing Day

Are you going to give it your all today or nothing? Considering it's the lazy days of July - you might want to enjoy and do nothing. But, that doesn't mean you still can't market nothing.

Idea: So how do you create a promotion out of nothing? Exactly that - send nothing. You could just have a blank post on your blog or send out an email with the subject line of "Hey, Nothing Is Going On".

Send it blank. You are sure to arouse some suspicions from your list on why you sent "nothing". They might wonder if you forgot to finish writing or something did not load properly. Just follow-up tomorrow with an explanation of your "nothing" email.

Or send out an email about "nothing" and tie it in with an offer. For example, with the purchase of a "Product A" they will receive "Product B" for free.

Dear Customer,

July 26 is all or nothing day and since I feel like doing nothing - I would like to share a little dialog with you from "Seinfeld" - it is of course a show about "nothing".

Jerry: You want to go with me to NBC?

George: Yeah. I think we really got something here.

Jerry: What do we got?

George: An idea.

Jerry: What idea?

George: An idea for the show.

Jerry: I still don't know what the idea is!

George: It's about nothing!

Jerry: Right.

George: Everybody's doing something. We're do nothing!

Jerry: So, we go into NBC, we tell them we've got an idea for a show about nothing.

George: Exactly.

Jerry: They say, "What's your show about?" I say, "Nothing."

George: There you go.

Jerry (After a moment of pause): I think you may have something there

In honor of All or Nothing Day, I do believe I have something for nothing. Please click here to read more details....(insert your offer)

July 30th - Henry Ford's B-day

Ideas: Famous quotes from Ford "one color only - black", automating things that used to take too much time etc.

Grabber: toy antique car

August 1st - World Wide Web Anniversary (1990)

Idea: What would you do without the world wide web today? If you offer services on the web/e-books or have a website, this is a perfect time to send out a savings to your customer (perhaps 10% off your service or product).

Grabber: Of course, an e-card!

August 5th – Twin Festival Day

Idea: This is a great day to execute a Buy One Get One Free offer – also known as the BOGO model. This model encourages the customer to buy one item and get special terms on other items (such as discounted or free items). It is commonly used in grocery stores however is also being used in the digital world such as download a song and get a ringtone for free. The use of Buy/Get promotions is popular to influence users to consume more of the product they are using and to introduce new products to consumers.

When marketing a BOGO make it personalized to your market – if you are offering digital services – a consumer will not require 2 copies of the same e-book; however it is a good time to introduce a new e-book recommendation (you might want to recommend a few different e-books therefore not limiting their options).

You can easily use this day to offer your clients a BOGO offer. For example, just send out a simple email to your customers letting them know that today you are having a Buy One Get One Free offer.

Subject: The Hollywood Twin Trend

Dear Customer,

It seems with each passing day, another Hollywood star is announcing the conception or birth of twins. Fads are common in Tinseltown and it appears there is some competition to produce twin babies. From Julia Roberts to Angelina Jolie, twins are popping up everywhere. But, it really isn't a trend, just ask the town of Twinsburg, Ohio.

Last year, 2,037 sets of multiples descended into the town to celebrate Twins Day Festival and on August 1st, this year...the amount will increase.

Could this be the new place to be seen for Hollywood twin moms?

I don't know if I would double my bet, but in honor of this day, we are offering a Buy 1 and Get 1 Free....

(Insert Offer)

Top 10 Lessons for Small Business Success As learned from my Twin 3 year olds by Troy White

Small business success is very similar to learning to walk, talk and spell. The basics have to be understood before moving on to the next step. I am blessed to have twin 3 year old girls in my life and am amazed constantly how much I learn from them on a daily basis. As I watch them run around and explore, I find myself realizing just how much my observations apply to being successful and happy in life and in business.

So take heart in the following tips – they may come from little people but they have the power of giants. To your happiness and your success !

1. **No matter how small you are you can change lots of lives** - your goal for starting your business should be to change lives in one way or another. Remember this in everything you do - how can I change my customers lives ?

(Relationship Version - No matter how small the issues are you can always improve your relationship! In every relationship, we come upon hurdles. Some of these hurdles are small while some are huge and are individual to your and your husband. Just remember to never give up and try to work these hurdles out together.)

2. **Climb that wall** - no matter how big the wall is - persistence pays off in the end. Never give up on your dreams and keep on trying.

(Relationship Version - Climb that wall – no matter how big the wall is – persistence pays off in the end. Never give up on your dreams as a couple. Keep on trying. Your dreams are unique to each other – it might be to buy that dream home, have children or move to an exotic country. Dream and work together to reach those goals.)

3. Times when you appear small and frail are when you can **surprise everyone with your hidden strengths**. Everyone in business pays attention to what the big boys are doing and how they became successful. What they miss though is the small businesses that quietly make substantial profits every year. These companies go about their business quietly and draw attention from the customers - not the competition.

(Relationship Version - Surprise each other with your hidden talents. At times, each of you will feel small and frail as life pushes you through different obstacles. Rely on each other's strengths and talents to help each other through life's never-ending challenges.)

4. **Act like a silly goof** whenever and wherever you want – people will never forget you - and that is what every business owner should dream of - sticking in everyone's mind.

(Relationship Version - Act like a silly goof. Whenever and wherever you want – express your love for each other. Don't care about what others are thinking as the two of you dance or run through the streets. Keep your relationship full of fun and ridiculous gestures.)

5. **Remember to share** – People can get very protective of what they learn and how they achieve success. When you have something of value that would benefit others – share ! IT will come back to you one hundred fold . You do have your rights also - protect what is not to be shared and make sure others know it is yours and yours only.

(Relationship Version - Remember to share. In each relationship, you have to give, take and share. From the materialist items to your most personal emotions, keep an open dialogue with your spouse to share all that you can as a couple.)

6. **Run naked every once in a while.** Well ok, you don't have to be naked but run – have fun, be free and try to be a kid again. Having kids gives you that chance again and it is incredible to relive the fun that you used to have – when you weren't so serious about life and business.

(Relationship Version - Run naked every once in awhile. Well, you don't have to run through the streets naked but take check of your sex life. As a couple, your sex life is the one thing that is yours exclusively. Don't let regular life such as stress and fatigue take over from enjoying the human contact you and your husband have dedicated to each other only.)

7. **Lay back on the grass and watch the clouds** go by whenever you have a chance. Reflection and relaxation can be one of the most powerful combinations that you can ask for in your personal and business success – use it !

(Relationship Version - Lay back on the grass and watch the clouds go by. Whenever you have a chance, go reflect and relax together. It is one of the most powerful combinations that you can use for your relationship. Pack up a picnic once and while or go to the park – just do it together and forget about the housework that has to be done or the presentation at work due on Monday.)

8. **Put on a fancy hat** - dress up for the day. Nothing can make you feel like a new person more than a complete change in clothing. Wear something you usually would not wear – or something you have always wanted to wear but were afraid to. In business this one little point can make you stand out from all of the rest. Wear a tacky tie, or a purple shirt, or a new hat every day – your customers will never forget you.

(Relationship Version - Put on a fancy hat. Don't forget to get dressed up and go out on the town for the night. Many couples find they are making a date night just because they are either stuck in a rut in the relationship of watching TV every night or working to late.)

9. **Silence is not always a good thing.** Usually it means something big is brewing and trouble is near. If you find too many of your competitors are quiet or your clients are quieter than usual – figure out why ! Something serious could be happening out there and you better find out what it is.

(Relationship Version - Silence is not always a good thing. If silence seems to be the communication level in your relationship, it usually means something big is brewing and trouble is near. Always talk through your problems, don't let things just go to the side to let it brew in each other's minds. Figure out the problem and fix it as soon as possible!)

10. **Find some sand and let your toes dig in.** Sand has an amazing soothing quality to it. If you do not have sand near your house or business – go buy a bag of sand at your local garden center and put it in a small box you can dip your feet in. Try this when you are working on a tough problem – new ideas will pop into your head in no time.

(Relationship Version - Take naps. Every once and awhile, just go lie down together and talk. Cuddle up to each other and celebrate in the love you have for each other. Fall asleep for an hour in each other arms and wake up to a new energy level together.)

August 8th – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

August Examples:

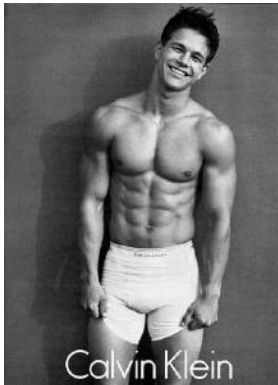
"If you think you're too small to have an impact try going to bed with a mosquito in the room."

"Ah, Summer, what power you have to make us suffer and like it" – Russel Baker

"In my retirement I go for a short swim at least once or twice every day. It's either that or buy a new golf ball. " - Gene Perret

"The tans will fade, but the memories will last forever."

August 13th – National Underwear Day



In 1982, Calvin Klein introduced his underwear line for men, which turned the item into a fashionable item. It no longer was just a practical product but also one with sex appeal. Men such as Antonio Sabto Jr. and Mark Wahlberg bared their briefs through a series of ads for Calvin Klein.

This wasn't the first time that Calvin Klein decided to change advertising by pushing the envelope. In 1980, he featured a 15 year old Brooke Shields purring "Nothing comes between me and my Calvin's" in an ad. Klein has also been criticized for some of his debatable ads featuring ads with children 15 years old and younger. When questioned in 1995 regarding this outcry, Klein replied:

"These campaign ads are not pornographic. The ads were intended to convey the idea that glamour is an inner quality that can be found in regular people in an ordinary setting; it is not something that is exclusive to movie stars and models". AppData/Websites/membercalendar/images/markwahlberg.jpg Regardless of his controversy, Klein has been referred to as a marketing genius and his underwear campaigns have become notorious and has made Calvin Klein underwear a twentieth century icon.

Can adding some sex appeal increase the effectiveness of your ad?

It is true it can attract the customer's attention however misuse of sex appeal can be costly and start brand boycotts and damage brand reputation.

Klein has produced ads which have cost him dearly. In 1999, when he launched an ad campaign for his children's underwear line he featured 2 ads, one with 2 little boys playing on a sofa only in CK underpants and another ad with 2 little girls doing the same. He ran full pages ads in the New York Post and a huge billboard in Manhattan's Times Square.

The public were outraged and the ads were pulled 24 hours later. The public felt the ads sexualized images of children.

If you are considering using sex appeal in your campaigns, make sure you know how your target market is going to react. Studies show that the attractiveness of an endorsing model provokes positive emotional responses but nudity and erotic content might get your customer's attention but it might be the wrong attention you are looking for. So, in essence, sex sells; however when used in good taste.

Adding some sexual appeal to your ad might increase the effectiveness of your ad but remember to be tasteful as your brand reputation is what yields the long-term results.

August 21 - Mona Lisa Stolen (1911)

Idea: Leonardo da Vinci's *Mona Lisa*, one of the most famous paintings in the world, was stolen right off the wall of the Louvre (famous museum in Paris, France). It was such an inconceivable crime, that the *Mona Lisa* wasn't even noticed missing until the following day. The story of the caper was actually much simpler than many had theorized. It takes two years for the mystery to end with the return of the painting on December 30, 1913.

Grabber: Give your customers a mystery to figure out. Create a contest and send your customers clues to figure it out – you could carry out the contest until the end of the year and reveal the winner on December 30? It can be as simple as sending puzzle pieces and then having them put together the puzzle and returning the completed puzzle to you and having a random draw. The key is to engage your customers in wanting to figuring out your mystery and getting them actively participating in your promotion. (See September – Fall Premieres for another idea to tie in with this promotion).

August 25th – Banana Split Day

Idea: Please see June 8th for information on how you can use this day to market your service and/or products.

September – National Coupon Month

Idea: This one is pretty obvious. But – have fun with it. Send a coupon booklet with savings your customers can have year around. Do a year long coupon booklet with different savings for each month. For your slower months, make the savings attractive so you can generate some money for these times. Everyone loves a deal!

September - Fall premieres for Networks

Idea: Still stuck on what type of contest to have for the August 21st Mona Lisa promotion? Select one of the more popular TV shows and ask your clients to figure out what their theory is for the premiere.

September 3rd – eBay founded

Idea: Is it time that you start an eBay store? There are some great benefits with starting an eBay store – if you are a high-volume seller on eBay or are selling large quantities of the same or similar items, it might make sense to start up your own eBay store. With your eBay store you can list items that can run for months at a time (instead of doing the running auction that is usually seven or ten days). Your eBay store is essentially your virtual storefront of your items and is a great way to promote your products.

One of the biggest advantages of having a eBay storefront is that it gives your website a professional look if you currently don't have one, plus it gives you the credibility that you need to reach customers who are looking for a particular product or service on the web. Plus, an eBay storefront gives you the opportunity to reach thousands of people each day and increase the exposure to obtain more! You can find all the information you need on starting up an eBay store on the site itself (www.ebay.com).

September 9th – Bodacious Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

September Examples:

"If there were no schools to take children away from home part of the time, the insane asylums would be filled with mothers" – Edgar W. Howe

"Often when I am reading a good book, I stop and thank my teacher. That is, I used to, until she got an unlisted number" – Author Unknown

"Studying: take the S-T-U off and it's just dying"

September 22nd - Elephant Appreciation Day

Idea: Elephants are known for not forgetting. Has your customer forgot something lately – perhaps they forgot to renew their subscription with you or perhaps it's time for them to use a service you provide (haircut, car repair etc.). If so, use today to remind them.

Dear Customer:

They say an elephant never forgets. We know though that you probably have lots more going on than an elephant. Perhaps that's why you might have forgot that today is Elephant Appreciation Day!

And in honor of today, we would like to remind you that you forgot to renew, service etc.

Grabber: peanuts, toy elephants

September 23rd - 1st movie to become a TV series - How to Marry a Millionaire (1961)

Idea: Do you have a million different ways to help your customer? Send them a note letting them know that they don't need to "marry" a millionaire because you have solutions on how to make them millions or by using your product and/or service you can save them millions.

Grabber: A fake million dollar bill or check

National Pizza Month (October)

Who'd have thought that a pizza take out joint would have such savvy marketers?

I received a letter in the mail (not addressed to me personally, they had blanketed neighborhoods near them - hint).

On the front was a letter with a bag of flour attached to it with a staple.

The letter began... "Dear Neighbor, Why have I attached a little tiny bag of flour to this letter? Here is why:" and the letter then goes on to talk about their 'secret flour' the chemical structure of their flour, the high protein content, where they get their flour, and why they pay more for their flour than the competition does.

They do an excellent job building their pizza dough and ingredients up, and play down the inferior ingredients the competition uses, which explains why they have "limp, often soggy, pizza crust".

They talk about how theirs is hand made daily, in-house, while others farm it out to outside companies who mass produce a cheaper, lower quality dough that shows up ready.

Then they have a 100% guarantee: "if it's not the best you've ever eaten, we'll refund your purchase price. In fact, when you stop by in the next two weeks, I'd like you to have our signature Caesar salad with your dinner (my treat)"

Then they have a coupon at the bottom with the free Caesar salad and Focaccia bread.

This is brilliant.

And why can YOU use the exact same idea?

You can... excuses will not be tolerated here.

You may not have a pizza business... but your business IS NO DIFFERENT.

The stupidest excuse I hear out there is just that "my business is different. that stuff won't work for me. my clients are different. my suppliers are different. we sell based on price. whine. whine. whine."

You are completely WRONG if that is coming out of your mouth.

- * You have a product or service to sell.
- * You need buyers.
- * Your buyers need to understand what makes you different.
- * You need to prove to them you are worthy supplier and they should give you at least a try.

Sound familiar?

You can attach a bag with a component of your product. You can have a picture of you delivering the service. You can have a picture with a happy customer sharing their feedback. You can find SOMETHING that will make this strategy work for you.

I spoke with the guy who owns this pizza place (we have ordered from them a few times - as have all our friends when I told them about this offer). He won't share numbers...but he said it has done VERY WELL for them.

And it will for you too.

So, no more excuses. This works exceptionally well... especially when people are looking for good reasons to buy somewhere else (and it is NOT always about price - read the statistics - the affluent market spent 29% more in the last quarter than the previous).

THEY ARE BUYING... are you selling to them?

Use this simple model, and at least give it a try.

Something important I forgot to mention: The letter came BEFORE the brochure. Yes, they had a typical pizza brochure, but the letter was stapled to the front of it. Instead of "Oh, another pizza brochure", which is what 99% of people would have done, they said "what is this letter, with this bag attached? This looks interesting".

Goal #1 in your marketing is ALWAYS to get them reading or paying attention. Once you get them reading, your chance of a sale go up dramatically. Once you have their attention, it becomes much easier to get them to try you out, especially when you use ideas like this pizza parlor.

2nd Week of October – Mystery Series Week

Idea: Big retailers have been using mystery shoppers for years to find out what the experience is like for their customers? Do you know what your service experience is like at your company? During Mystery Series Week perhaps it's time you do. Marketing isn't just what you say or do but how and what you do. Here are a few things you should do this week:

- Send someone to ghost shop to see how your entire sales process is going
- Are your employees fixing problems? If so, give an incentive for them to do so.
- Are your employees telling you about problems that have happened? If so, reward them for doing so – sticking your head in the sand and pretending everything is running along tickity boo is NOT a business strategy.
- Do your employees share your passion for your business? If no, then why are you having them represent you?
- Make sure your customers are satisfied (create a customer survey) – do everything in your power to make sure they are satisfied – if you don't – they might end up telling everyone about the bad service they received.

October 10th – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

October Examples:

"October. This is one of the peculiarly dangerous months to speculate stocks in. The others are July, January, September, April, November, May, March, June, December, August and February" – Mark Twain

"If you haven't found something strange during the day, it hasn't been much of a day" – John A. Wheeler

The leaves fall patiently
Nothing remembers or grieves
The river takes to the sea
The yellow drift of leaves
- Sara Teasdale

October 16th - Boss's Day (National Bosses Day)

Idea: "There is only one boss. The customer. And he can fire everybody in the company from the chairman on down, simply by spending his money somewhere else."- Sam Walton.

Where is your customer spending their money? Recognize your customers this Bosses Day and let them know that they are "boss" of your company. This would be a great time to have your customers fill out a survey on how you can improve your service to them.

Or send your customers a letter telling them that you are giving them a raise! Offer your customers a product or service which will increase their earnings.

Grabber: Simple little gift or card

October 17th – Sweetest Day

Idea: Who knew? That it's not Halloween or Valentines day – it's the sweetest day that the candy industry sells 75% of their business during this holiday. Herbert Birch Kingston, a philanthropist and candy company employee wanted to bring happiness into the lives of orphans and others who were forgotten. With the help of friends, he began to distribute candy and small gifts to the underprivileged. The tradition caught on with movie star Ann Pennington presenting 2,200 Cleveland newspaper boys with boxes of candy to express gratitude for their service to the public. Another popular movie star, Theda Bara, distributed 10,000 boxes of candy to people in Cleveland hospitals and also gave candy to all who came to watch her film in a local theater.

Celebrate this unique holiday by sending your customer a letter letting them know how sweet it is to have them as your customer. Appreciation for the simple things in life and the little surprises is one of the trends that fuels this celebration.

Grabbers: It's all about sweetness...send candies, cakes or chocolates. You could also send your favorite desert recipe; alternatively write your letter on a recipe card.

October 23rd - Television Talk Show Host Day

Idea: It's time to give people a reason to start talking about you! Try creating a unique angle or a memorable service that will get people talking.

For example, movie theaters tapped into the market of new parents by offering the "Stars and Strollers" program. The Stars and Stroller program allows adult patrons and their babies or toddlers to enjoy movies in a baby-friendly environment. They don't have to worry about upsetting other guests with crying babies; show times include dimmed lighting allowing parents to see children clearly, lowered volume levels and stroller parking.

Well, guess what? Mother's started talking. The program was such a success that the theaters started offering evening times in addition to the regular weekly screenings so that both parents could attend and make a night out of it.

***I use the oldest words in the English language.
People think I'm an ignorant bastard who doesn't***

***I know the ten-dollar words.
There are older and better words which,
if you arrange them
in the proper combination,
you make it stick.***

- Ernest Hemingway -

October 25th – Make A Difference Day

Idea: Send out a press release to try and get some media attention on this day. Make sure you read the Checklist for Sending Press Releases section before sending to get the most out of your press release.

news release

for immediate release

Local Business Owner Participates in “Make a Difference Day” on October 25

YOUR CITY, STATE – **Today's Date** – Local business owner **YOUR FULL NAME** is contributing to Make a Difference Day on October 25 by **WHAT YOU WILL BE DOING**.

Since initiated in 1990, Make a Difference Day has become one of the world's largest day of volunteering. More than three million Americans participated in it 2007.

“Besides the other charitable things **NAME OF BUSINESS** does throughout the year, I wanted to really make a statement about the importance of community to business,” says **YOUR LAST NAME**, “I challenge other business owners to participate in Make a Difference Day. It's time to step up and take an active interest in the well-being of our community.”

Participation is simple: identify a need in your community, put together a team of co-workers and plan your project. You can also register the project on line to help publicize your project and recruit volunteers at <http://www.usaweekend.com/diffday>.

Founded in **Year**, **Name of Business** helps **your target market** to **do what** by **how you do it**.

contact: **YOUR NAME**
YOUR PHONE NUMBER
YOUR EMAIL ADDRESS HERE

Credit: This press release template is given exclusively to Troy White's Marketing and Promotional Calendar recipients by Shannon Cherry.

Shannon Cherry, APR, MA is The Power Publicist. The founder of Be Heard Solutions (www.beheardsolutions.com) , she helps small business owners and entrepreneurs to attract targeted prospects by using the power of publicity and promotions. Sign up for her free Publicity Power Pack, which gives you access to free publicity and marketing tips, media contacts and more at <http://www.beheardsolutions.com>

October 31st - Halloween

Idea: One of the biggest adult holidays and the 2nd biggest kid's holiday of the year. Be prepared for this fun holiday!

Grabbers: Skeleton Cardboard Decorations, Grim Reapers, Hanging Jack-o-Lantern Decorations, Candy

Here is a sample letter that can be used using a skeleton as your grabber.

Fellow _____,

As you can see, I've attached a Skeleton to the top of this letter. Why have I done this? Actually, there are two reasons:

1. I have something very important to tell you and I needed some way to make sure this letter would catch your attention.

2. And second, since what I'm writing about **concerns skeletons in your closet**.

Here's what it's all about:

You know as well as I do, your customers are the ones that pay your bills. So why do you hide that fact? Keeping things that important locked up in a closet, can be very dangerous to your long-term profitability.

Your customers NEED to know you care... and that you appreciate their business.

Yes, you probably said thanks when they bought... but have you been in touch with them since? You should be on a bi-weekly basis. They do want to hear from you, as long as you have something interesting to say!

Which brings me to the point of this letter and skeleton in the closet idea...

I want to HELP.

I have a simple new tool you can use to keep in touch with your clients more.

It will show them you care - and will bring them closer to you in the end (which means they will buy more from you on an ongoing basis).

Here is what you can now do:

(Add In Offer)

National Novel Writing Month

What is the most profitable daily action you can take?

When it comes to marketing and growing a business, entrepreneurs tend to get stuck as to what they should be doing next to reach their yearly goals and objectives. They go from placing ads, to using coupon books, maybe some yellow page space, possibly even the odd mail out to people.

Which are all part of the marketing mix.

But, one of the most profitable daily things you can start doing is writing. No, you do not have to aim to write a book (although a book can be one of your greatest lead generation tools)... nor do you need to write a masterpiece.

Writing for 15 minutes a day (at minimum) will grow your business faster than you could ever imagine (especially if you have never used this technique before).

Things to write about:

Client case studies – their experiences with your company, your service, your products

Life – people love to hear about your personal life, dreams, goals, and ambitions. This does require you stepping out of your comfort zone (which is very good thing)... but you will immediately begin create a relationship with your clients that will last for many years to come.

Your staff – write about them, how much they help you, how much you appreciate them. Also try writing short articles from their perspective about working with you, about working direct with the clients, about their lives and experiences or dreams and ambitions.

Seriously, writing for 15 – 30 minutes a day will do amazing things to grow your income – and your expertise.

You will have to commit to this – as once a month is a waste of your time (although it is better than nothing).

How to use your writings:

- Newsletters
- Blogs
- Websites
- Booklets for lead generation
- Sales Letters
- Brochures
- Tip Sheets
- White Papers
- Use as audio cd
- Email follow ups
- Postcards
- Catalog copy
- Coaching program material
- Articles for on and offline

An easy way to get going if you find yourself stuck to start writing:

List out 3 of the topics you would like to write about on the top of the page. Set a timer for 5 minutes Press start on the timer. Without thinking about it, start writing using the 3 topics you wrote out – you must mention all 3 topics in the first paragraph Write for 5 minutes (even if it is rambling writing that makes no sense at first) When the timer goes off, stop writing

Do it again, or continue on from where you started for another 5 minutes... then another... then another
This helps break through a writers block – and it does work if you try it. Once you use this technique for a while it will be much easier to write without this method. 5 minute chunks keeps it simple.

(HINT: shut off phones and DO NOT check emails while doing these drills)

If you commit to doing this for the next 6 months, you WILL experience profound breakthroughs (and profits) in your business. It has happened to me – and it will for you too... guaranteed!

Thomas Smith wrote a guide called Successful Advertising in 1885.

Some of his most profound words then, which apply just as much today:

The first time people look at any given ad, they don't even see it.

The second time, they don't notice it.

The third time, they are aware that it is there.

The fourth time, they have a fleeting sense that they've seen it somewhere before.

The fifth time, they actually read the ad.

The sixth time they thumb their nose at it.

The seventh time, they start to get a little irritated with it.

The eighth time, they start to think, "Here's that confounded ad again."

The ninth time, they start to wonder if they're missing out on something.

The tenth time, they ask their friends and neighbors if they've tried it.

The eleventh time, they wonder how the company is paying for all these ads.

The twelfth time, they start to think that it must be a good product.

The thirteenth time, they start to feel the product has value.

The fourteenth time, they start to remember wanting a product exactly like this for a long time.

The fifteenth time, they start to yearn for it because they can't afford to buy it.

The sixteenth time, they accept the fact that they will buy it sometime in the future.

The seventeenth time, they make a note to buy the product.

The eighteenth time, they curse their poverty for not allowing them to buy this terrific product.

The nineteenth time, they count their money very carefully.

The twentieth time prospects see the ad, they buy what is offering.

1st Week of November – World Communication Week

Idea: Send out a press release to try and get some media attention on this day. Make sure you read the Checklist for Sending Press Releases section before sending to get the most out of your press release.

news release

for immediate release

Local Business Person Celebrates “World Communication Week”

YOUR CITY, STATE –**Today's Date** –Face-to-face communication at the work place is declining rapidly. While tools like E-mail, telephone, instant message, and intranet score high on convenience and speed, they lack the warmth and emotion that face-to-face communication provides.

A local business owner is celebrating the “World Communication Week” (November 1-7) stressing the importance of face-to-face communication.

On November 1, **Your Full Name**, who owns and runs **Name of Business** in **Name of City** will launch a week-long “talk-in-person” campaign to encourage his/her employees to communicate face-to-face with co-workers, clients, family and friends.

“We email. We wiki. We blog. We IM. We convince ourselves that as long as we can write well, we can experience real communication through text alone. We are lost in digitality”, says **Your Last Name**.

“However, 55 per cent of meaning in an interaction comes from facial and body language and 38 per cent comes from vocal inflection. Only seven per cent of an interaction’s meaning is derived from the words themselves.”

Your Last Name also points to a Harvard Business School research project which has found that the more managers communicated electronically, the more pressing became the need for face-to-face meetings.

“Technology and supporting software are important to effective communications. In fact, they’re critical components. But they will never replace face-to-face communications,” **he/she** says.

Founded in **Year**, **Name of Business** helps **your target market** to **do what** by **how you do it**.

contact: YOUR NAME
YOUR PHONE NUMBER
YOUR EMAIL ADDRESS HERE

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November 3rd - National Sandwich Day

Idea: Take your client out to lunch.

People prefer to do business with people they like and there is no better way to get to know someone better than sharing a meal.

There is an opportunity everyday to share a meal with a prospect, client or associate – so try not to miss the opportunities! Make sure you go prepared and watch your business grow.

Grabber: Send a note to your customer to meet you at a specific deli. You could create just a simple note like this:

Would Love To Meet With You!

Come celebrate National Sandwich Day with me!

It's going to be a deli-cious time!

November 11th – Bodacious Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

November 11th's Bonza Bottler Day is even better than the others. It is the Bodacious Bonza Bottler Day (11/11/11) and you might want to make an even bigger offer to your clients – or even have a party to celebrate this Bonza Bottler Day.

November Examples:

"The problem with winter sports is that – follow me closely here – they generally take place in winter" – Dave Barry

"Snowflakes are one of nature's most fragile things but just look what they do when they stick together" – Verna M. Kelly

"Fallen leaves lying on the grass in the November sun bring more happiness than the daffodils" – Cyril Connolly

November 20th - McDonald's made its 50 billionth hamburger (1984)

Idea: According to Ray Kroc (founder of McDonald's) - "If you work just for money, you'll never make it, but if you love what you're doing and you always put the customer first, success will be yours." Use Ray Kroc's philosophy and let your customer's know that you are "lovin' it"! Send your customers a letter letting them know how much you love what you do. Let them know that you put them first in your business. Other McDonald slogans include:

- What you want is what you get
- It's a good time for the great taste of McDonalds
- Nothing can do it like McDonald's
- You deserve a break today...at McDonald's
- We love to see you smile

Grabber: McDonald's coupons!

November 25th – Black Friday & November 28th - Cyber Monday

Idea: Black Friday is not an official holiday, but many employers give the day off, allowing consumers to get a head start on their Christmas shopping. Retailers are decorated weeks beforehand and many retailers in the US open at midnight on Thursday evening or very early (typically 5am) offering doorbuster deals! If you have an on-line website selling product – Cyber Monday is your day! Cyber Monday is the on-line version of Black Friday. The term, coined by retailer network Shop.org, refers to the day when many people log

on at work to look for gifts they didn't manage to buy over the long Thanksgiving weekend. It has been seen as the start of the online holiday shopping season. So – make sure you have your website or store up & ready offering holiday specials.

Here are a few ways to motivate your visitors to buy:

- Use the first fold of your web site to build urgency -- and pack in the benefits for holiday shoppers!
- **URGENCY BUILDERS:** Another thing you could include in your first fold is a little "countdown" box that tells your visitors exactly how many days are left to Christmas, or to the shipping deadline for gifts to arrive in time
- **AN OPT-IN OFFER** that speaks to the needs of holiday shoppers. For example, you could put together a Holiday Buying Guide" that tells people more about your products and explains why they'd make great gifts.
- **HOLIDAY SPECIALS AND DISCOUNTS:** Make sure you offer some special deals on your products to entice your visitors to buy! How about an early-bird deal if your customers make a purchase before a certain date? Or a special discount for those panicky last-minute shoppers?
- You could offer a two-for-one deal, or even a "holiday gift set" that combines two or more of your products in a gift-ready package!
- **YOUR SHIPPING INFORMATION:** If you're able to offer free or discounted shipping, be sure to include some mention of it in the top fold of your site.
- **PROVIDE AN IRONCLAD SHIPPING GUARANTEE** so customers know their gifts will arrive in time. You'll want to put it where your customers can see it right away, at the top of your right- or left-hand sidebar.
- **YOUR RETURN POLICY:** Be sure to let your customers know you offer a no-questions-asked return policy for a certain period after the holidays. It'll give them the extra boost of confidence they need to make a purchase.
- **FREE GIFT-WRAPPING SERVICE:** It's another great way to give your customers an extra perk without much additional cost to you. For the cost of some paper and ribbon, you can make any humble package look like a fabulous holiday gift!
- Reduce your refund rate by offering gift certificates that let recipients choose their own present! Offer free or discounted shipping -- as well as guaranteed delivery dates for last-minute shoppers!
- Create an email promotion that solves your subscribers' holiday shopping problems and compels them to buy!

8 Steps To Maximizing Your Holiday Promotions

1) First thing you need to do is make them an offer they can't refuse. And the easiest way to do that is to bundle your products and services in new 'holiday packages' that are not available at any other time of the year.

Why? Because they are looking for a deal. A deal they can't find anywhere else - and it doesn't mean the cheapest price either... it means the most attractive offer.

Do you have multiple products and services?

Have you created an inventory of your products and services? Do it - right now... the results will amaze you.

List off every product, service, report, package, or incentive you have for your clients.

Then fit like-minded products together in a few different ways - have a Silver, Gold, and Platinum package arrangement ranging from inexpensive to medium ticket price to high end price tag.

For example, maybe you run a massage business.

You could offer a 60 minute massage, a book on at-home- stress-relief, an audio complete with soothing music, massage oil for at home use, and a couple nice candles to top it off.

Let's say you price this at \$75 - which is the perfect price point for many lower end gifts - package it up nicely with gift certificates on nice paper, a basket, wrapped up professionally.

Your gold offer - monthly massages for 6 months, free spa products, the book as above - plus one more on creating your own spa at home, the candles and oil also included, plus a nice pair of slippers for lounging. Price tag - \$500

Your platinum - 12 months worth of massages, all of the above, plus a facial and pedicure every other month (done by someone you subcontract with). This for \$750.

This gives you 3 very nice packages that you can offer your clients... packages that are not available at any other time of the year.

Bundle them up real nice and have them wrapped up like a pro - and you will make a very attractive offer for your clients that are looking for simple gifts they can buy - right up to the husbands who will pay the big ticket price tag knowing that the gift they are giving their wife will be very much appreciated for the next 12 months.

2) Use some interesting numbers in your bundle and promotions. For example, why not have a year end bundle sale that saves them 20.08% off the purchase price?

You can have all the promotional material with the 20.08% OFF theme... it is different and stands out from everyone else (key right now)... and it incents them to buy the bundle, rather than the smaller packages.

3) Use some unusual cartoons and artwork for your holiday promotions. Last year, I used this Santa cartoon for my Wild West Christmas Bash and it was very well received (people LOVE a funny cartoon and you can get them done custom for you for under \$50 at www.cashcartoons.com.)

4) Make sure people know you have holiday bundles and specials available on your website. Take your hints from Google and OrientalTrading. They switch up the holiday banners on the main pages regularly.

Have a fun graphic done with you in a Santa suit... or an elf outfit... or riding in a sled dropping presents... or, or, or. The CashCartoons.com team can do pretty well any type of cartoon you want.

Once you have them ready... use them everywhere. On the top banner of your website. In your emails. On your invoices and with stuffers that go with your invoices. On your business cards.

Even have some voice over work done for a Christmas greeting on your answering machine.

Now is the time to have some FUN!

One client I coach is chomping at the bit to roll out his holiday viral video contest idea I gave him. One that involves kids, clients, messes made by the kids... and some great laughs that is guaranteed to drive a ton of traffic to his site this season.

Video is perfect for this... all you need to do is find a video professional that can help you put it together in a short period of time.

5) Product launched out? Well, chances are your clients aren't. While most of us in the marketing world feel abused by all the launches out there... most people have no clue such a thing even exists. Find ways to tie in a weekly holiday gift launch. Or a daily special

Make sure they know that each product launch or bundle opportunity is only available for X amount of days. Anytime you can have a proper deadline (a real deadline and scarcity draw... unlike many others out there) you will immediately increase your response.

6) Offer existing customers a Platinum membership and upgrade... for free. Give them a gift for being a devoted customer and give them gifts, extra discounts, membership cards and benefits.

Everyone loves an unexpected gift... and they are much more likely to buy when they experience this.

7) Get promoting... NOW! Time is running out. How do you get the word out?

- Postcards - simple - easy - great way to drive traffic to your holiday bundle sales page.
- Direct mail - send them a simple letter to tell them what kind of special deals you have put together for them this year.
- Phone calls - call all the customers and prospects that you have their numbers.
- Personalized faxes to people who have bought from you before.

A Warning Though... if you are going through all this effort and work to improve your holiday sales - you had better make sure your message is done right.

- The web page sales pitch you use must convince them to buy.
- The sales copy you use must compel them to take action.
- The image you are portraying to your clients and prospects must show them you know what you are doing - and will treat them with the utmost of respect.



Some wording to be using in your promotions at this time of year:

Gathering	Nutcracker	Bethlehem
Harvest	Sleigh	North Pole
Christmas	Candy Canes	Resolutions
Decorations	Blessings	Family
Festival	Peace	Feast
Holiday	Hope	Jingle Bells
Cheers	Joy	Reindeer
Happy	Stockings Mistletoe	Hug
Greetings	Nativity	Kiss
Gifts	Sweetest	Love
Ribbon	Reindeer	Rudolph
Surprises	Old-Fashion	Feliz Navidad
Ornaments	Yule	Jolly
Gifts	Elves	Worship
Wreath	Celebrate	Dance
Ho Ho Ho	Homecoming	
Snowman		

8) Don't be timid about the language you use. We are becoming way too politically correct with our wording around the holidays.

I heard the other day they are now thinking of changing Halloween to "Orange and Black Day" (maybe this is a Canadian thing... or maybe it has spread to other countries).

People are scared to say Merry Christmas now... because this "politeness" (I have another word for it) has gone too far.

Don't be scared about enjoying your holidays and making sure EVERYONE knows you do.

You will attract the right kinds of buyers... and get rid of those who are too easily offended by traditions that have spanned generations... even centuries and millenniums.

Trying to appeal to everyone is the worst thing you can do.

Be yourself this holiday season in your promotions... have some fun... be unusual... and give them some good reasons to buy from you.

Find a few ways to make these lessons work for your business ...

December 6th – First Taxi Cabs in London (1897)

Idea: December is a month of many parties and as such the consumption of alcohol. It's a good time to remind your clients that you care about their safety and not to drink and drive. Taxi cabs were introduced for a reason and you could offer your clients a taxicab voucher for them to use throughout the xmas season (you would need to set a budget and contact your local taxi cab company to see if it is possible for them to issue a \$5.00 coupon for taxi use).

Another idea, would be to set aside a few nights and tell your customer that you will come pick them up as sometimes getting a taxi during this month can be quite difficult. A great time for you to have your customer's attention (well – depending on how much they have drank).

Grabber: Taxi Cab Vouchers

December 9th – 1st Christmas Card Sent

Have you send out your Christmas cards to your customers yet? If not, make it a priority today. Sending Christmas cards are not only a tradition but let's your customer's know that they are important to you. It also helps you further establish a relationship with them.

December 12th – Bonza Bottler Day

Idea: Please see January 1st for further explanation of Bonza Bottler Day.

The Bonza Bottler Day gives you an opportunity every month to reach out to your customers. You can simply send out a Happy Bonza Bottler Day email or send out a note/postcard specific to that month using a humorous/inspirational quote and add in a monthly Bonza Bottler Special.

December Examples:

"If you ever have to steal money from your kid, and later on he discovers it's gone, I think a good thing to do is to blame it on Santa Claus" – Jack Handy

"Santa Claus has the right idea: visit people once a year" – Victor Borge

"How did it get so late so soon? Its night before its afternoon. December is here before its June. My goodness how the time has flewn.
How did it get so late so soon?" – Dr. Seuss

May you have the gladness of Christmas which is hope;
The spirit of Christmas which is peace;
The heart of Christmas which is love.
- Ada V. Hendricks

Your Cash Flow Calendar Creativity Connection

THE TOOL KIT

Let's start with getting some important tools together to start your path of idea generation. This kit contains tools that are critical to discovering your future profit powerhouse.

- **A NOTEBOOK!** Any kind will do. But, keep it personal and yours. A notebook will work fine but perhaps a funky journal from a bookstore is more your style. This notebook is now your best friend. It goes everywhere with you! It replaces your purse or your briefcase. It will end up holding the most powerful information inside of it. Something so simple can have so much power if it is used properly !
- **A PEN!** Not just any ordinary pen but a pen you are comfortable writing with and one that sparks you to want to write.
- **POST-IT NOTES!** If your notebook is not handy – you need to keep those ideas before you forget them. Keep yourself armed with post-it notes around you constantly.
- **DIFFERENT COLORED PENS, FELTS & CRAYONS!** When was the last time you wrote with a crayon? Try it again – you will be amazed at how such a simple tool can make your ideas flow much easier.
- **CONSTRUCTION PAPER OR A SCRAPBOOK!** Flipping through a magazine and something catches your eye? Use it. You never know when this idea might generate yours. Glue it to the paper or throw it into a scrapbook.
- **AN ALARM CLOCK!** This is so you don't focus on time during some of the exercises. Whenever time amounts are specified for activities or exercises, set your clock so you don't waste time worrying about the time.
- **DESIRE TO MAKE A CHANGE IN YOUR LIFE !** Perhaps the most important tool in your kit is desire. This one quality will take you to new heights and will guarantee you success in business and in life. Find it, keep it and nourish it – the power of desire can overcome almost anything !

NOTE: A very sad fact on the internet is that less than 20% of the people that purchase books on how to make money actually use the information. Please use the information here, come up with some ideas for your publishing business and get going – TODAY ! I do not want you to be one of the 80% that never use the information. So I am here to help – if at any point in this course you want clarification or help, please email me at troy@smallbusinesscopywriter.com

ASSESSING YOUR SITUATION

What things in your current life situation do you not like? If you could change one thing, what would it be? Chances are that you do have something you want to change about your life – otherwise you probably wouldn't be reading this. What if each one of us changed something in our life to improve it – or to make ourselves happier – wouldn't the world be a better place?

What are your reasons?

Money

Early Retirement

Time for hobbies

Time for family and friends

Time to read

Security for your future

Time to travel

Write down these reasons on a piece of paper or 3 x 5 cards and place it where you can see it at all times. It is your motivator. It is what is going to drive you to your success. Once you commit things to paper it seems to flip a switch inside of you and things start to happen. And not only write down the reasons but write down what each reason means to you – you want more money - why ? Maybe for a newer car, house, holidays ? Write them down and be specific with numbers or fixed dates to push you along.

(Eg – I will spend 15 hours per week more with my family. I will pay off all outstanding credit card debt within 60 days. I will have my start up business running within 60 days from now.)

Warm Ups

There are a number of phases you will have to go through to find your million dollar ideas, the first of which is the warm up. This consists of exercises designed to help you clear your mind and find the right state that you need to be in to begin your mental workout. These warm-up activities should become habitual daily activities. Everyday try to make the time to do these activities. If you can't seem to find the time for all activities at least try to incorporate one of these activities daily.

- **WRITE!** Write for the next 11 days, every day for 10-20 minutes in your notebook. Sit down and write about anything – even if it is something like “this exercise is dumb, my pen is not working right, my hand hurts, boy I wish it was the weekend then I can go do...” and so on. It doesn't matter what you write about, only that you write.

This helps clear your mind of all those daily things our mind gets trapped into. Try it and stick with it for at least the 11 days – I dare you! See what happens. Now this is a longer-term exercise that you need to keep up even if you find your great product idea right away. Writing will help keep your mind clear and focused. You might find that you never stop this.

This is an exercise that will change your life if you do it – please give it a chance ! There is an immense amount of insight within you waiting to come out and be heard. Your writing will help you find new product ideas and partnerships to follow, solutions to on-going issues you have, easy answers to questions and so on. The following exercises contain writing exercises so please start to write – like it or not ☺ If you want to succeed in life try this – guarantee it will bring you much closer than you are today.

- **FOCUS!** Write down a question or concern in your notebook. Set the alarm clock for 3 minutes. Close your eyes and concentrate on this for 3 minutes. The question can be anything such as:
 - a. What subject do I want to produce a guide on?
 - b. Where can I help others the most?
 - c. What skills do I have that are valuable to others?
 - d. What career path should I follow?
 - e. Why is the sky blue?
 - f. What type of business could I start and be successful in?
 - g. Where would my talents be of the most use to others?

Write down all those thoughts about that question in your notebook once finished. Don't do anything with it right now – just keep writing in your notebook.

- **DAYDREAM!** Go to your favourite place (a coffee shop, your bedroom). Do not take anything to read but do take your journal to write anything down that comes to mind. Just hang out and think for at least 10 - 20 minutes. Imagine what your life would be like if...Picture it, live it in your mind – how does it feel?
- **DRAW!** Use those crayons from your tool kit! Buy a colouring book if that helps or just draw, doodle, colour, write out your grocery list – anything. Just make sure you use your crayons.
- **LISTEN!** Music is very powerful – close your eyes while you are listening. Listen to your favourite song with the volume turned up (to help the brain's juices flow). Listen to some of your favourite music – and listen loud! If needed, use headphones to keep the neighbours at bay, but loud music can get those brain juices flowing. Then pick some music you never listen to – if you usually like rock and roll, listen to classical or jazz or country. Classical music has been proven time and time again to improve blood flow to the brain and greatly improve your thought process.
- **TIME!** Watch the alarm clock from your kit. Get comfortable and watch the second hand go around for 2 – 3 minutes. Try to quiet your mind by counting one-one thousand, two-one thousand, etc. Notice how slowly the second hand moves when you are in deep concentration. This is tough to do but is very helpful with focus. Practice this daily.
- **TOUCH!** Clasp your hand together in front of you with fingers interlocking. Notice which thumb is on top. Now re-clasp your hands with the other thumb on top. Focus on this task. This is a small exercise that shows how change can be difficult to accept at first but is much easier with practice.

BRAIN BOOSTER TIPS

- Eat foods containing barley and/or high concentrate carbohydrates – proven to build up memory and increase brain blood flow – critical for proper creativity and brainstorming attitudes.

- Get some exercise! I am not going to go into all the physiological benefits of exercise – you know it so just get out there and do it – go for a walk, run, power walk or even just sit around outside- that fresh air can do wonders. Start slow and build up to a good pace. When that blood gets flowing and your heart starts beating faster you will be amazed at the thoughts and ideas that start popping up in your mind.
- Get some relaxation or meditation music to sooth and clear your mind. With technology now it is easy to find this music and download it for free or next to free. Indulge in your favourite pastimes. Go walking, running; go to restaurants, cafes, coffee shops, pubs, the gym, play music, listen to music, paint, draw, sculpt, read, etc... The list can go on but it is up to you to write down everything that interests you.
- Use your lunch hours and after hours. Take your notebook with you to work – or, if it is too noticeable, go to the dollar store and buy a smaller notebook that will fit in your pocket. Always keep it with you to write down ideas and insights.
- Always keep thinking about this question “How can I _____?” This is where you need to go back to your list of things you want to have in your life.

I have a basic formula I use to create and evaluate new ideas. This is the exact formula I used to build a list of 300 ideas in no time at all.

This is what I recommend but I also think that some people have their own system they prefer – if it works – do it.

The 5 Step Profitable Idea Kit – EIDOP (sounds like eye drop)

Step 1 – Explore – Gather information about everything. The exercises you will find in here will help you analyze areas of your life that you should focus on for your information products. Lets say you decide you collect stamps as a hobby and you have decided to write an ebook on this subject. Start researching the market – online, offline, library, stores etc. Collect as much information as you can find. I would recommend listing off right away the exercises that you like the most – write down your answers to them immediately upon reading them. Then do the ones you don’t like the sounds of – because they are probably the ones that will work the best for you !

Step 2 – Imagination – Generate a ton of ideas with the use of creativity and brainstorming techniques outlined here. Try and get your mind used to blurting out ideas without criticism. And keep on blurting until you can blurt no more. Do not pick any ideas – just keep writing them down

Step 3 – Devise – Select an idea through using your common sense, your research and further brainstorming and narrowing ideas here. Figure out which markets will pay for your information. Who are the experts in this field, what is lacking for information with this idea.

Step 4 – Optimize – Improve the idea by testing in the different means listed in the Marketing section. You need to test to find out what works best and what else you can change or add to your offering to make it 10 times better than anything else out there.

Step 5 – Perseverance – Never give up on your vision and your dream. There will be rough times – guaranteed! Show me something in life that does not have a bumpy path to achievement. But the key here is to keep testing different methods until you find some that work. And there is a million different tools available to you for free or inexpensive testing. Lots of them are listed in the resource guide at the end and there is many others I will be recommending to you over time via email.

So here you have a system that is proven, tested tried and true. Use it in your discovery and you will easily create 300 profitable ideas in 11 days. The key now thought is to get started with your discovery and do not look back. Remember, if there is ever anything you want clarification or help with to email me at troy@smallbusinesscopywriter.com or call me toll free at 403-259-4566.

STAYING FOCUSED

Staying focused on the project at hand can be hard. This is one of the biggest issues that I have always struggled with myself. I am an ideas-person so I always have way too many ideas floating around in my head. And that leads me to get on a tangent on one, two or three ideas at once, which in effect means I am not giving any one idea the focus it requires. So what can you do to stay focused on ideas and projects? Here are a few things that have worked for myself:

- **Get a day timer** – they cost as little as \$10.00 for a decent one – one that shows a week at a time with room on each day to write things down. This lets you plan a week out easily and see at quick glance what you need to get done.
- Turn those dreams and objectives into **to-do items and deadlines** to move forward. Put these dates in your day timer. Make sure that these are realistic though – do not tell yourself that you will write a book and have it published within 2 weeks if you have never done it before. Say it will take 6 months to write and publish. But you need to start writing – give yourself 2 weeks to have 20 pages – 1.5 pages a day. Break it down to smaller chunks to be more manageable and feasible.
- **Form a “Mastermind group”**. Napoleon Hill, author of the multi-million copy bestseller "Think & Grow Rich" emphasises that this is one of the most important steps that can be taken to achieving your dreams. This group ideally has 4 or more people (remember though that you can start with 2 people and build from there) that can help you with ideas to move you towards your dream life. And a variety of personalities and backgrounds can be good also so don't worry that people all have to be the same or they won't get along. There is more electrical energy in the air when you have a group of unlike minds brainstorming rather than a group of like minds. Why? Because unlike minds see different aspects of the project and these differences when brought to light can bring up new ideas or creations. Start with one or two people and grow your group and quickly as you can manage it. Try to meet once a week or every other week if possible. So start thinking about people you know (or would like to know) that would be a good addition to your mastermind group. Approach them with the proposal and be prepared to some trade some ideas for their time. For example if one person is also looking to make a change in their life – offer to be a part of their mastermind group. Or if another person has a small company they run – offer to help with brainstorming new ideas for promotion for their company.

**** NOTE:** On the internet, you are going to hear of Joint Ventures and how they can make or break your publishing business. Joint Ventures are arrangements between 2 publishers to self promote each others products for profit and or recognition. The Master mind group you form at the start can be your eventual JV. If you all get together to discuss ideas and how to get them up and running quickly, you can all profit at the same time. So think about one person you know who wants to start their own business – call them and start talking about regular meetings. Do it ! But make sure right from the start you agree that you are getting together to help each other start their own business **not as a partnership** in the same business. Partnerships can be dangerous to a friendship so go it alone.

There is an absolute ton of things you can do to wake up your mind, jump start your inborn creativity and find out who is lurking inside your docile mind just waiting to jump out.

Read through each idea spark and note which ones you would like to start with. Then note which ones you do not want to do. Both will be helpful – the ones you agree with and the ones you disagree with.

As you go through this process you will find some things that work better for you. Notice which triggers work best for creativity and idea generation – maybe it is smells, sounds, water, walks etc. And write down any triggers that work especially well for you. Here is a quick list for you to keep in mind for idea triggers and creativity generating environments:

- While doing anything repetitive – painting, colouring, manual labour etc
- Listening in on a speech or sermon
- While out for a walk or run
- Intense exercise – aerobics, biking, martial arts etc
- While reading a novel
- Upon waking up in the middle of the night
- Driving in your car
- Relaxing
- While in a meeting
- Meditating
- Showering
- Note which other ones work great for you !

The key is that you have to do it. Stop thinking about it, stop talking about it, stop reading RIGHT NOW – and go do step one!

PLAYTIME PASSION - STEP ONE

Remember when you were a child? Remember the things that you enjoyed and that consumed your days and nights? Sometimes these things are easy to remember and other times a little reminder helps out.

The following list contains things you may have done when you were a child and may still do. Look through the list and make notes on which ones stand out for you – both for the good memories and the bad memories.

When you look through this list you will find that some things will make you feel different. Maybe you cannot put your finger on what feels different just something does. Listen up ! When your body tells you something like that please take note and write down which item made you feel that way – make a note that your stomach turned or your heart fluttered or you got gas and the cat passed out or.

Your past interests can be an amazing tool to find your true passions in life today. Unfortunately we tend to forget about the things that were so important to us in the past because we get wrapped up in our busy lives. Look at the list and remember what you can about **each** item. The ones that give you that feeling inside are the ones you want to pay attention to.

One of life's biggest disappointments is how quickly we encourage kids to grow up and act like an adult. How far has that advice gotten you ? Are you happier as an adult than you were as a kid ? Most of society would love to go back and enjoy the simple pleasures in life and get back some of that freedom we gave up as we got older.

Action Figures	Art classes	Airplanes	Archery	Board games	Basketball	Baking
Baton twirling	Blackboards and chalk	Beanbags	Biking	Binoculars	Bird watching	Blocks
Butterflies	Bowling	Cap guns	Cracker Jacks	Clay Creations	Caterpillars	Cots
Books	Boomerangs	Bubbles	Bug Collections	Boat sailing and building	Card games	Carpentry
Cards	Costumes	Chess	Candles	Camping	Checkers	Cats
Clay molding	Construction	Coloring books	Cartoons	Chalk boards and drawing	Cars	Cooking
Computer games	Crayons	Chemistry	Dancing	Dollhouses	Dogs	Dominoes
Dolls	Drumming	Dune buggy	Electric toys	Exercise	Elephants	Elegant party
Dice	Dreams	Energy	Football	Firecrackers	Frisbee	Finger painting
Flower pressing	Finances	Forts	Guitar	Games	Gardens	Garages
Golf	Gymnastics	Hunting for bugs	Horseshoes	Haunting	Harmonica	Harp
Hammocks	Horoscopes	Helicopters	Hiking	Hockey	Jewelry making	Juggling
Jumping rope	Kaleidoscopes	Kites	Knitting	Letter writing	Listening to music	Lumber
Mummies	Magic tricks	Magnets	Microscope	Magnifying glass	Marbles	Marionettes
Model making	Musical instruments	Masks	Nature walks	Needle point	Paper airplanes	Paper mache
Plants	Pipes	Photography	Piano	Playgrounds	Ping pong	Poster coloring
Puppet making and play	Pool	Puzzles	Rocks	Remote control cars, boats planes	Reading	Robots
Slides	Skiing	Snow men	Star gazing	Scare Crows	Silk Screen	Soap Making
Ships	Sleds	Science	Scrap books	Scrap yards	Sand boxes	Rope
Skating	Stamp collecting	Skateboarding	Sketching	Tires – old tires and tubes	Twister	Trampoline
Tea Party	Tents	Trading cards	Telescopes	Swimming	Strings	Stickers
Train sets	Tools	Traveling	Violin	Volleyball	Video games	Walking

Whistling	Wagons	Whittling	Walkie Talkies	Writing	Xylophone	Wilderness
Yoga	Viewmaster	Yo-Yos	Yarn	Zebras	Zipper	Zoo trips

Reliving some of those joys that kids live every day is one of the simplest exercises you can do to improve your life and the way you look at problems and issues. Bringing that zest for life into your own business will make your company stand out from the crowd and attract as much success as you dream for. Look at those people that took the plunge, started their own company, absolutely loved what they were doing and went on to make statements like “I never worked a day in my life since I became my own boss – it is too much fun to be work !”

There are many different ideas here waiting to happen.

If you have a hobby that is related to one of the above activities – you are on to something – write it down !

Information Ideas

101 ways to make money from your art

Secrets of baking success

Butterfly hot spots around the world

Training your old cat new tricks

Money making Kite Ideas

Mysterious Money from Magic

Travelling for dollars

How to travel the world on \$1,000

10 steps to Science success – Teaching your kid the basics

CREATIVITY EXERCISES:

- Go to the best candy store around and splurge on yourself – buy a Pez dispenser, liquorice, swizzlers – have fun – remember what it was like when you were a kid? What was your favourite thing to do as a kid ?
- If you could be a Superhero which one would you be? Or would you create your own? What is the outfit like? Special powers? Write it down.
- Listen to the questions that kids ask – they are experts at creativity and honesty. Watch them play and learn – they are masters of excitement, focus and imagination – try to copy some of their traits and use them in every day life.
- Buy some water based finger paints – get a friend or two together with some large sheets of brown paper – or a white table cloth – and have some fun – pretend you are 5 years old – what would you paint?!

- Pretend you are 2 or 3 years old – ask why to everything you see. Why is the sky blue? Why is it raining? Why ? Now ask these why questions about all businesses that you have been interested in the past. (Ex. Why do coffee shops all have a similar set-up ? Why don't coffee shops have more music ? Or more social activities ?)
- Do something totally out of character – with friends or with strangers – it doesn't matter.

Product Promo Tip

If you have an existing company and are looking for new ways to promote or advertise – pay attention to the above list ! There is over 160 different ideas there that may help. Think about it – you are looking for ideas for your custom gift baskets and you start looking through this list for ideas. Maybe have art classes for free where people can decorate their own gift baskets. Or maybe you start doing gift baskets for kids birthdays – consisting of toy trains, bubble machines and books. Or what about bug collecting gift baskets with nets and jars and magnifying glasses etc. Or a friend is going away on a trip somewhere you could build gift baskets for the travelers with film for their camera, first aid kits, waterproof pouches, money belts etc. There are lots of ideas out there if you put your mind to it and try some new things. If you look around at society and small business – the problem as a whole is that everyone expects wonderful things to happen in their personal and business lives but they never do anything to get there. Back to the saying – “if you keep doing the same things day after day you can not expect the results to be any different“

CREATIVITY EXERCISES

- Go to the zoo. Watch children's faces as they light up with delight when seeing a tiger for the first time. Or think about the animals. Just what are they thinking ? What about animals do you enjoy the most (companionship, safety, comfort etc) ?
- Go for a walk anywhere, new or old. Try and get into the habit of walking once a day or once very other day. Walking is one of the most powerful idea generation techniques out there – so bring your notebook !
- Ask yourself – “What would I do if there was a cash reward of \$100,000 for solving this problem within the next 2 days?” “Or what if there was a cash reward of \$100,000 to you if you come up with a creative business concept in the next 2 days ?”
- Invent something – look in your junk drawers – find a couple items that stand out – find a way to make them work with each other or work in a new way or for a new use.
- Rent your favourite funniest movies and laugh, laugh, laugh!
- Close your eyes and imagine yourself being able to actually massage your stress points in your mind. When you first close your eyes, concentrate on your breathing – feel the breath go in and go out. Concentrate on this until you feel some of the tension come out. Feel the tense spots and pressure points? Lightly mentally massage out the tension – feel the difference it can make.
- Create a collage – get out some construction paper, scissors and tape or glue. Find some old magazines and newspapers and start cutting out headlines and pictures that sum up your goals, motivations, dreams and aspirations. Find a headline that really stands out to you as a statement and put it right in the centre of your collage. Try this ! It is fun getting dirty and being a little

crazy with some scissors and glue ☺ Here is an idea with this “Cash from your Collages”. Sound crazy ? Have you been to a scrap booking store lately ? They are popping up everywhere and they are selling products like hot cakes !

“Reflection is one of the most underused yet powerful tools for success.” -- Richard Carlson

- Go to your local dollar store— take \$10 with you and buy some Hot Wheels or Barbies or other toys that you used to play with when you were a kid. What information is needed by people that collect these ? Look at all the Beanie Baby collectors guides out there now – somebody is making some serious money !
- Go back to the basics. Read about famous people from the past and how they became famous – Einstein, Edison, Mozart, Davinci etc. They all have amazing stories and each of us could learn immensely from them. How does what they went through apply to your life? Could you change things like they did? One of the best authors writing about these techniques is *Michael J Gelb* who recently wrote *Discover your Genius*.
- If you are not a puzzle or crossword person – start working on them in the paper – or if you are a crossword person – try brain twister exercises.
- Get a dictionary or thesaurus out – close your eyes and put your finger on a word on any page – look at the word and think/write down how it applies to your problem or project –compare and contrast. (eg – I picked **far** out of the dictionary – I think about it and I think – I am far away from a beach but if I keep working hard on my problem I will be on a beach in 2 months on a 2 week holiday. Also if I look back in time I have come a far ways from where I was 2 years ago for happiness and fulfillment). **Product**

Idea – Far Away Fortunes – Stories of Success from Overseas

- With the same thesaurus, sit down and pick out 10 words out of the thesaurus that describe you. Write them down and then expand on why you think those words describe you. Write down everything you want. Do not hold back or feel guilty about wanting things. Write down everything you want in love, relationships, business, spiritual, financial, recreational, personal growth, material goods. Remember that this is helpful to cleanse yourself and get these wants down on paper. Write down the little secrets that you have always dreamed of.
- Find a place with a fireplace and hang out with a coffee, drink and think. Write down what you enjoy about coffee houses or what you don't like about them.
- Try a new sports activity – roller blade, ski, run, walk, lift weights, try martial arts etc – most have trials at no cost – good way to see what else is out there. What is hard to find ? Information for the beginner on ?

**** Product Idea – How you too can make \$100k/year in the sports industry. Interview successful sales and marketing people in the sports business and find out what makes them so successful. ****

- Have a show and tell party with your friends and/or your mastermind group. Remember these from school ? Time to show off your prize possessions or ideas. Plan ahead with your group and each person gets 5 minutes to show off what they are passionate about.
- Go to a pet store and look around. Picture things from a fish's perspective, or a cat's perspective or a dog's, etc. What would they like to see, smell, taste ?

- Learn the art of Mind Mapping (there is some great books out there – notably by *Tony Buzan* who termed this process Mind Mapping) as it can help you generate tons of good ideas as well as helps you focus on your to-do lists and find quick ways to get things done. This is a subject that deserves a entire book in itself to educate yourself on. For now I will provide you with a simple example which you can experiment with. The best process to use is:
 1. Start in the centre with your problem or goal
 2. Every idea that comes to you based on the problem – write it down around your center question – just start thinking of everything related to your problem or question
 3. Start looking at all of the ideas and do the same for each one. . Work on the free thought process for 2-5 minutes and see what you come up with.
 4. Use different colours, arrow types, drawings, text type etc. The point is to get your mind flowing and working on all kinds of different ideas and associations. When you are completed the free thought flow look at what you have put down and see what words relate to each other or compliment each other and connect them with new lines.
 5. Look at the entire mind map you have drawn and try to pick out the top 3-5 main points or concepts that came up.
 6. Try this again with the 3-5 main points. Lets say based on the following map (which should be expanded upon before completion) that you choose a kids furniture business and a home delivery business as a couple main points. Put these as your central points on a new map and start over.
- Go to a museum – one of the most under utilized tools for relaxation, idea generation and creativity building. Take your notebook and write down what catches your eye or interest.
- “I wish it was easier to get _____? This sentence can help you find a number of ideal businesses for yourself. Number one, it tells you something about your interests and passions; you are the one that finds an issue with it. And if you have a problem with it chances are that there are thousands of people out there with the same problem.
- Ask yourself one of those important questions – then open up a magazine or book that catches your eye. Randomly pick a page and then read the first sentence that stands out to you. How does it relate to your search?
- Stop reading – anything! -for a few days. If you are like me this is tough to do – I love to read! But I also found that this helps clear your mind and refocuses you on your goal – to live your dream life!
- Be silly for a day about anything and everything.
- Get a drastic haircut or colour – it grows back and it can be coloured back.
- Wear something incredibly tacky or something you would not usually wear. Whenever I am in need of some new ideas I throw on my ugliest Hawaiian shirts (this one almost makes you blind) and a funny thing happens – my mind starts whirling.

EXCELLENT BRAINSTORMING TECHNIQUE

Get yourself some post it notes, some pens, some large blank sheets of construction paper or use a 8 x 11 sheet of paper.

Step 1 - Write down on a post it your goal for brainstorming (eg – an idea for a part time business I can start). Put this post it in the centre of the table.

Step 2 - Now start writing (one idea per post it) the first things that come to mind (eg – helping elders, writing a book, coffee delivery, home parties, etc – keep going until you run out of ideas. Have these all spread out around your main question from step 1

Step 3 – Have numbers written on each post it with an idea 1, 2, 3, up to as many ideas as you have. Now do the same with small slips of paper so there is as many as there is ideas. So you have 14 ideas and 14 slips of paper with the numbers written on them.

Step 4 – Put the slips of paper in a hat or box or cup – whatever works for you – pick out 4 slips. Now pick each idea whose corresponds with the slip of paper (so you picked number 7 and idea # 7 was photo scrap booking sales as an example).

Step 5 – Put each of the 4 ideas on the corners of the construction paper or other paper you are using – they key is to have an idea on each corner and blank space in the middle.



Step 6 – Look at each of the 4 pieces of paper on the corners and write down the first things that come to mind on the blank space in the middle.

Step 7 – with a new pen colour start brainstorming combinations of the 4 ideas and write the combinations in the centre of the paper.

Also factor in the items you listed when you first looked at the 4 main ideas. Lets say we had the following 4 ideas on the corners:

Photo Scrap Booking

Pet day care and walking service

Selling health products door to door

Custom sign design and printing

Now we start brainstorming and we get some of the following (some far out) ideas

Pet Scrap booking

Holistic products for pets

Pet memorials

Signs built for pet owners

Signs with picture collages as the focus

Selling picture collages as celebrations or pets lives

Lawn signs with pets as characters – birthdays, anniversaries etc
How to guide on being healthy and wealthy with a holistic pet business
Specialty pet gift baskets
Pet product of the month club

Step 8 – now you have a list of off the wall business ideas. What I like to do is pick 4 more slips out and put 4 more ideas on the corners (overtop of the previous 4) and do this again with the new ideas but use the same paper with the business ideas generated from above. So add to this list again.

Step 9 – Now you may be running out of ideas or you can keep going to build your list. At this point you can also start combining the business ideas from step 7 and 8 into new and improved business ideas. For an example – “Pet product of the month club sold as a gift basket arrangement for pet birthdays”.

Step 10 – Walk away for an hour or two ! That’s right, forget about this and go do something else and let you subconscious mind do some work on this.

Step 11 – Go back to your list of business ideas. What does your stomach or heart tell you to do ? Listen to yourself here ! Your subconscious will have figured out which ideas have the most potential for yourself and now listen to your internal voice to tell you which ones are best.

Remember that there is no such thing as bad ideas – only ideas with potential ! Everything requires some work in this world – try and make it fun work though – only go after the things that bring fun or joy into your life. Each one of my crazy ideas listed has potential as an information product. Don’t believe me ?

MEDIA CHECKLIST

Please find below a checklist for getting you recognized by the media when you send out a press release:

Part 1 - Getting the release ready.

- € Download the fill-in-the-blank press release expressly created for this program.
- € Fill in the release with your information anywhere you see highlighted areas. Be sure to remove all the highlighted areas, as well as the credit information, after you are finished!

Part 2 - Who to send it to (local).

- € Focus on local, first.
- € Other ways to find the right reporter and right publication.
 - You can also find great contacts by using the newspapers, magazines, etc., you may already have. Simply look for reporters who are covering your press release topic and take down their contact details.
 - You can also use online directories to search for other outlets. A great one is http://dir.yahoo.com/News_and_Media/
 - Let your fingers do the walking by using the phonebook to find other media outlets
- € Call to confirm all contacts. Ask how they want to get your release: email, fax, snail-mail.
- € Send out release to each reporter as they prefer.

Part 3 - Who to send it to (national).

- € Research media outlets online which appeal to your target market. Use the same system outlined above to find out the right contacts.
- € Use release posting websites. These are great for search engine optimization, and driving others to your website. But please remember, they often don't lead to any media coverage.
 - Here's a list of sites to post:
 - www.prleap.com
 - www.prweb.com
 - www.addpr.com
 - www.express-press-release.com
 - www.free-press-release.com
 - www.openpr.com
 - www.press-base.com
 - www.press411.com
 - www.pressreleasespider.com
 - www.i-newswire.com
 - A note on PR Web. I highly recommend this one. Although you will have to pay for the service, if you really want to make a splash to increase your search engine rankings, this is the one!

Part 4 - Following up with reporters.

- € Choose which media outlets are important to you - the places you really want the release to appear in.
- € Call and ask for the reporter.
- € First, introduce yourself and ask if they have time to talk.
 - If yes, then go to next step
 - If no, then find out when would be a good time to call back. (Then do so!)

- € Do **NOT** tell the reporter you are following up on a press release. Instead say:

I have some additional information that I left out of the release I sent you about... (fill in with topic)

At this point the reporter will say to continue or that they don't recall the release.

If it's to continue, say the following:

Did you know that (add additional info here). Do you think this would make an interesting local story?

Or say:

Since announcing I am doing XX, many people, especially others in my field, asking me how I XX. I think it's something that your readers would be interested in, too. Do you agree?

If the reporter says he or she did not getting the release:

Offer to resend it. Confirm the reporter's method of receipt. And ask when you can call back to make sure they got it. (Then follow up by using the method above.)

- € If the reporter says, "No Thanks. I don't think I'm interested."
 - Ask the reporter why.
 - * It may often be the case that you targeted the wrong reporter! In this case, ask them for the correct contact and report the whole process by sending the correct contact the release.
 - * If he or she truly isn't interested, ask what he or she is interested in covering. If you can fill one of the reporter's topics, tell him or her so immediately.
 - Thank the reporter for his or her time and ask they would be interested in other stories from you in the future. (Make a note for future reference!)
- € If the reporter says, "Yes."
 - Find out if the reporter will be running the release as is or wants to set up an interview.
 - Thank the reporter for his or her time.

Part 5 - The interview

- € When a reporter wants to interview you:
 - DON'T just answer off the cuff. Ask for a time to call them back if they are doing a phone interview.
 - Confirm the topic and focus of what the interview is going to be about.
 - Set up a time for the interview.
- € Use the interview prep worksheet to prepare your talking points. (download)
- € If your interview is face-to-face with camera use:
 - Don't wear all black. You'll look as though you're disappearing into a hole. This often throws women into a panic, as we love the slimming properties of black, particularly when TV will probably make you look slightly heavier than you are in real life.
 - Don't wear all white. It makes the lights that may be used bounce back and you'll look as though you just descended from the heavens on a cloud.
 - Don't wear anything with a very small pattern such as pin-stripes, tweed or polka dots. Again, it has a strange effect on lights known as strobing.
 - No visible logos of companies or brands (watch out for this particularly on sportswear) as this may be regarded as advertising. You may be asked to change if a logo is too obvious.
 - Avoid buying a new outfit the day before and acting as if you're going to a job interview. If you feel too stiff and formal in your clothes this will affect how you express yourself.
 - You should wear your make-up much heavier than you normally would. Otherwise you will look washed out.
- € Some things to remember, during the interview:
 - Focus on your three main points from your worksheet.

- If a reporter is quiet, that doesn't mean fill in the space with you talking. It's a tactic for you to reveal too much.
- Nothing is EVER 'off the record.'
- If you don't know, say so. And offer to find out the information.
- If, for any reason, you can't reveal something, explain that as honestly as you can.

Part 6 - Leveraging your publicity.

- € Post any coverage you receive onto your website. Check to make sure you can use the footage or story, as copyright may apply. If you cannot post the whole thing, perhaps you create a link to their website.
- € Post "As Seen On" on main page of site with a list of the media outlets you've been featured on/in.
- € Send an announcement to your customers/clients
- € Send announcement to possible clients/customers
- € Use Google News Alerts to help track coverage as well.

Part 7 - Getting more publicity.

- € Send reporters a hand written thank you note no more than three days after your story appeared.
 - Express gratitude for taking the time out of their schedule.
 - Tell them what the coverage meant to others (It was informative, well written, etc.)
 - Do NOT thank them for the coverage or tell them how the coverage benefited you.
 - Tell them you will check back with other ideas every month or so that may be of interest to them

Credit: This press release template is given exclusively to Troy White's Marketing and Promotional Calendar recipients by Shannon Cherry.

Shannon Cherry, APR, MA is The Power Publicist. The founder of Be Heard Solutions (www.beheardsolutions.com) , she helps small business owners and entrepreneurs to attract targeted prospects by using the power of publicity and promotions. Sign up for her free Publicity Power Pack, which gives you access to free publicity and marketing tips, media contacts and more at <http://www.beheardsolutions.com>

We would love to hear from you...if you have a campaign that you did and want it featured in the Calendar – please send us your campaign along with your credentials and we will include it in our next publication.

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All the best, Troy White
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